

Kaizen Made Easy

100+ Quotes to Inspire Continuous Improvement



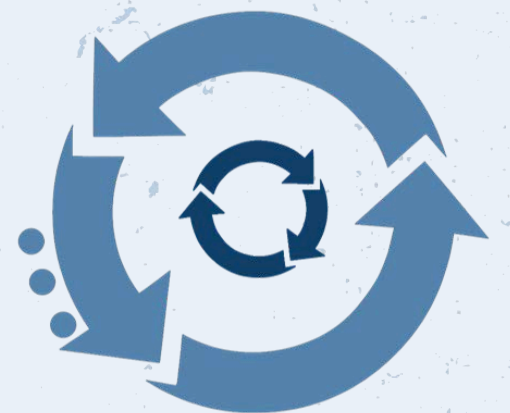
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“

**Kaizen builds human
capability in response to
competitive challenges**

”

Prof. Bob Emiliani



Source: kaizen forever : Teachings of Chihiro Nakao



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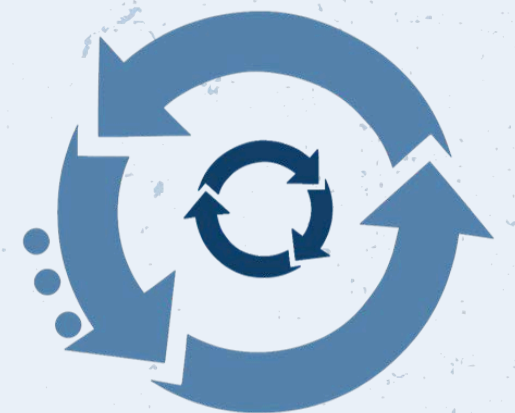
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“

**“Trystorming”
is most important
Never Stop Trying**

”

Chihiro Nakao



Source: Bob Emiliani, kaizen forever : Teachings of Chihiro Nakao



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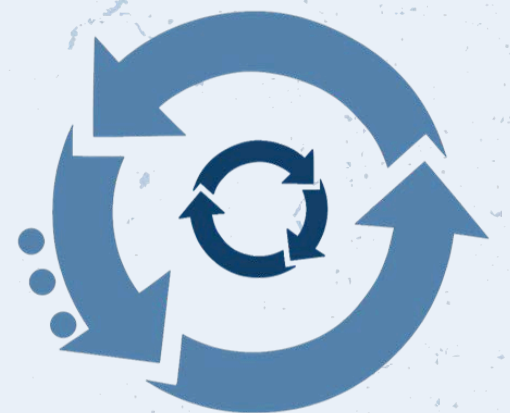
“

Lifetime Employment
Is A Core Value For Toyota.

”

Tracey & Ernie Richardson

Source: Tracey and Ernie Richardson. The Toyota Engagement Equation



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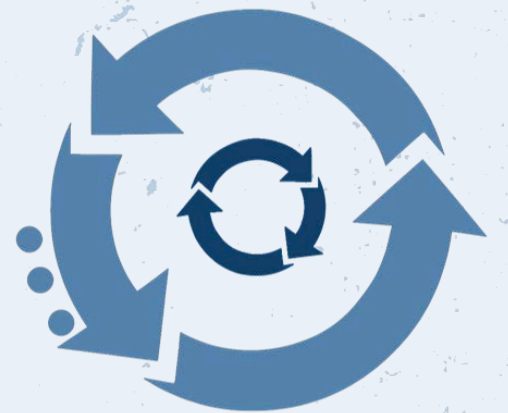
“

**There is no end to
Kaizen**

”

Prof. Bob Emiliani

Source: Emiliani, B., Yoshino, K., & Go, R. (2008). Kaizen forever

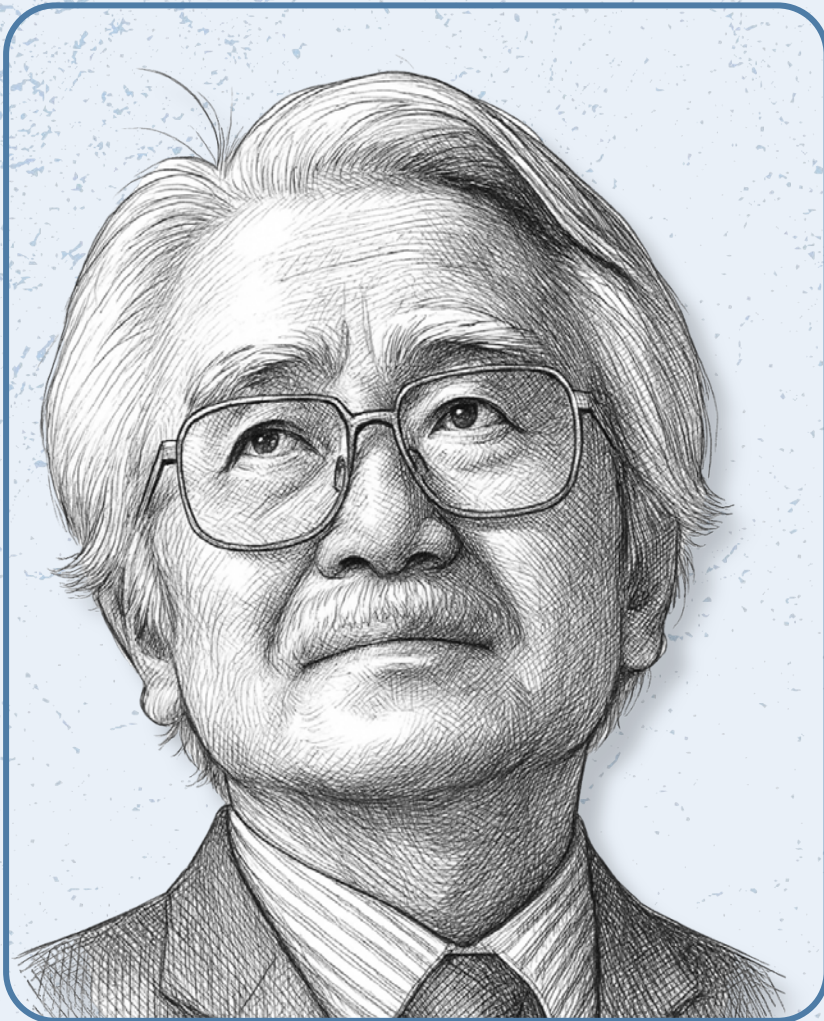


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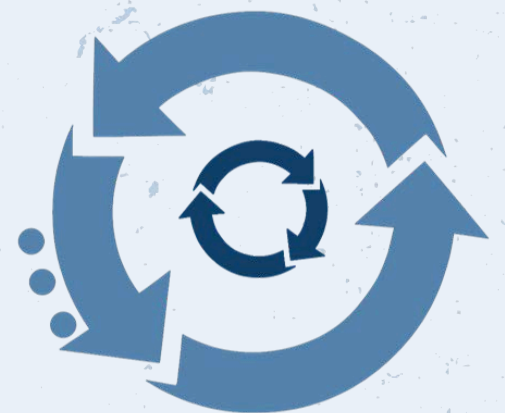
“



Masaaki Imai

**Gemba Kaizen is a
human system
that works only
when it is people-
centered.**

”



Source: Imai, M. (2012). Gemba kaizen



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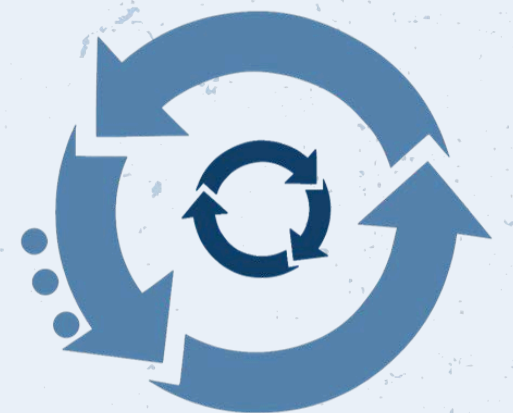
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“

**People
must not be harmed by
Kaizen**

”

Prof. Bob Emiliani



Source: kaizen forever : Teachings of Chihiro Nakao



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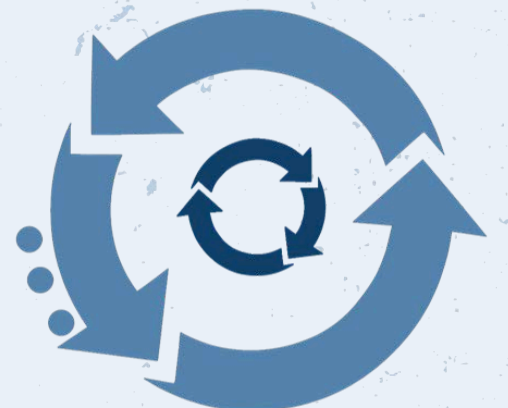
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“

**Lean must be led by an
organization's
top leaders**

”

Prof. Bob Emiliani



Source: Emiliani, Bob. The Triumph of Classical Management over Lean Management



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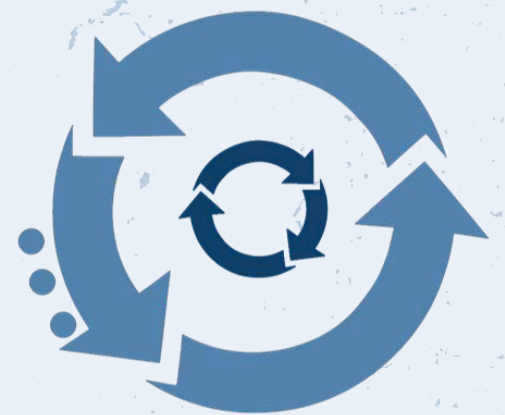
**The biggest danger is that we wind
up blaming people**

for a badly designed process.

”

Tracey & Ernie Richardson

Source: Tracey and Ernie Richardson. The Toyota Engagement Equation



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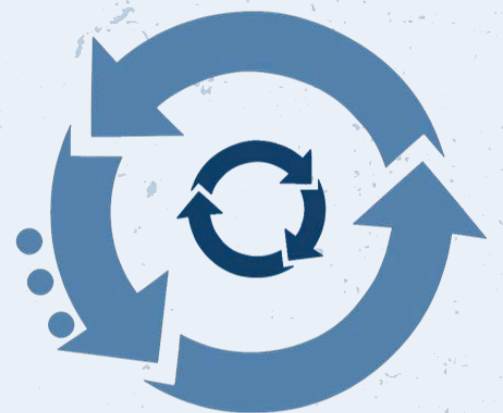


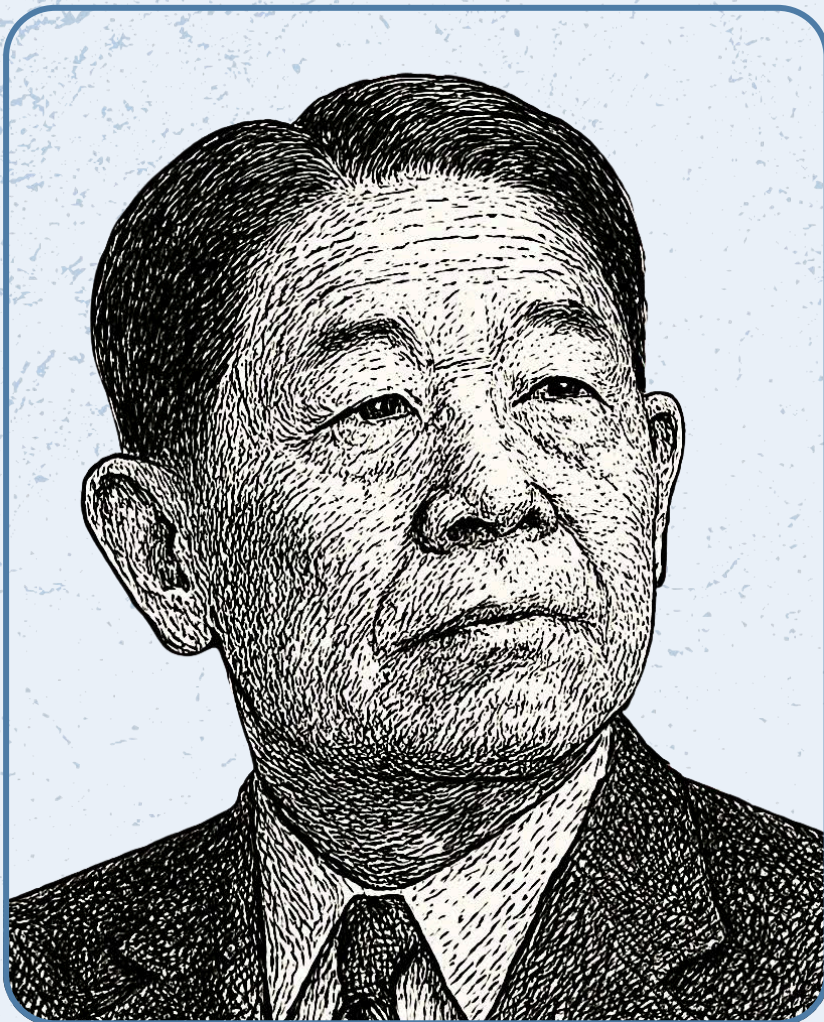
John C. Maxwell

“

**Fail early, fail
often, but always
fail forward.**

”





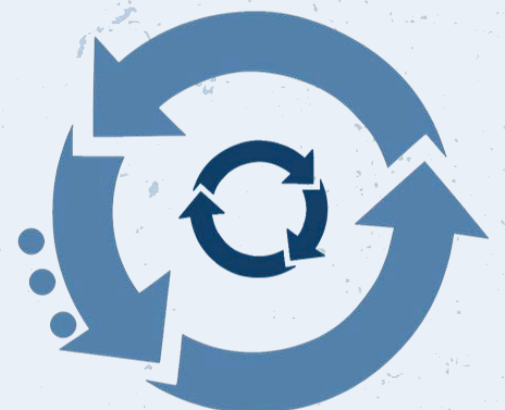
Shigeo Shingo

“

**Any sort of
improvement would
be impossible.**

**... if we believed
there were only one
means to each end**

”



Source: Shingo, S. and Dillon, The Sayings Of Shigeo Shingo



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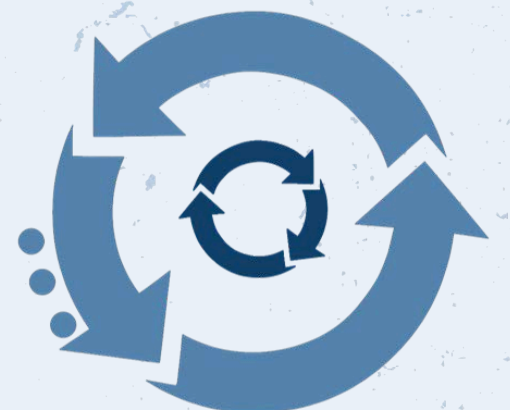


“Be kind to people,
be ruthless to systems.”

”

Michael Brooks

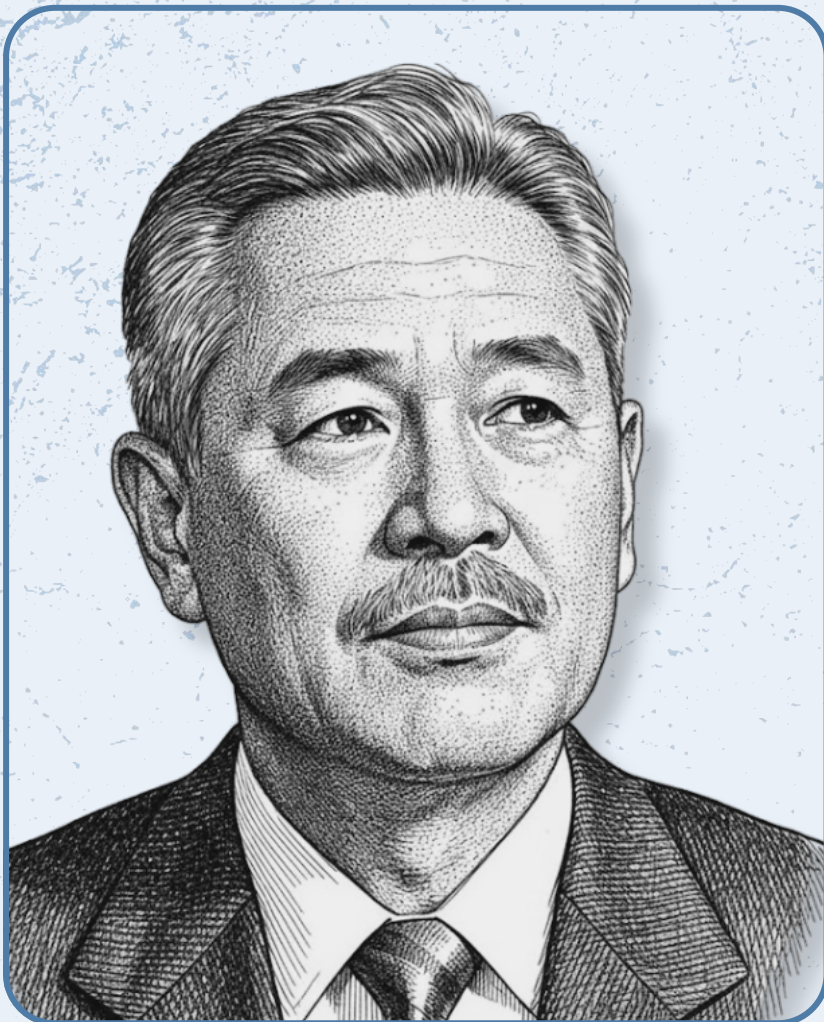
Source: Tracey and Ernie Richardson. The Toyota Engagement Equation



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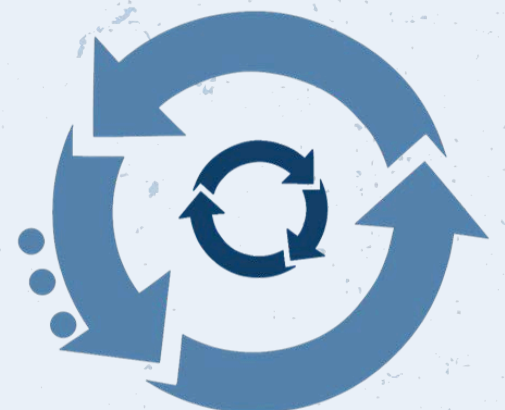


Taiichi Ohno

“

We are doomed to failure if we do not initiate a daily destruction of our various preconceptions.

”



Source: Emiliani, Bob. The Triumph of Classical Management over Lean Management:



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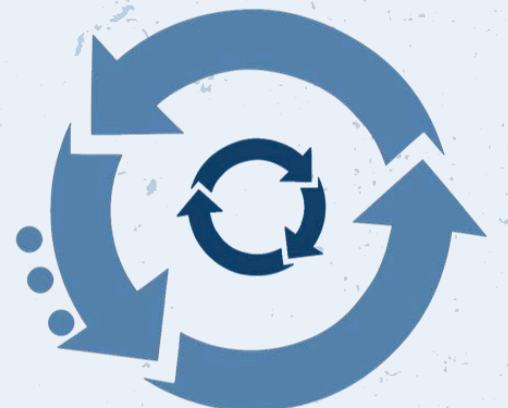
“

NOBODY
is exempt from
IMPROVEMENT

”

Prof. Bob Emiliani

Source: Emiliani, B., Yoshino, K., & Go, R. (2008). Kaizen forever



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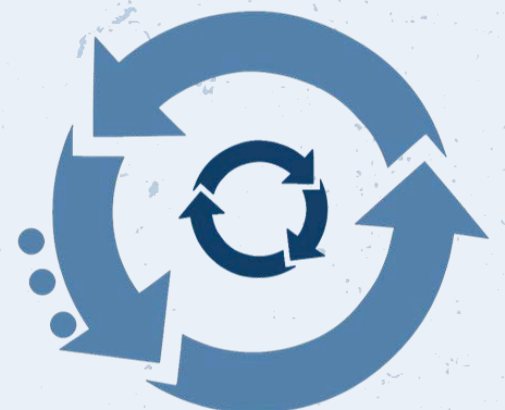
“



Sakichi Toyoda

**Before you say
you can't do
something, try it**

”



Source: Tracey and Ernie Richardson. The Toyota Engagement Equation



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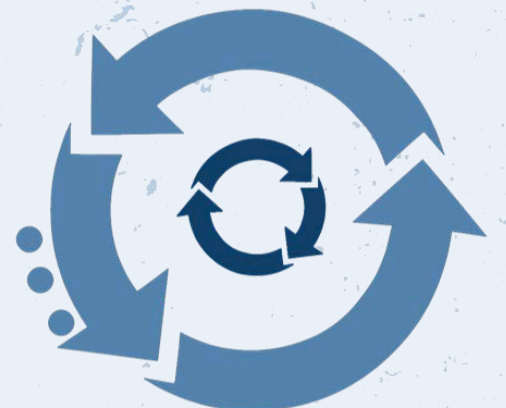
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**“ Lean management
recognizes people as
hard-working, intelligent,
and responsible.**

”

Prof. Bob Emiliani



Source: Emiliani, Bob. The Triumph of Classical Management over Lean Management



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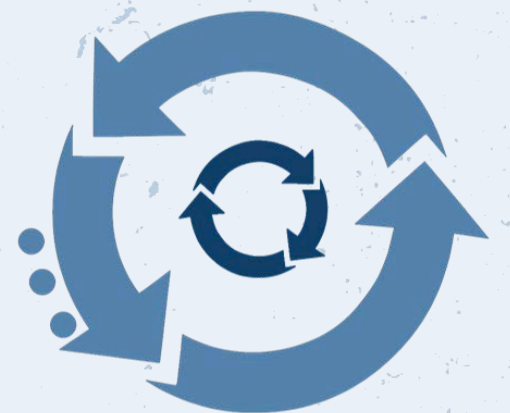
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“ We will never be experts at everything, so we all have to be willing and able to LEARN CONSTANTLY. ”

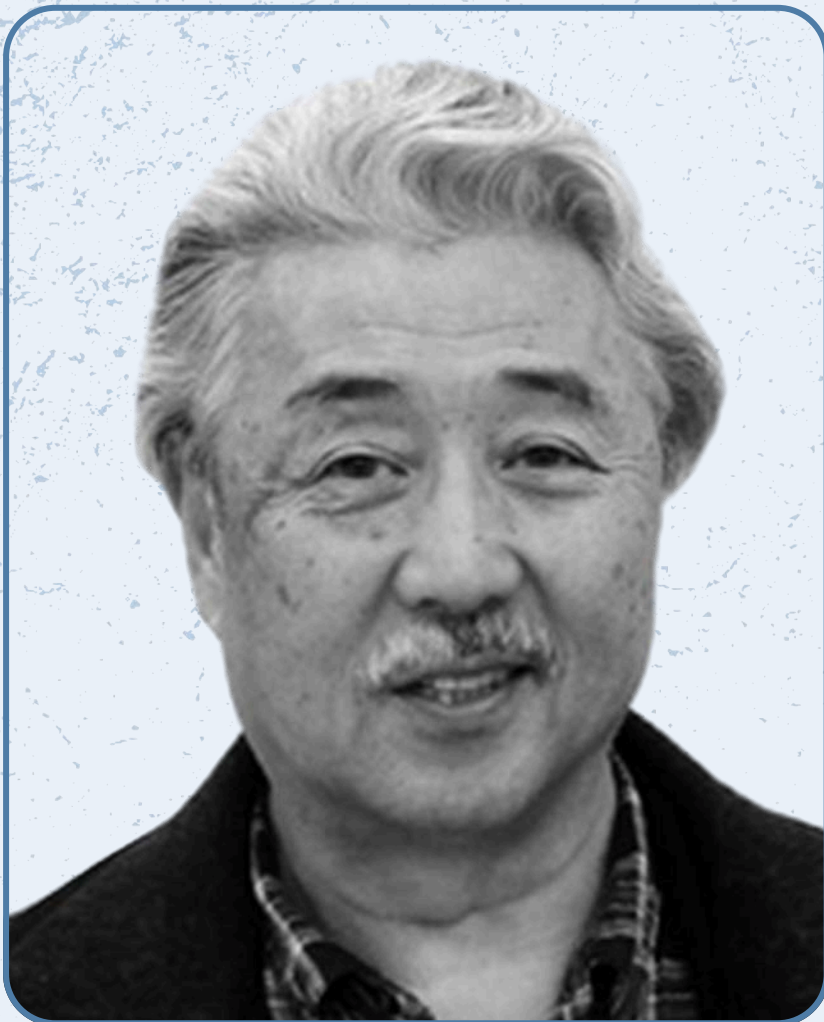
Tracey & Ernie Richardson

Source: Tracey and Ernie Richardson. The Toyota Engagement Equation



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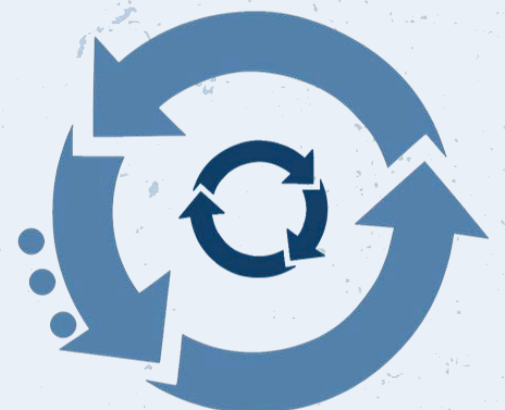
Toshihiro Nagamatsu

“

**You may think you are a
good company today, but
make no mistake, you are
not...**

**There is no end. You must
continually seek to
improve**

”



Source: Emiliani, Bob. The Triumph of Classical Management over Lean Management



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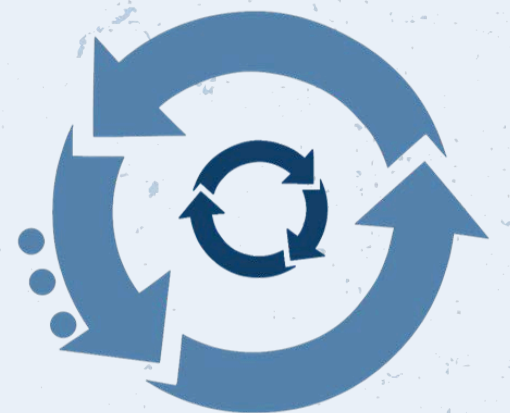


Eiji Toyoda

“

People are the most important asset of Toyota and the determinant of the rise or fall of Toyota

”



Source: Tracey and Ernie Richardson. The Toyota Engagement Equation



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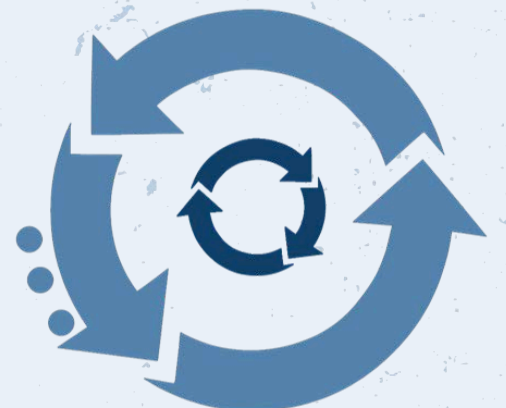


“

Any person in a leadership position should possess the same basic mindset: “We can do better.”

”

Prof. Bob Emiliani



Source: Emiliani, Bob. The Triumph of Classical Management over Lean Management



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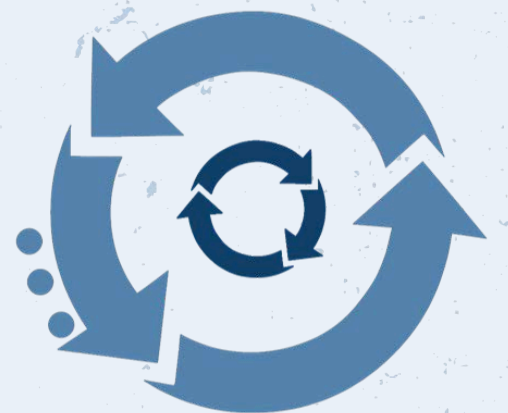
“

**Every Toyota employee is
expected not just to excel in his
current role, but to work toward
higher levels of performance
with enthusiasm.**

”

Jeffrey Liker

Source: LIKER, JEFFREY K. TOYOTA WAY



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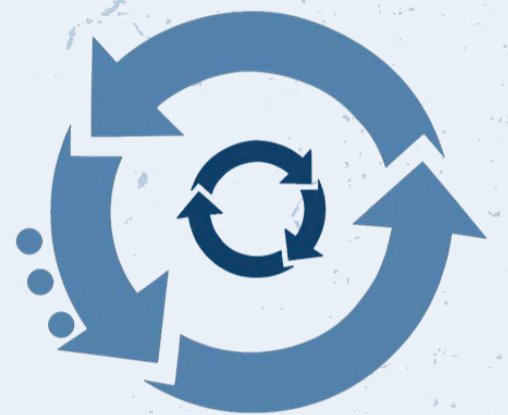
“

**As a leader, you must now spend
Fifty Percent of your time developing
your people.**

”

Tracey & Ernie Richardson

Source: Tracey and Ernie Richardson. The Toyota Engagement Equation



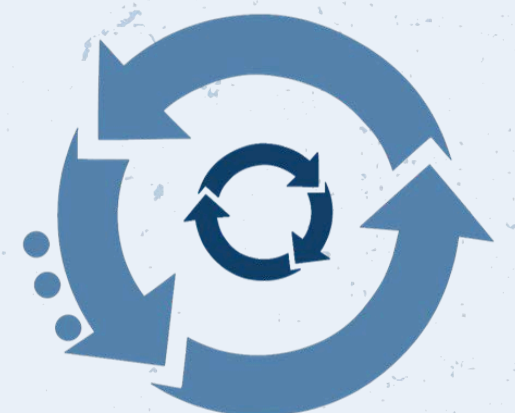
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A large, light blue circular arrow graphic with three arrows pointing clockwise, centered behind the main text.

“ kaizen **isn't a set of projects or special events. It's the way people in the company work toward goals scientifically, harking back to Deming's **never-ending PDCA Cycles** ”**

Jeffrey Liker

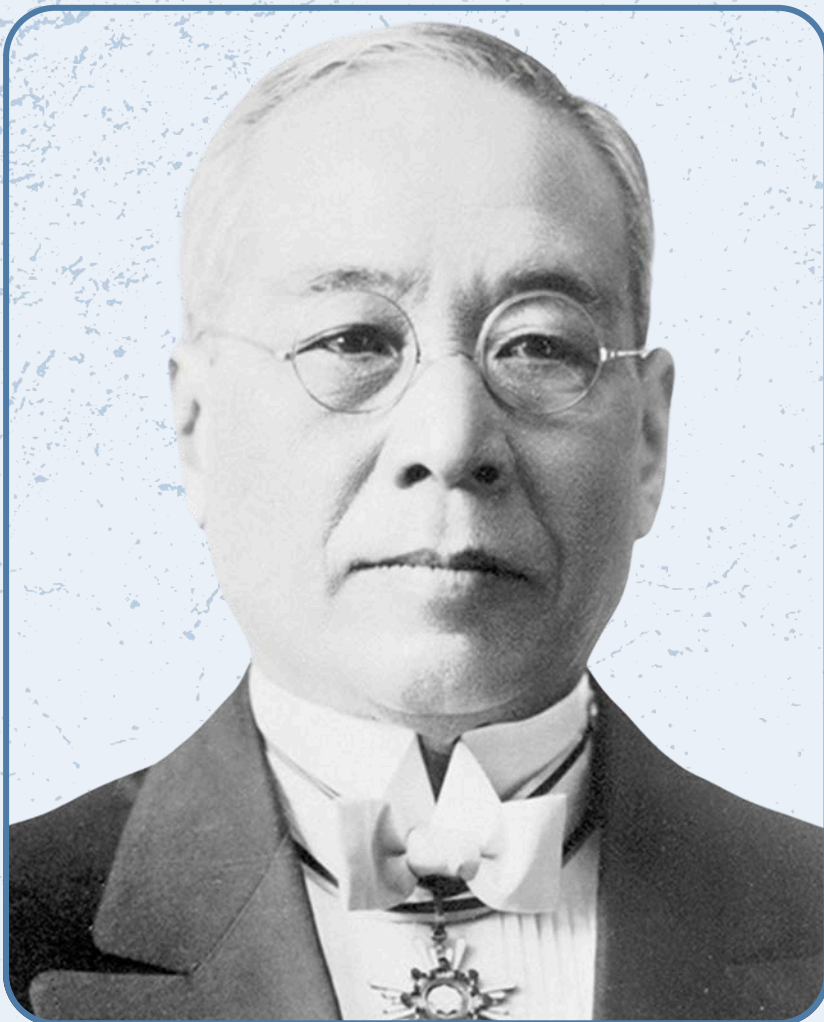


Source: LIKER, JEFFREY K. TOYOTA WAY



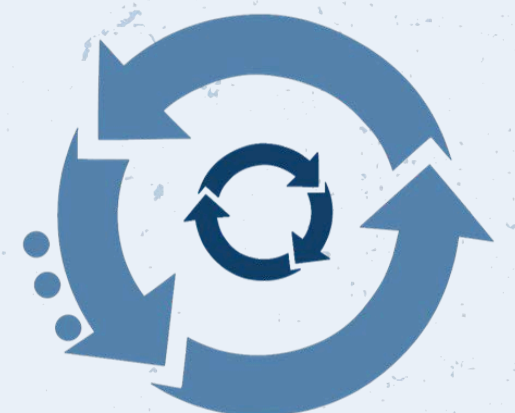
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Sakichi Toyoda

“
I have experienced
many twists and
turns in my life; For
the most part, I have
seen more failures
than successes.”



Source: Tracey and Ernie Richardson. The Toyota Engagement Equation



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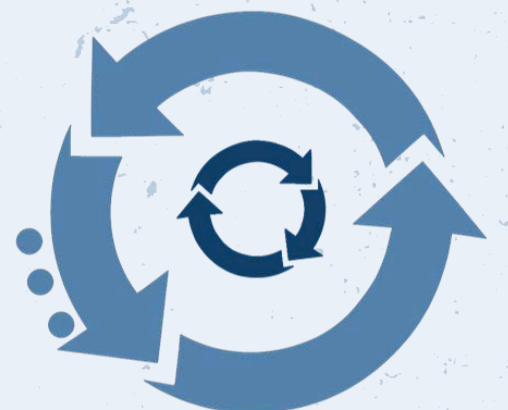
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“

**A Lean transformation takes an
incredible amount of discipline at
all levels**

”

Mark DeLuzio



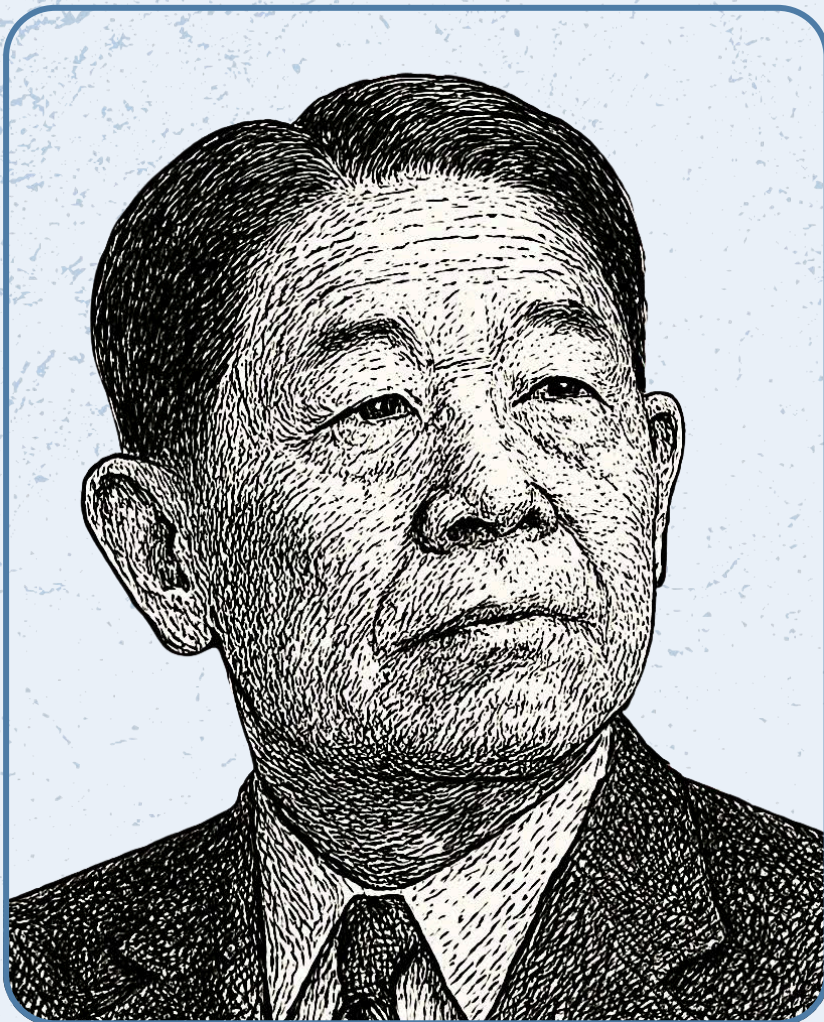
Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined why lean transformations fail and what to do about it.



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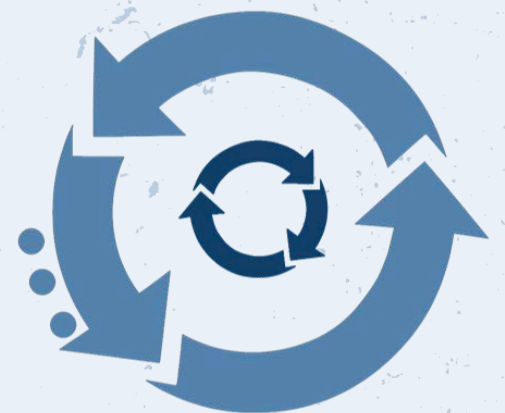


Shigeo Shingo

“

The most magnificent
improvement scheme
in the world will be
worthless...
if your perception of
the current situation
is in **error**.

”



Source: Shingo, S. and Dillon, The Sayings Of Shigeo Shingo



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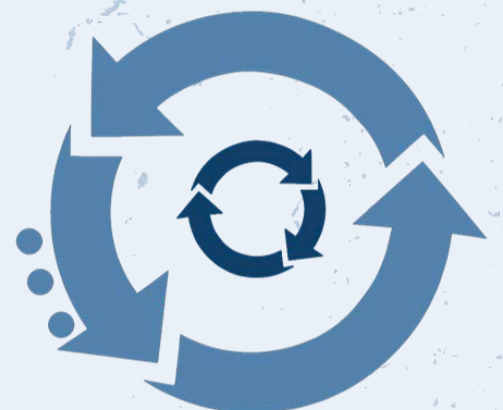
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“

**Lead not from a position of power,
but from an empowering position**

”

Tracey & Ernie Richardson



Source: Tracey and Ernie Richardson. The Toyota Engagement Equation



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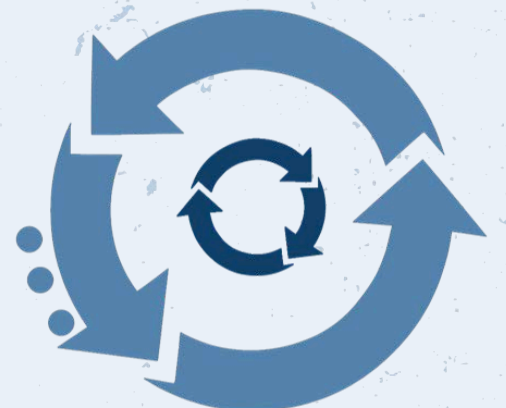
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“

**A “lean process” is actually a
vision to strive for and an
outcome of repeated problem
solving.**

”

Jeffrey Liker



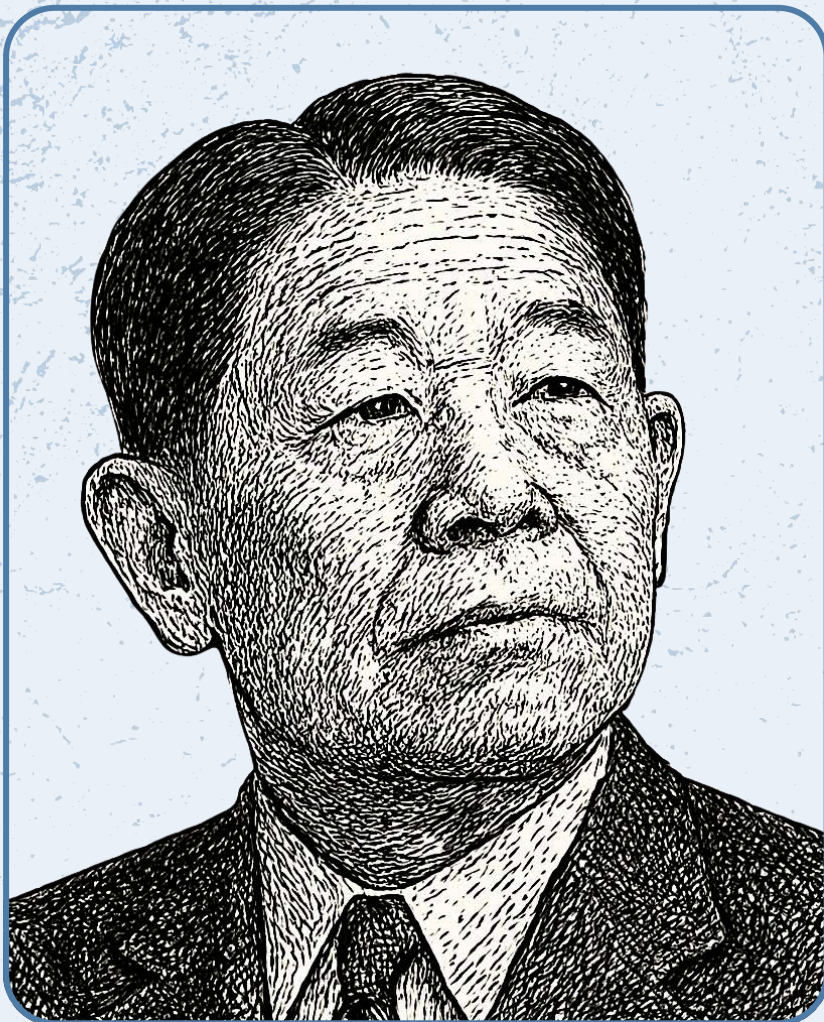
Source: LIKER, JEFFREY K. TOYOTA WAY



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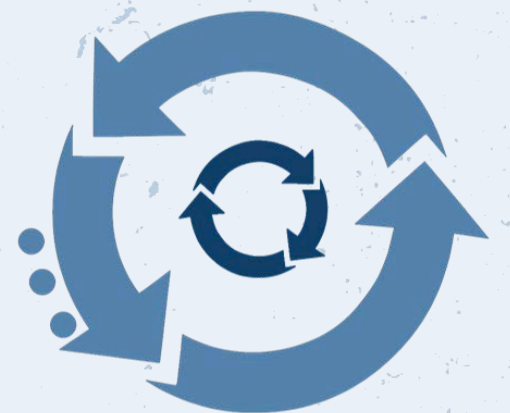
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Shigeo Shingo

“
Quality can be
stabilized,
when "**feel**" is
abandoned in favor of
quantitative
measures.”



Source: Shingo, S. and Dillon, The Sayings Of Shigeo Shingo

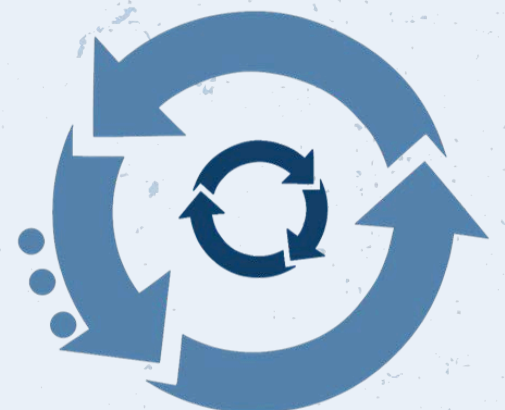


Taiichi Ohno

“

The **more inventory** a
company has, . . .
the **less likely** they will
have what they need.

”



Source: LIKER, JEFFREY K. TOYOTA WAY

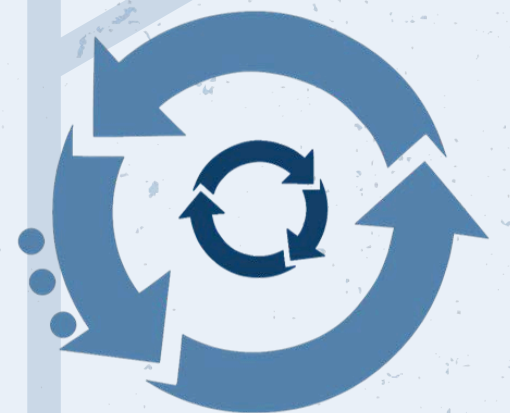


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**“ The paradox of Lean is that
the more structure and
standards you have in place,
the more flexible and creative
you can become. ”**

Mark Deluzio



Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined



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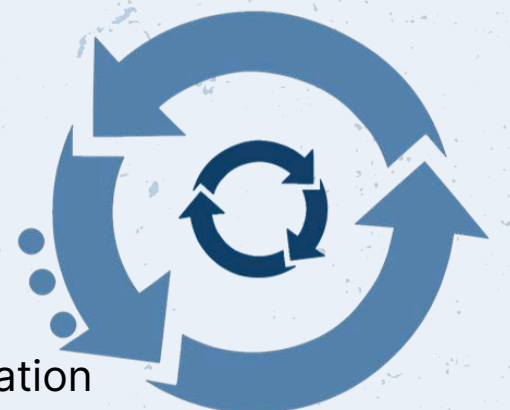
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Taiichi Ohno

“
**Why not make the
work easier and more
interesting so that
people do not have to
sweat?**
”

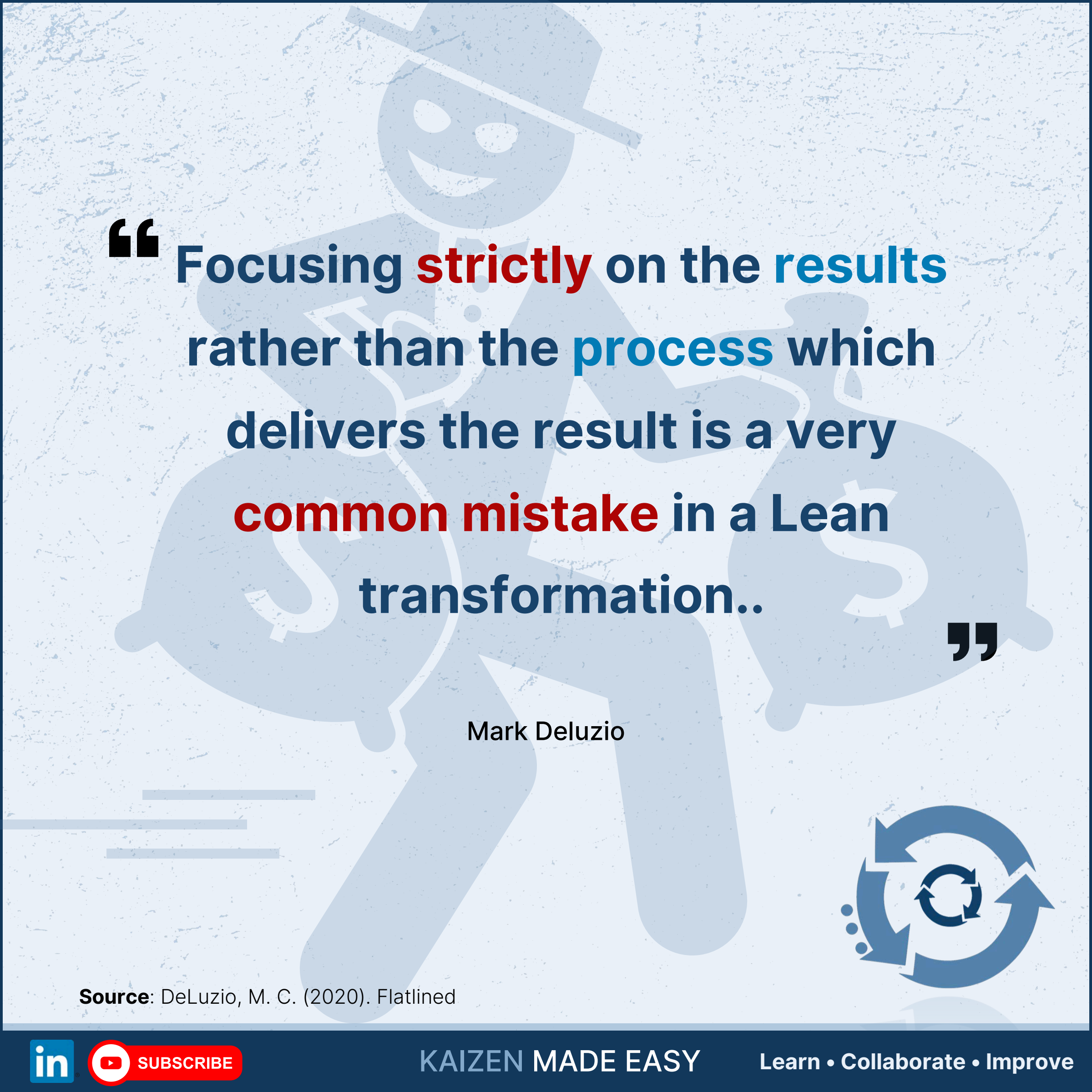


Source: Richardson, Tracey S., and Ernie Richardson. The Toyota Engagement Equation



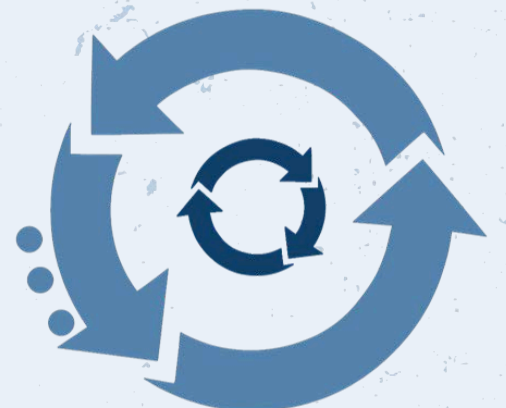
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“ Focusing **strictly on the **results** rather than the **process** which delivers the result is a very **common mistake** in a Lean transformation.. ”**

Mark Deluzio



Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined



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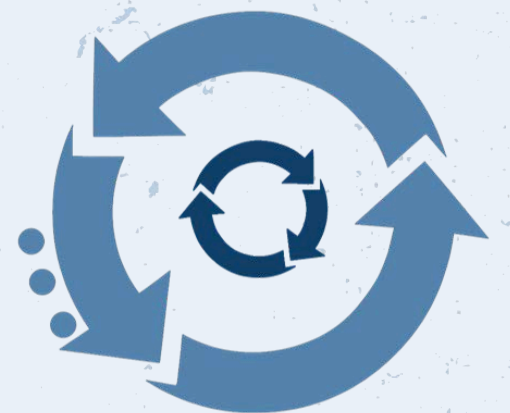
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Shigeo Shingo

“
Progress will **never**
pay a visit to those
who **stubbornly** insist
that their way is right
and **no other means**
are possible.”



Source: Shingo, S. and Dillon, The Sayings Of Shigeo Shingo



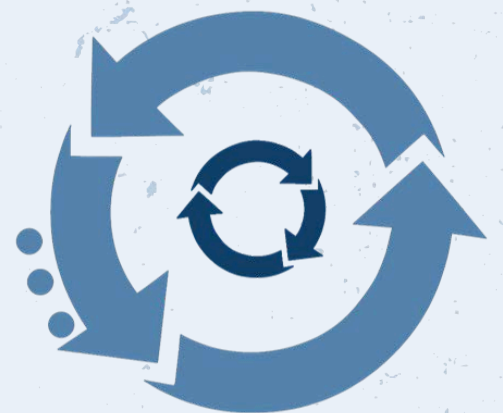
“

The moment you think you’ve finally “got it,” you can be sure that there’s a deeper lesson to be learned.

”

Tracey & Ernie Richardson

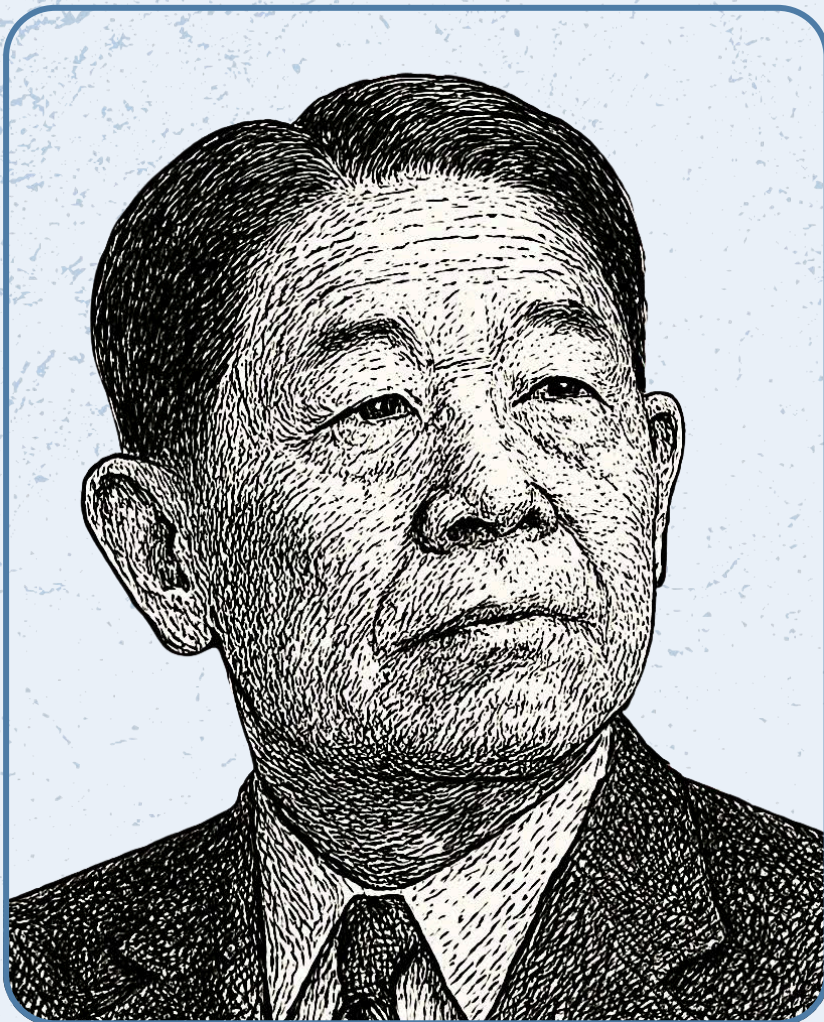
Source: Tracey and Ernie Richardson. The Toyota Engagement Equation



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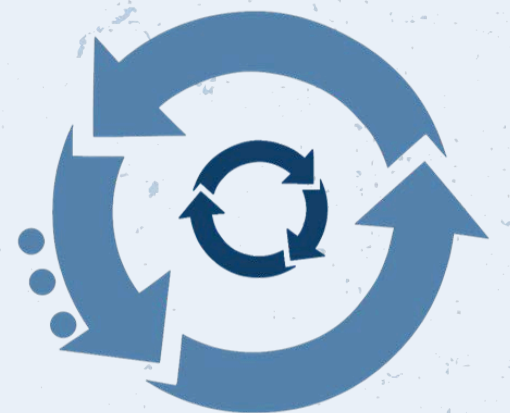
Shigeo Shingo

“

We frequently persuade ourselves that current methods are the best....

we may even end up believing that current methods are goals in themselves

”



Source: Shingo, S. and Dillon, The Sayings Of Shigeo Shingo



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“

**Point kaizens result in
quick wins rather than
sustainable results.**

”

Mark Deluzio



Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined



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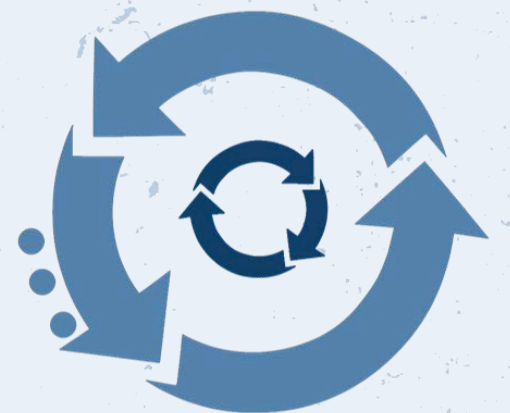
“

The real purpose of **kanban** is
to **eliminate the kanban.**

”

The challenge is to develop a **learning organization** that
will find ways to reduce the number of kanban and
thereby reduce and finally eliminate the inventory buffer.

Jeffrey Liker



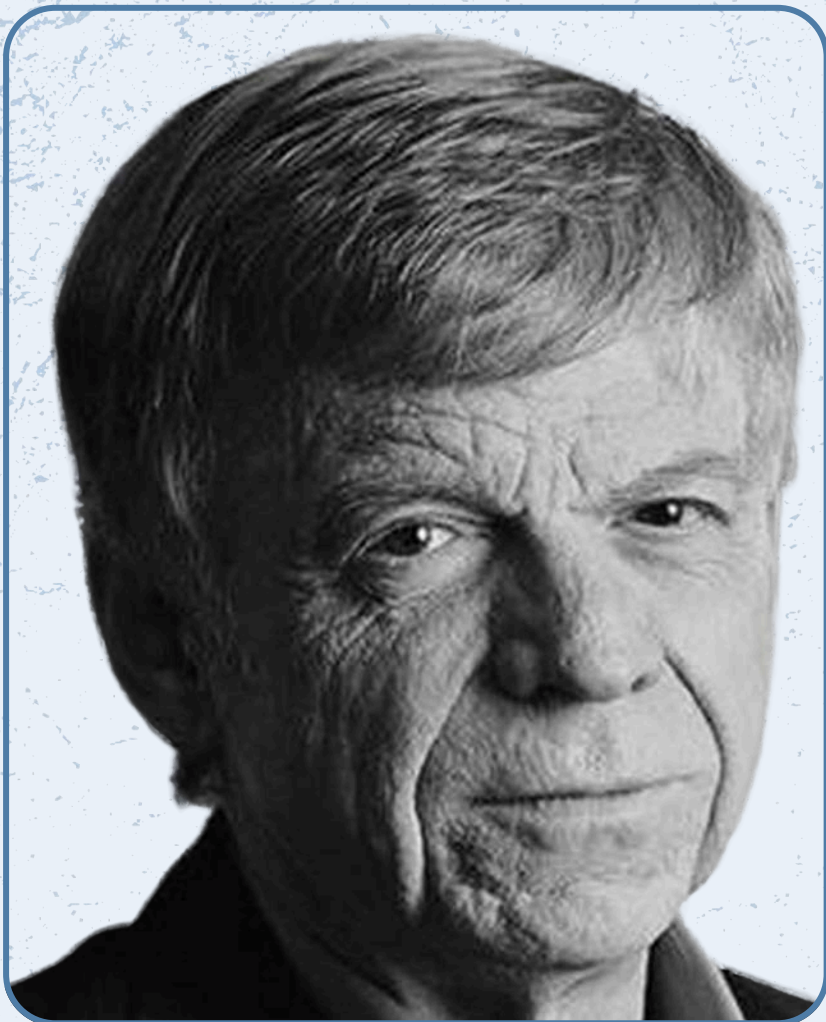
Source: LIKER, JEFFREY K. TOYOTA WAY



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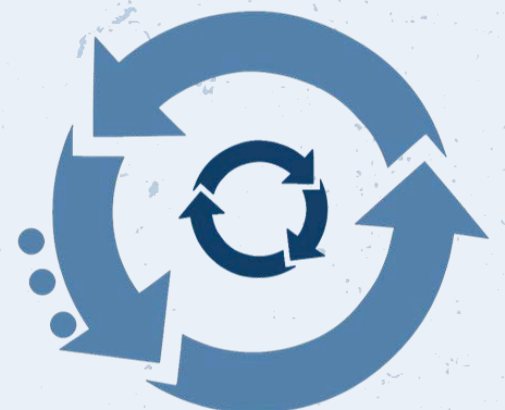


John Kotter

“

The Central issue is never strategy, structure, culture, or systems. The core of the matter is always about changing the behavior of people.

”



Source: Tracey and Ernie Richardson. The Toyota Engagement Equation



“

**Lean principles apply
regardless of what kind of
business you are in.**

”

Mark Deluzio

Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined



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“ The three Ms: **muda** (waste), **mura** (unevenness), and **muri** (overburden).

Eliminate all three to get to true flow.

”

Jeffrey Liker

Source: LIKER, JEFFREY K. TOYOTA WAY



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“ The Lean basics are not exciting but they will get you further faster... than if you had tried to introduce the next “silver bullet.” ”

Mark Deluzio



Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined



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“

**There are no limitations to
where kaizen can be applied**

Any type of business or organization in any industry can
benefit from kaizen.

”

Bob Emilliani



Source: Emiliani, Bob; Yoshino, Katsusaburo; Go, Rudy. Kaizen Forever: Teachings of Chihiro Nakao



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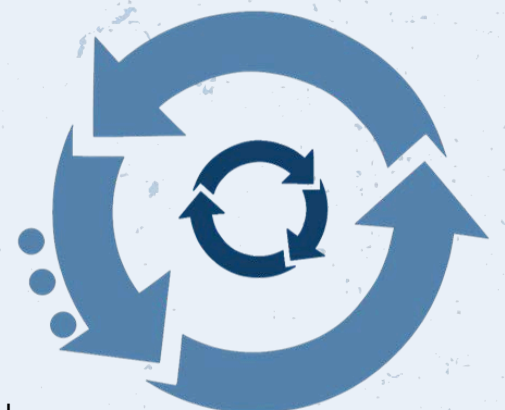
Chihiro Nakao

“

**Kaizen means taking
action; go to the genba
now, deal with the
facts now.**

**Always take action;
that is the key.**

”



Source: Emiliani, Bob; Yoshino, Katsusaburo; Go, Rudy. Kaizen Forever: Teachings of Chihiro Nakao

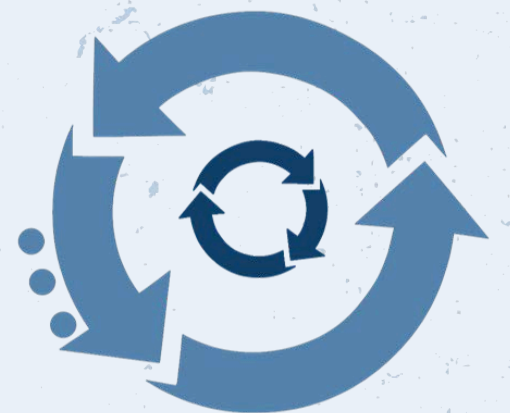


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“ Leaders must have **tolerance** for allowing employees to make mistakes, always focusing on the process and **not the individual.** ”

Mark Deluzio



Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined



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“

**It does not make sense to
reduce costs and simultaneously
introduce trade-offs that have
negative effects on employees,
suppliers, customers, investors,
or communities.**

”

Bob Emilliani



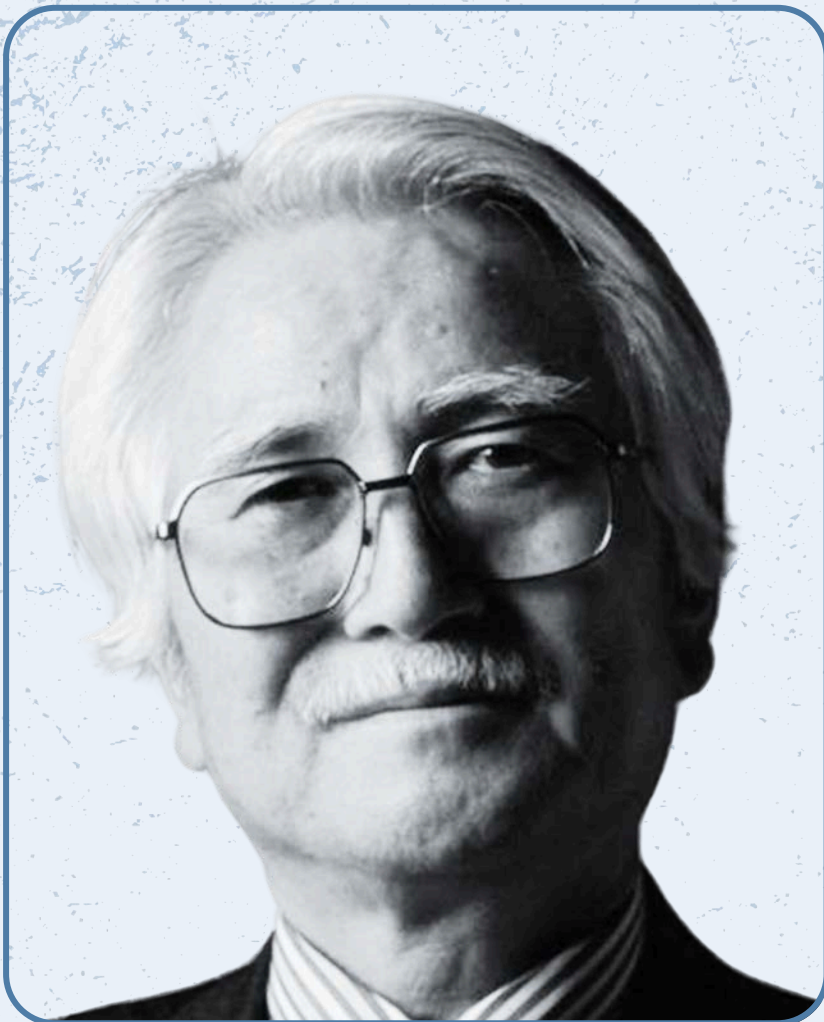
Source: Emilliani, Bob; Yoshino, Katsusaburo; Go, Rudy. Kaizen Forever: Teachings of Chihiro Nakao



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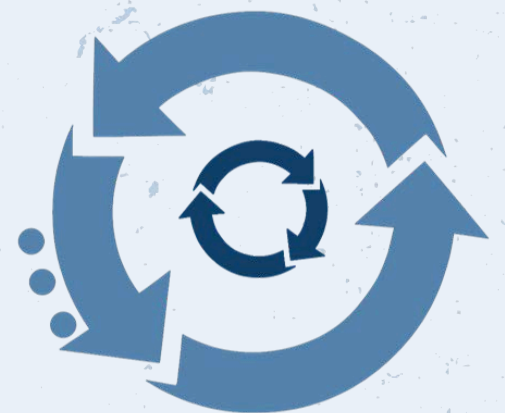
“



Masaaki Imai

**Kaizen without
a target would
resemble a trip
without a
destination.**

”



Source: Imai, M. (2012). Gemba kaizen



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“

**One must standardize, and
thus stabilize the process
before continuous
improvements can be made.**

”

Jeffrey Liker

Source: LIKER, JEFFREY K. TOYOTA WAY



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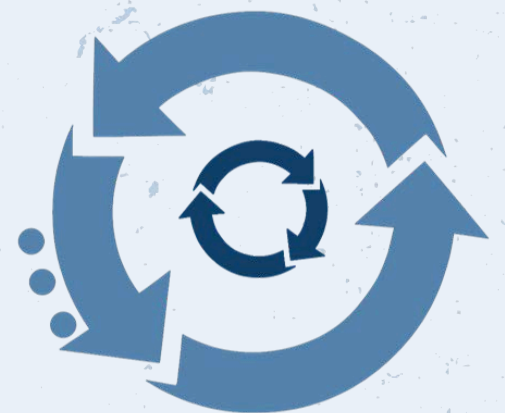
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“

Studies prove that the more employees are involved in kaizen events, the more satisfied they are with their jobs.

”

Mark Deluzio



Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined



KAIZEN MADE EASY

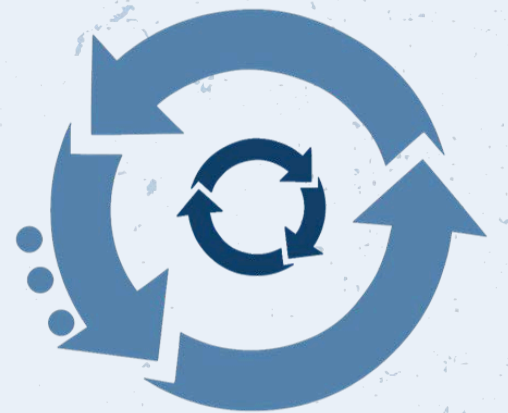
Learn • Collaborate • Improve

“

Standardized work is the basis for empowering workers, sharing ideas for improvement, and driving innovation in the workplace.

”

Jeffrey Liker



Source: LIKER, JEFFREY K. TOYOTA WAY



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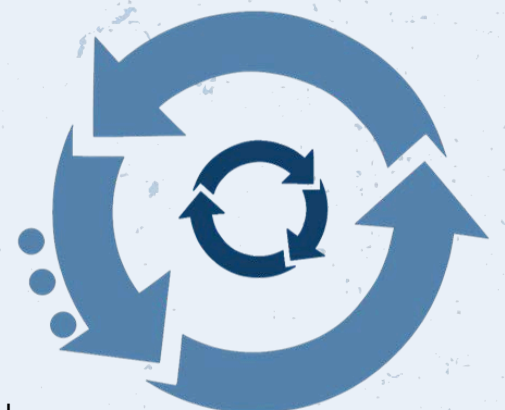
Learn • Collaborate • Improve

“

.... there is no such thing as
a "**perfect process**,"
just as there is no such
thing as
the "**perfect person**."

”

Bob Emilliani



Source: Emiliani, Bob; Yoshino, Katsusaburo; Go, Rudy. Kaizen Forever: Teachings of Chihiro Nakao



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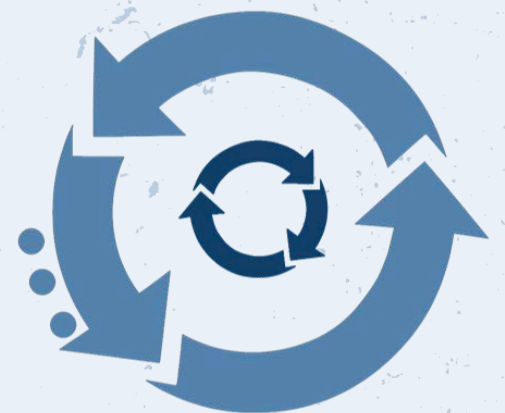


Taiichi Ohno

“

Having **no problem**
is the **biggest**
problem of All

”



Source: Tracey and Ernie Richardson. The Toyota Engagement Equation



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“

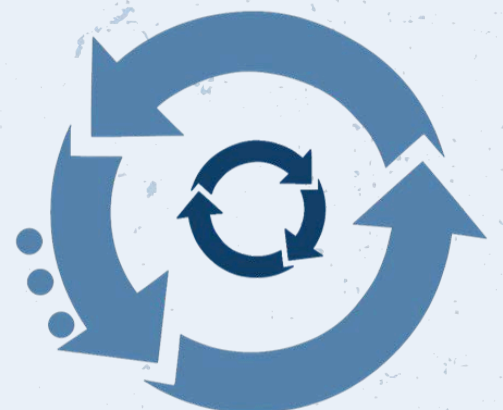
**Becoming satisfied with the way
things are is the first step
backward**

”

**I am
Perfect**



Jon Miller



Source: Tracey and Ernie Richardson. The Toyota Engagement Equation



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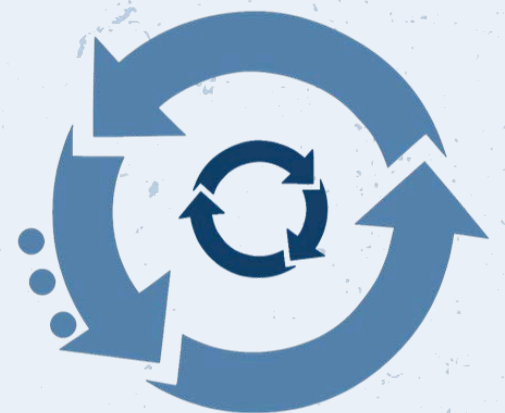
Learn • Collaborate • Improve

“

**People must be allowed to
think and participate in the
improvement of
their own work**

”

Bob Emilliani



Source: Emiliani, Bob; Yoshino, Katsusaburo; Go, Rudy. Kaizen Forever



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“

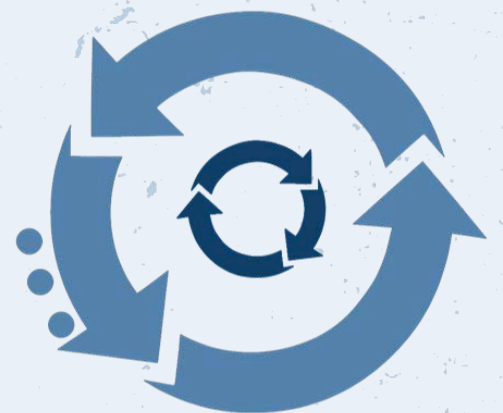
LESS
is
MORE
when it comes to
VISUAL MANAGEMENT

”

John Drogosz



Source: Lean Enterprise Institute



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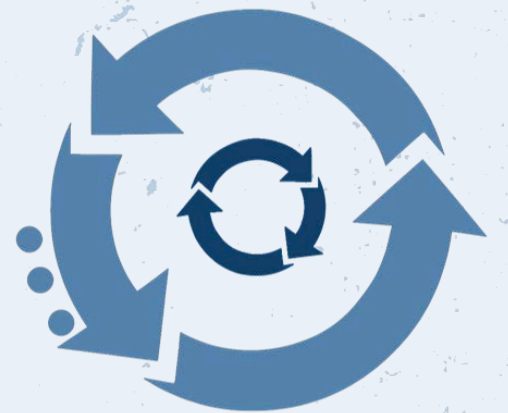
“

**Stop production so that
production never has
to stop**

It is OK to stop production to ferret out the root causes of defects

”

Toyota Proverb



Source: DennisPascal. Lean Production Simplified Second Edition. Productivity press, n.d.



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“

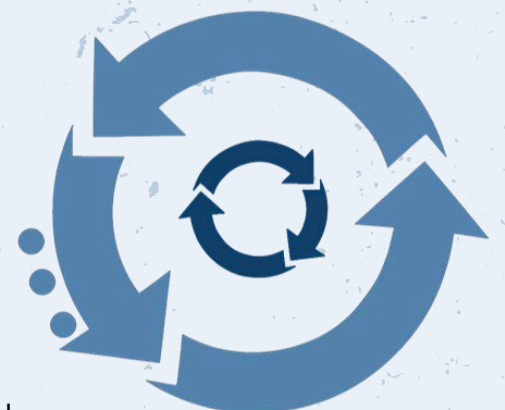
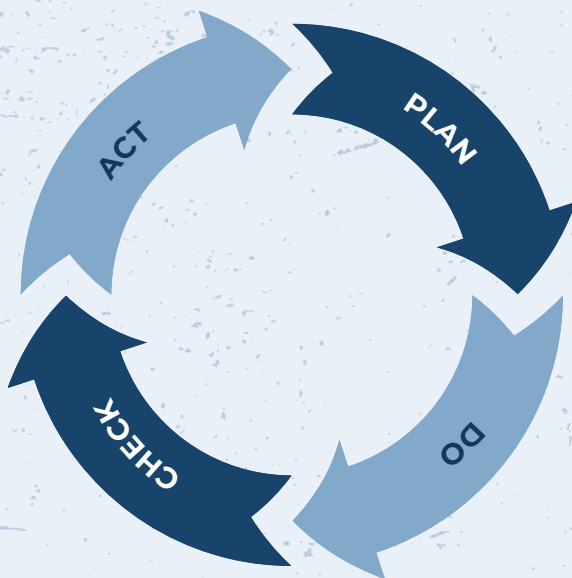
.. **KAIZEN**

must be understood as a series of activities
pursuing future conditions of what should be in

**a never-ending cycle of new
attempts to improve processes.**

”

Bob Emilliani



Source: Emilliani, Bob; Yoshino, Katsusaburo; Go, Rudy. Kaizen Forever: Teachings of Chihiro Nakao



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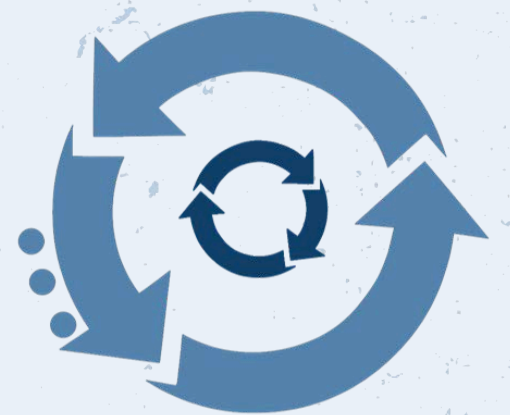
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“

FIND THAT BALANCE
between providing employees with
rigid procedures to follow and
providing the **freedom to innovate and**
to be creative

”

Jeffrey Liker



Source: LIKER, JEFFREY K. TOYOTA WAY



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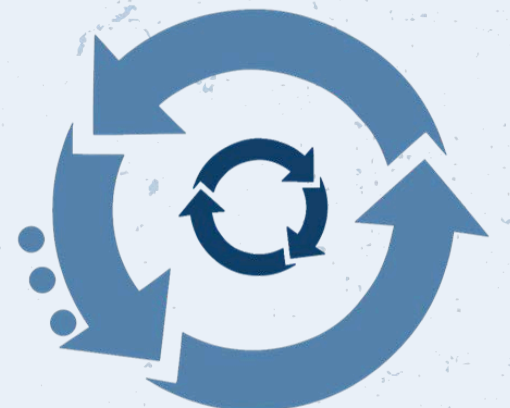
“

STOP PRODUCTION
so that Production **NEVER** has to stop

It is OK to stop production to ferret out the root
causes of defects

”

Toyota Proverb



Source: Dennis Pascal. Lean Production Simplified Second Edition. Productivity press



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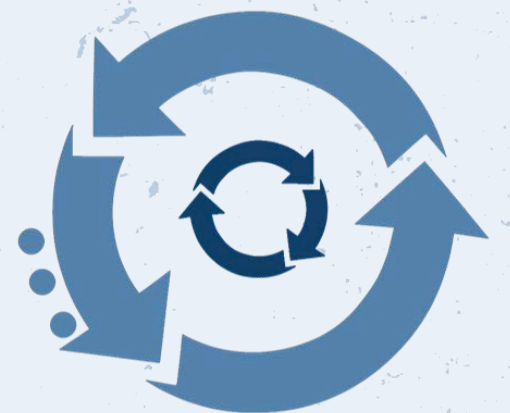
“



Akio Toyoda

We never **run away
from our problems or
pretend we don't notice
them.**

”



Source: Full text of Toyota President Akio Toyoda's testimony. U.S.



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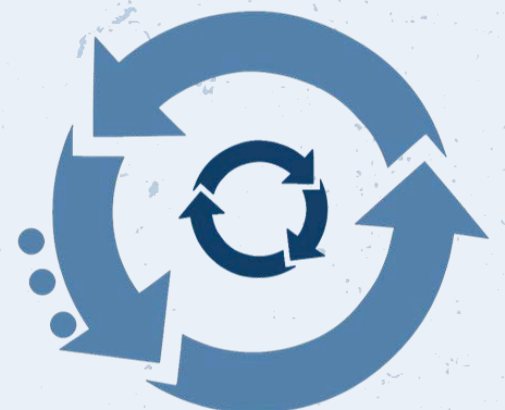
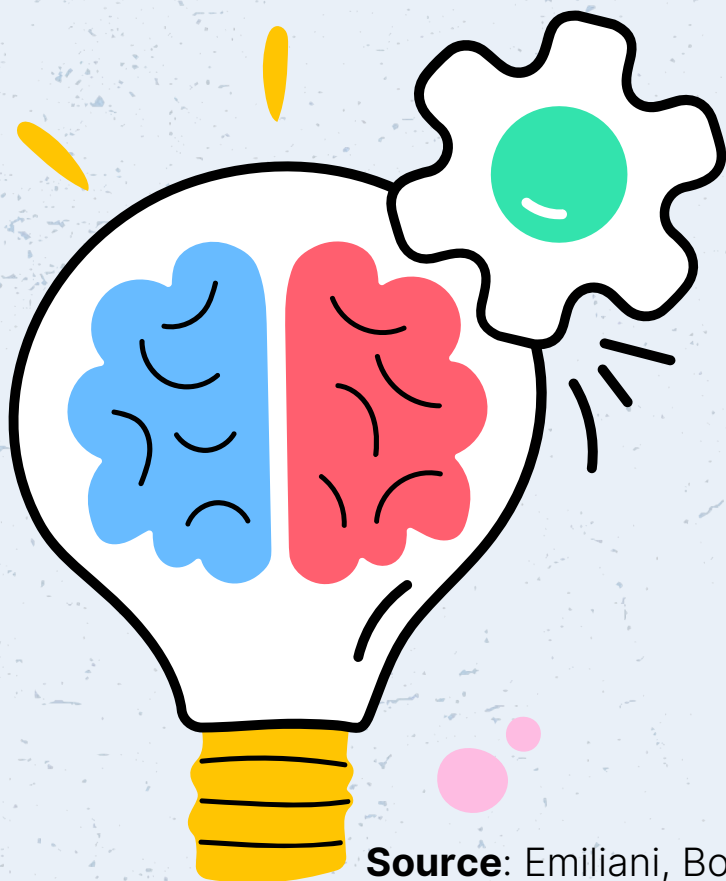
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“

KAIZEN develops human
capabilities and is the process
that converts the words
“**RESPECT FOR HUMANITY**”
into reality.

”

Bob Emilliani



Source: Emilliani, Bob; Yoshino, Katsusaburo; Go, Rudy. Kaizen Forever: Teachings of Chihiro Nakao



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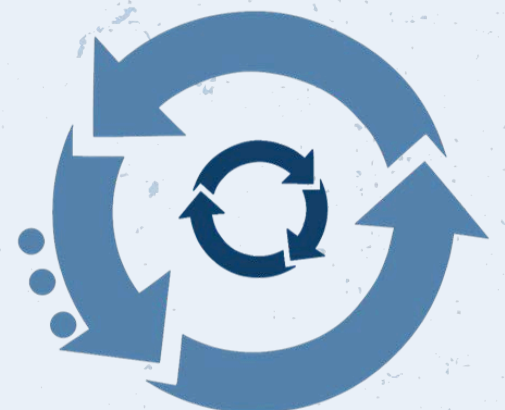
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“

Standards are not there
mainly to maintain
but as a
basis for improvement.

”

Jon Miller



Source: Tracey and Ernie Richardson. The Toyota Engagement Equation



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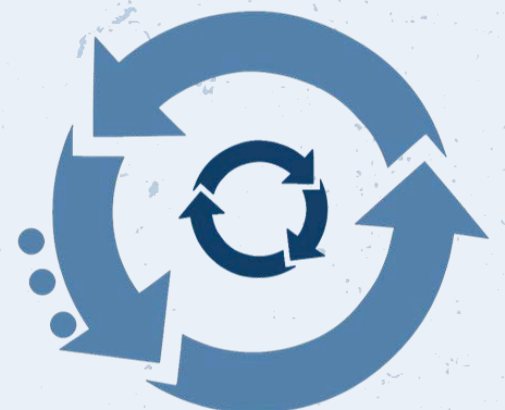
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“

Managers must not fire people
as a result of KAIZEN.

”

Bob Emilliani



Source: Emiliani, Bob; Yoshino, Katsusaburo; Go, Rudy. Kaizen Forever: Teachings of Chihiro Nakao



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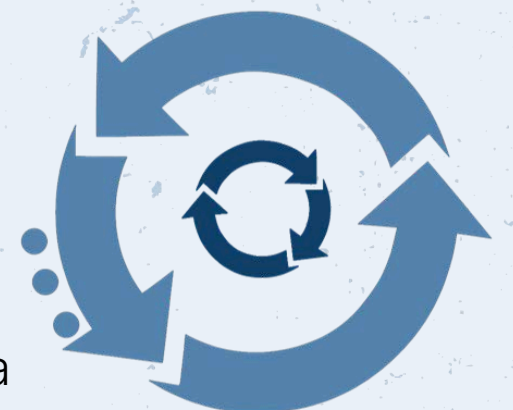
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“ A standard is **not the platform** on
which you stand, but
a step on the ladder
before the next one you take ”

Jon Miller



Source: Tracey and Ernie Richardson. The Toyota
Engagement Equation



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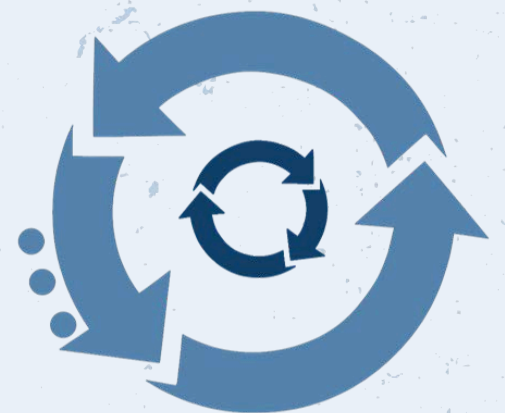
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“

**The standardized work must be
specific enough to be a useful
guide, yet general enough to
allow for some flexibility.**

”

Jeffrey Liker



Source: LIKER, JEFFREY K. TOYOTA WAY: 14 Management Principles



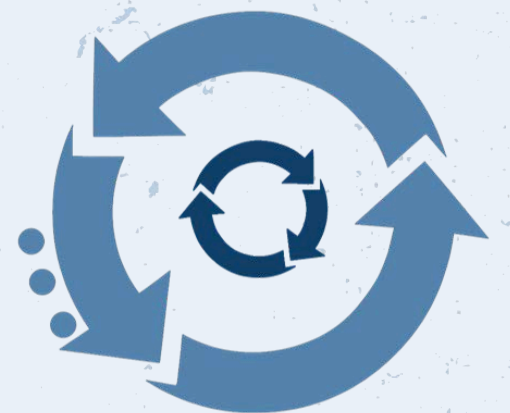
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Akio Toyoda

“ **"Each employee thinks about what he or she should do, continuously making improvements, and by doing so, makes even better cars."** ”



Source: (2010, February 24). Full text of Toyota President Akio Toyoda's testimony. U.S.



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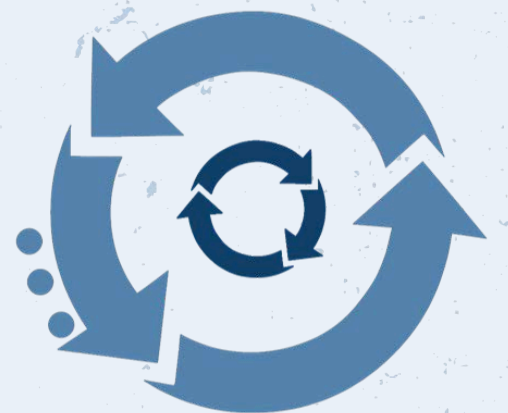


Deming, W. Edwards

“

**People are entitled
to joy in work.**

”



Source: deming.org/quotes



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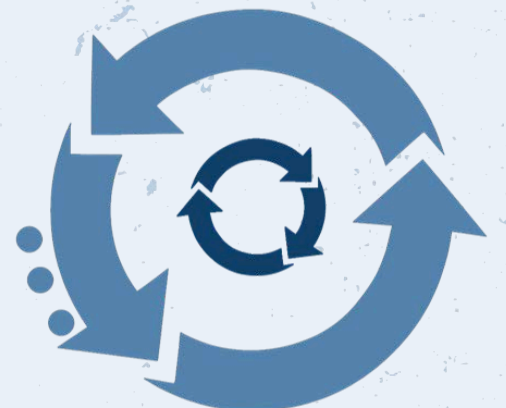
Learn • Collaborate • Improve

“

**The maniacal focus on cost
alone has derailed many
improvement initiatives.**

”

Mark Deluzio



Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined why lean transformations fail and what to do about it.



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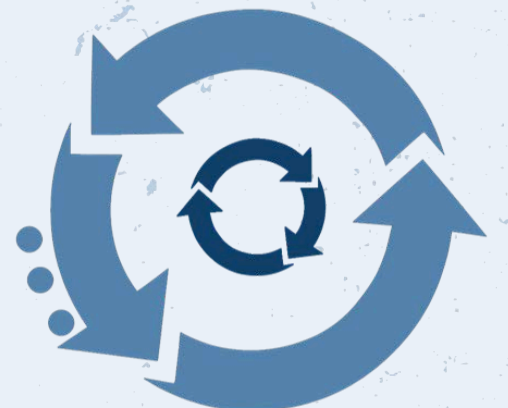
“

No matter how good our results look, **there**
is still waste hidden in our processes, and
we can never afford to stop looking for
continuous improvement opportunities.

”



Tracey & Ernie Richardson



Source: Richardson, Tracey S., and Ernie Richardson. The Toyota Engagement Equation



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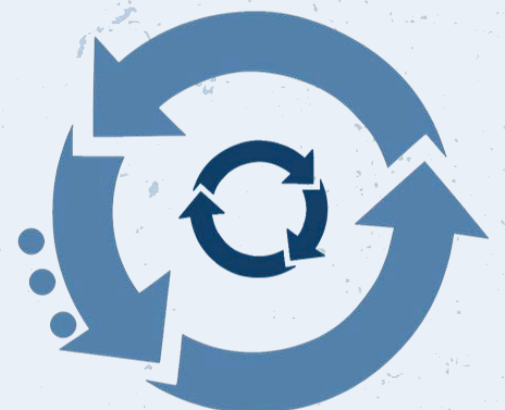
“

Six Sigma is a statistical problem-solving process that fits under the Lean umbrella.

Rather than competing with Lean, it should sit alongside all of the other tools in the Lean toolbox.

”

Mark Deluzio



Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined why lean transformations fail and what to do about it.



KAIZEN MADE EASY

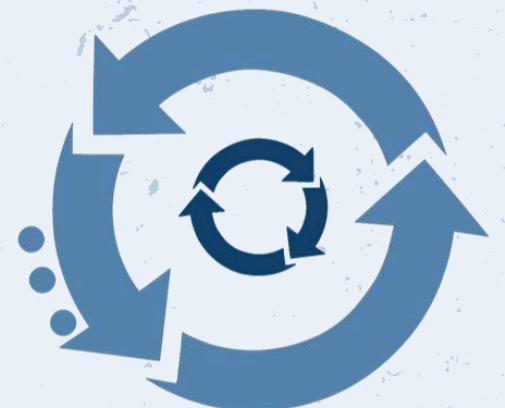
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“

**The people doing the work are
in the best position
to improve the standardized
work.**

”

Jeffrey Liker



Source: LIKER, JEFFREY K. TOYOTA WAY: 14 Management Principles



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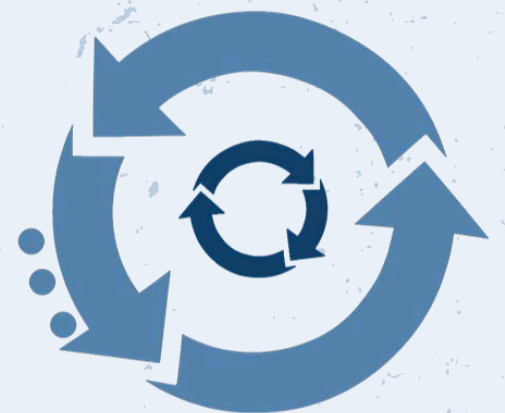
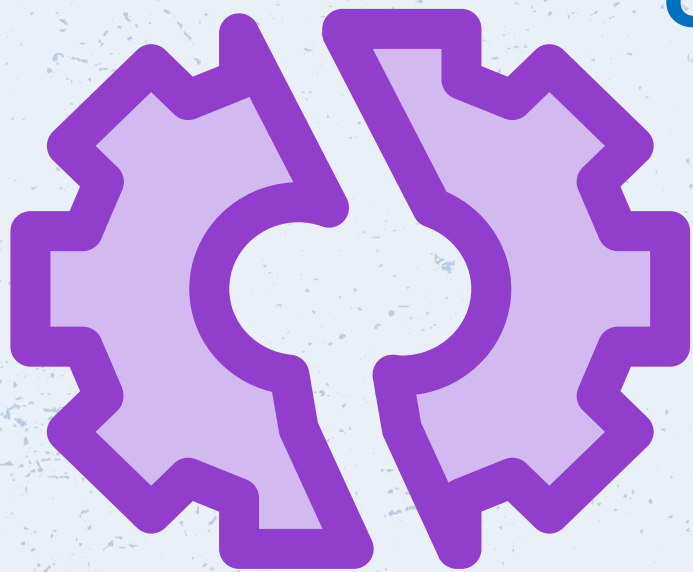
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“

**Standardized work can be an
ugly thing in the hands of control-
oriented bureaucrats and
a beautiful thing when it enables
creativity and continuous
improvement.**

”

Jeffrey Liker



Source: LIKER, JEFFREY K. TOYOTA WAY: 14 Management Principles



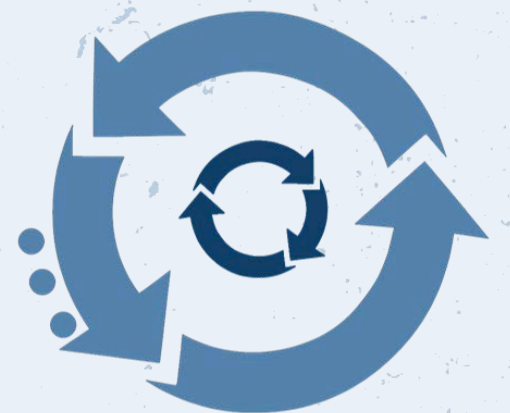
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Deming, W. Edwards

“
**The aim of leadership
is ... to remove the
causes of failure:
to help people to do a
better job with less
effort.**
”



Source: deming.org/quotes



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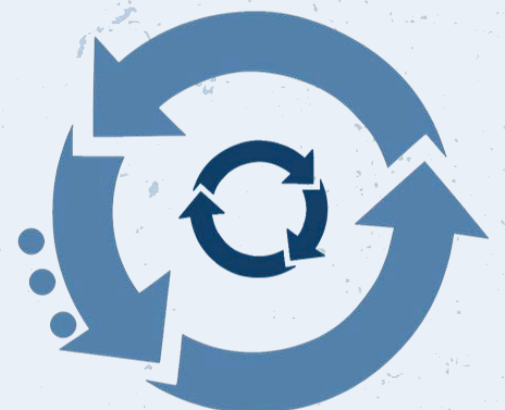
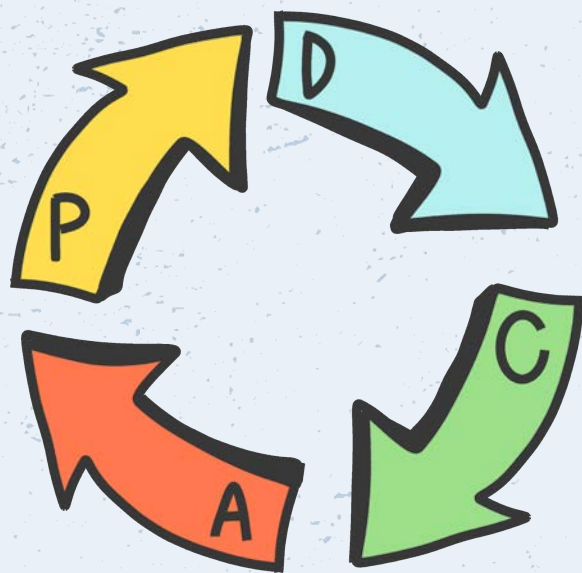
“

**“Don’t let perfect get in the
way of better”**

is what Lean practitioners need to keep
in mind.

”

Mark Deluzio



Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined why lean transformations fail and what to do about it.



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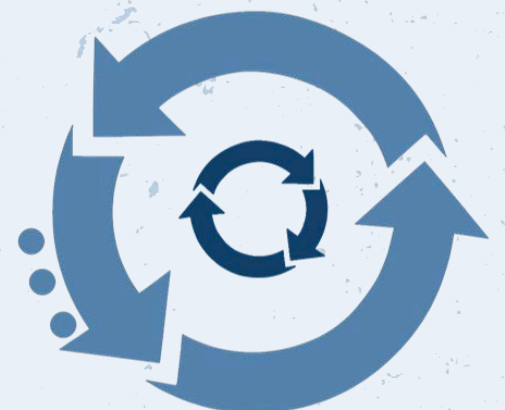
Deming, W. Edwards

“

**A system must
have an aim.**

**Without an aim,
there is no system.**

”

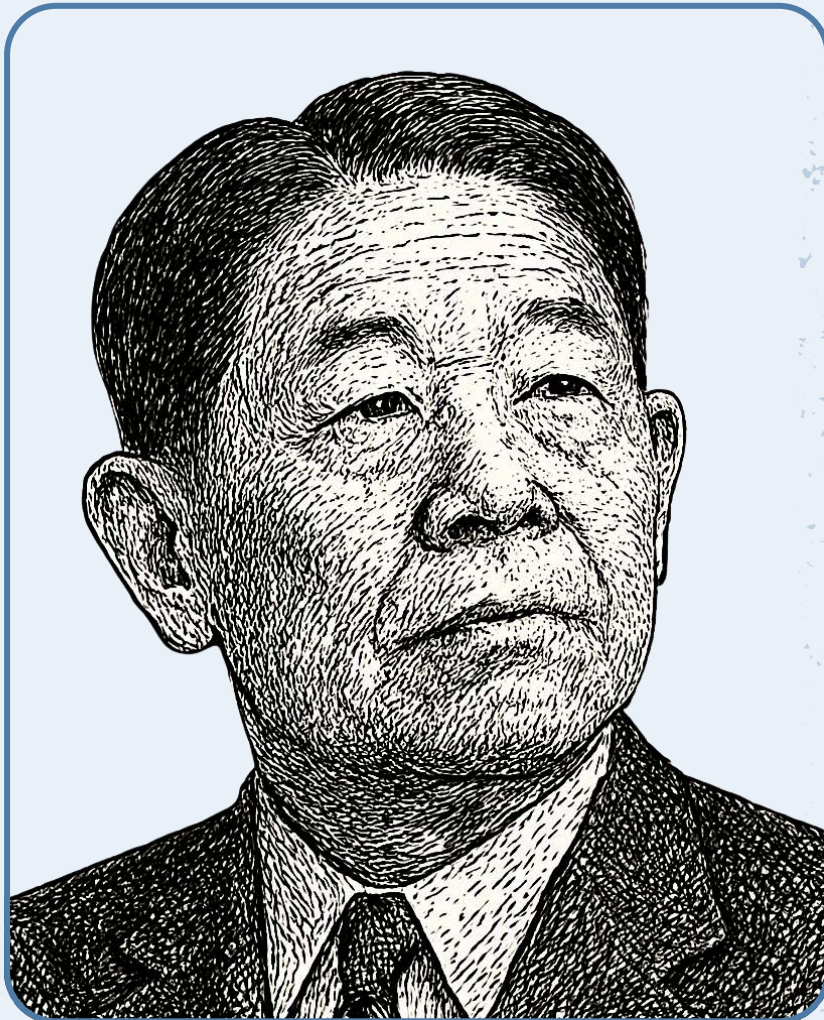


Source: deming.org/quotes



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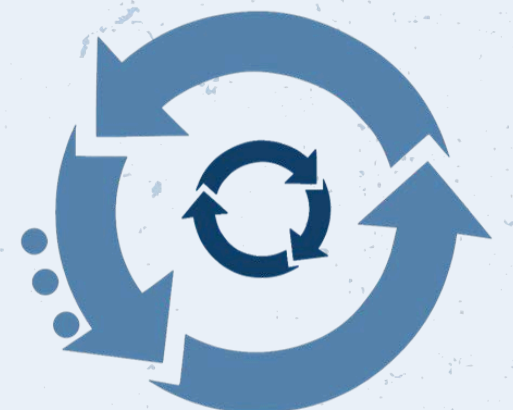


Shigeo Shingo

“

**Expressing
problems in a
concrete and clear
way make an
effective shortcut
to discovering
solutions**

”



Source: Shingo, S. and Dillon, The Sayings Of Shigeo Shingo



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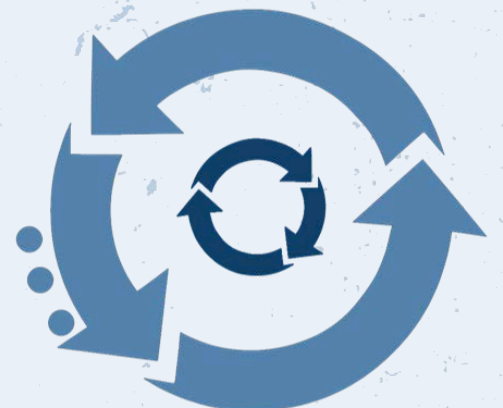
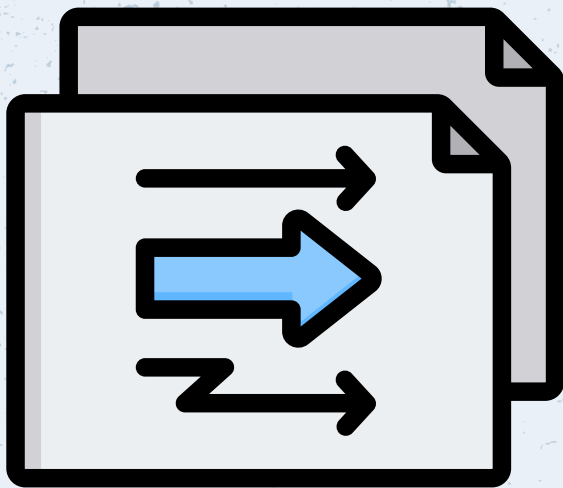
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“

If I were called in to give the
stamp of approval on a Lean
plan, I couldn't do it if it
incorporated **any form of a
push system.**

”

Mark Deluzio



Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined why lean transformations fail and what to do about it.



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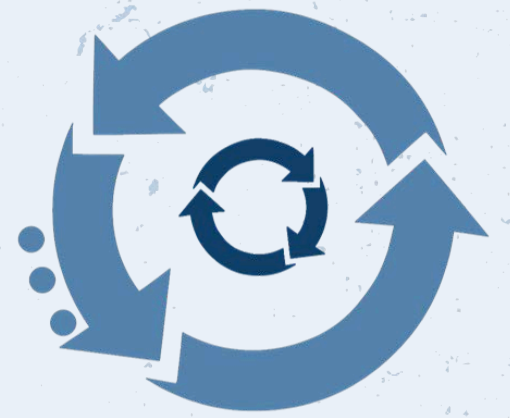
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“

People always need to feel challenged, and to even be pushed a little so that they will step outside of their comfort zone.

”

Tracey & Ernie Richardson



Source: Richardson, Tracey S., and Ernie Richardson. The Toyota Engagement Equation



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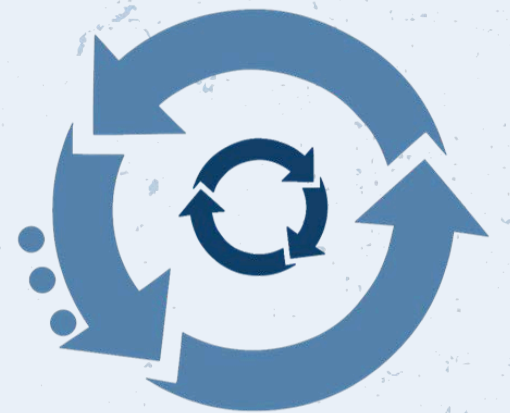
“

**Lean manufacturing
dramatically increases the
importance of building things
right the first time.**

With very low levels of inventory, there is little buffer to fall back on in case there is a quality problem.

”

Jeffrey Liker



Source: LIKER, JEFFREY K. TOYOTA WAY: 14 Management Principles



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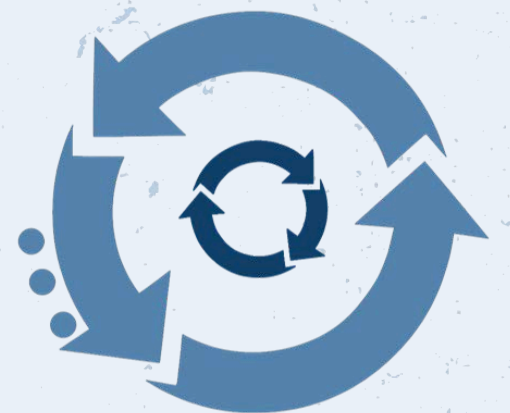
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Deming, W. Edwards

“
**Money and time
spent for training
will be ineffective
unless inhibitors to
good work are
removed.**
”

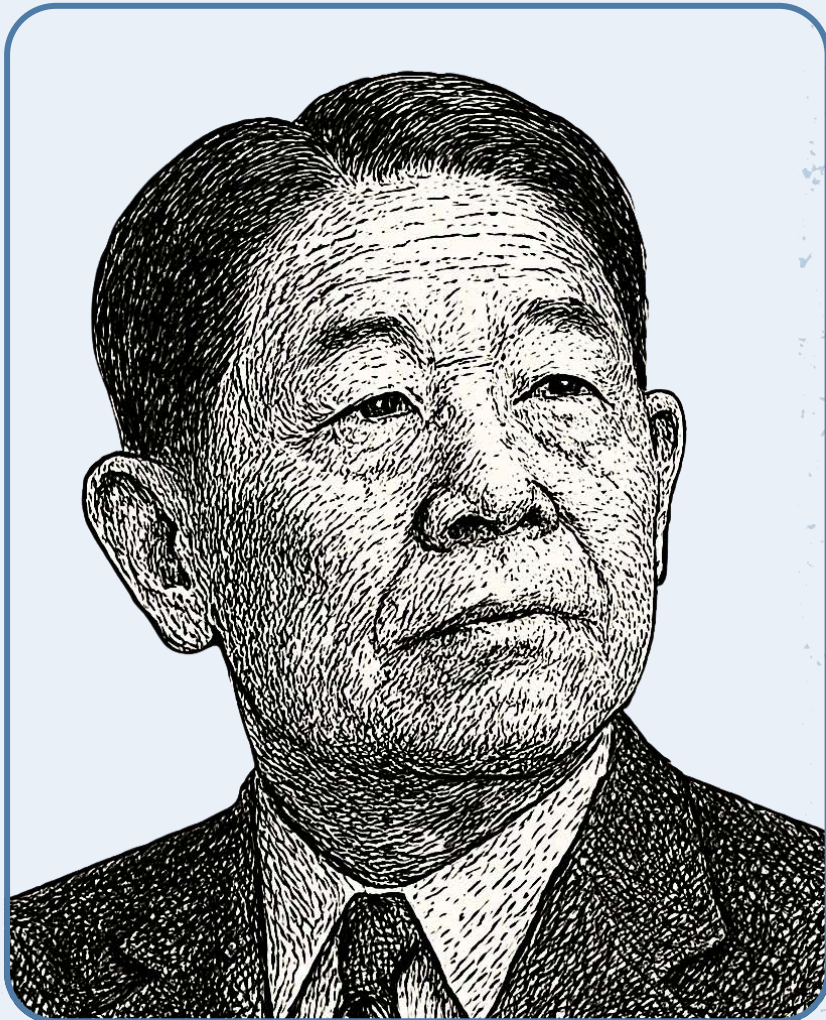


Source: deming.org/quotes



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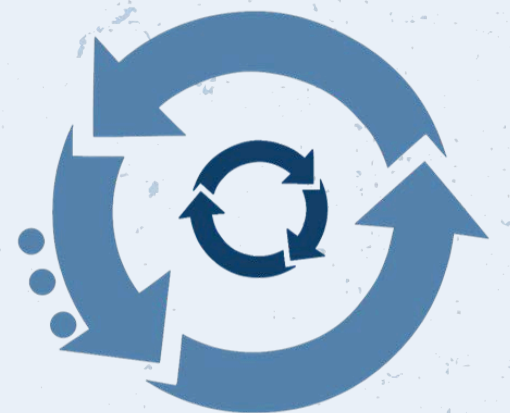


Shigeo Shingo

“

It is surprising how easily we can **uncover the causes of problems** starting with a clean state and **rethinking each premise**

”



Source: Shingo, S. and Dillon, The Sayings Of Shigeo Shingo



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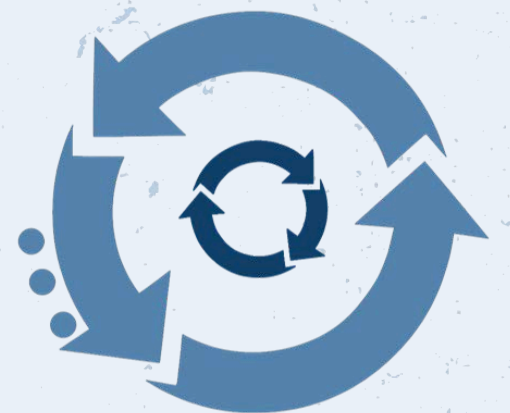
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Chihiro Nakao

“
If you do not
understand
standard work, you
do not understand
the Toyota
Production System
”



Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined why lean transformations fail and what to do about it.



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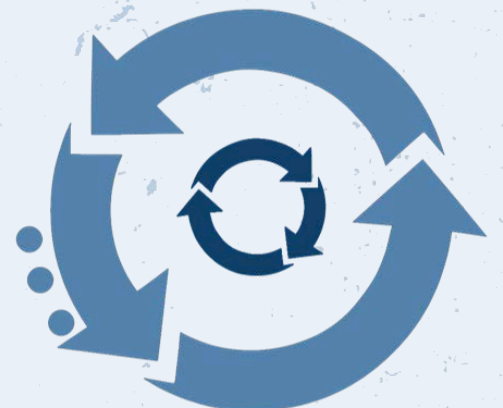
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“

**... the minute you quit
learning is the minute your
value starts **going down.****

”

Tracey & Ernie Richardson



Source: Richardson, Tracey S., and Ernie Richardson. The Toyota Engagement Equation



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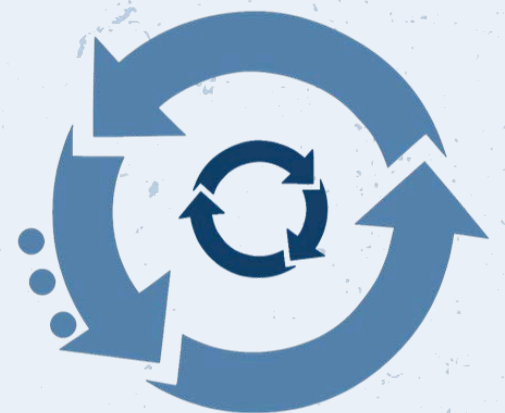
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Deming, W. Edwards

**“ Top management
should publish a
resolution that no
one **will lose his job**
for contribution to
quality and
productivity.**

”



Source: deming.org/quotes



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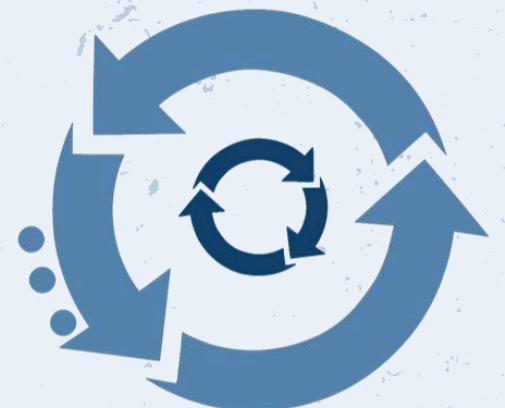
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“

**kaizen is a
healthy dissatisfaction
with the status quo.**

”

Mark Deluzio



Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined why lean transformations fail and what to do about it.



KAIZEN MADE EASY

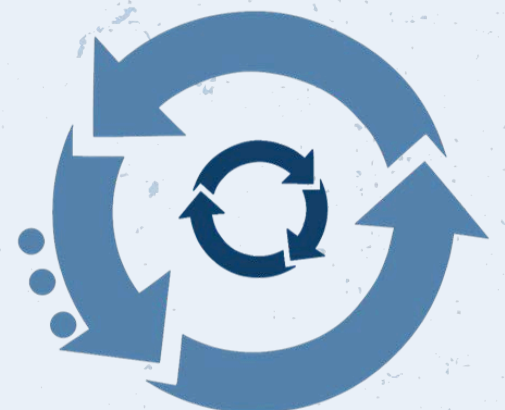
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“

**The customer is the
final arbiter of how
good a job the
company is doing.**

”

Jeffrey Liker

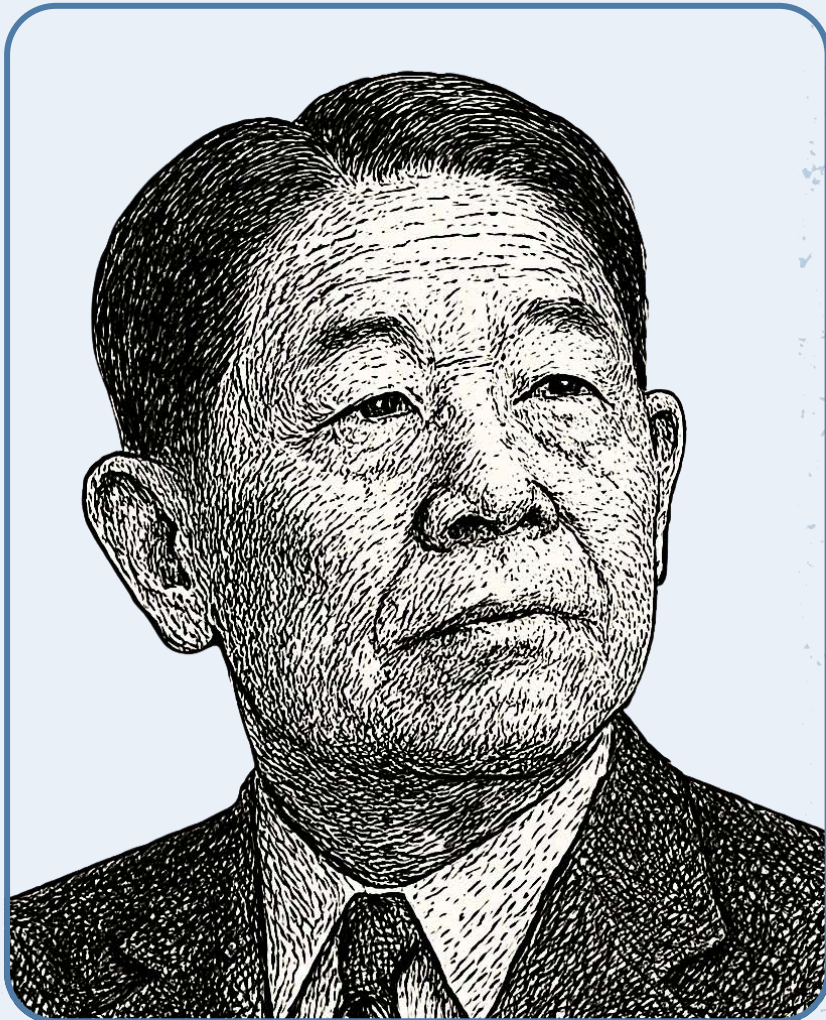


Source: LIKER, JEFFREY K. TOYOTA WAY: 14 Management Principles



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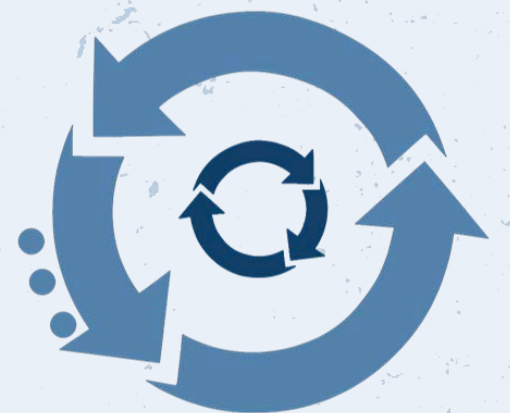
Shigeo Shingo

“

**It's the easiest thing
in the world to argue
logically that
something is
impossible.**

Much more difficult is to ask how
something might be
accomplished

”



Source: Shingo, S. and Dillon, The Sayings Of Shigeo Shingo



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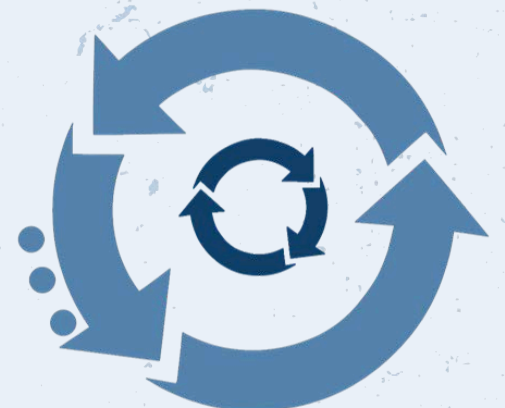
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“

kaizen dictates that even
though we will **always strive**
for perfection, we will **never**
reach a perfect state.

”

Mark Deluzio



Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined why lean transformations fail and what to do about it.



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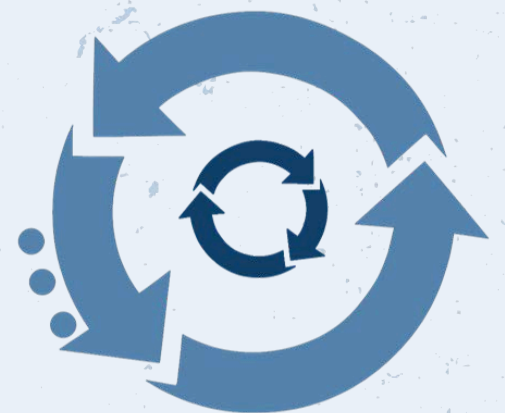
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“

**The voice of the
customer must be
driven through every
process from design
to manufacturing.**

”

Jeffrey Liker



Source: LIKER, JEFFREY K. TOYOTA WAY: 14 Management Principles



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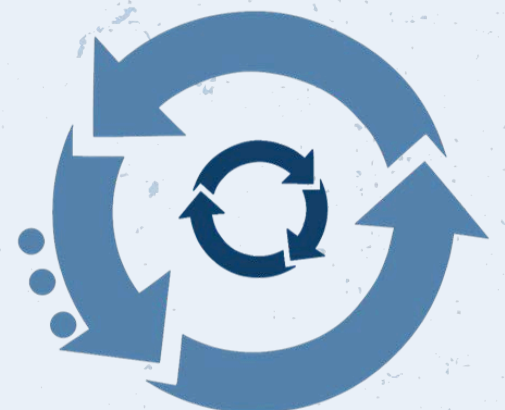


Deming, W. Edwards

“

Where there is
fear you do not
get honest
figures.

”



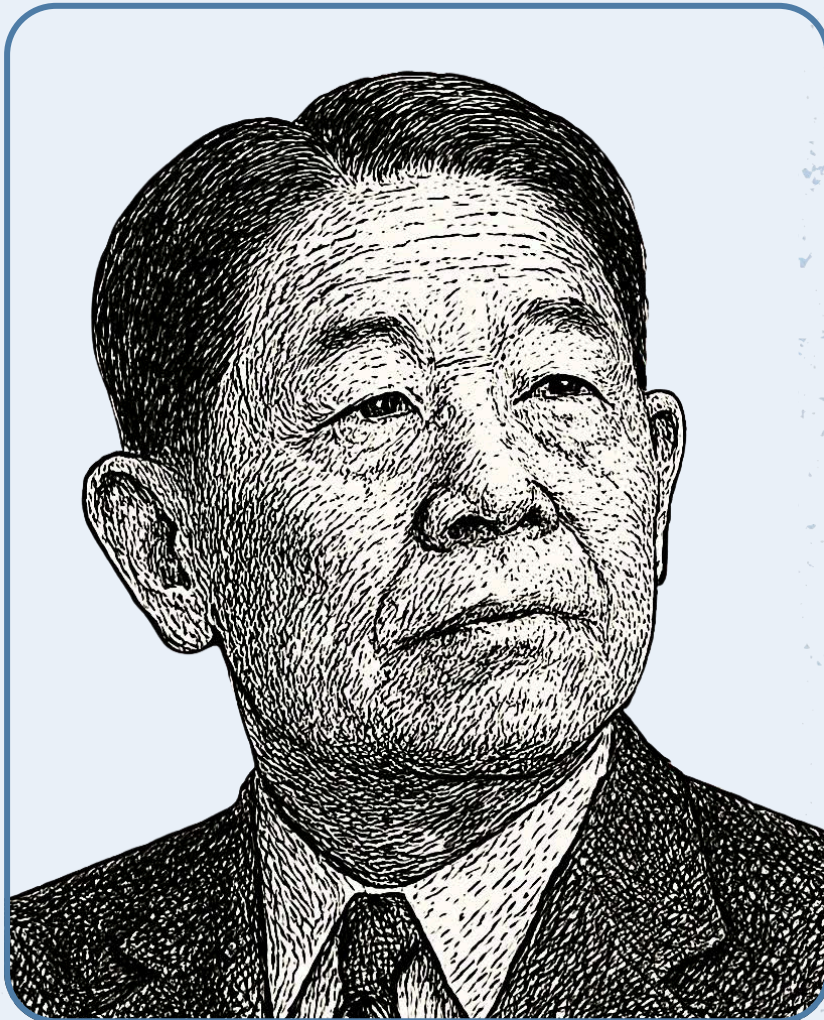
Source: deming.org/quotes



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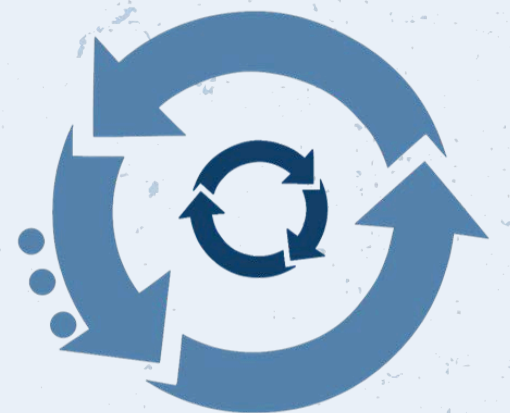
“



Shigeo Shingo

**The Same as
Yesterday
Isn't Good
Enough**

”



Source: Shingo, S. and Dillon, The Sayings Of Shigeo Shingo



KAIZEN MADE EASY

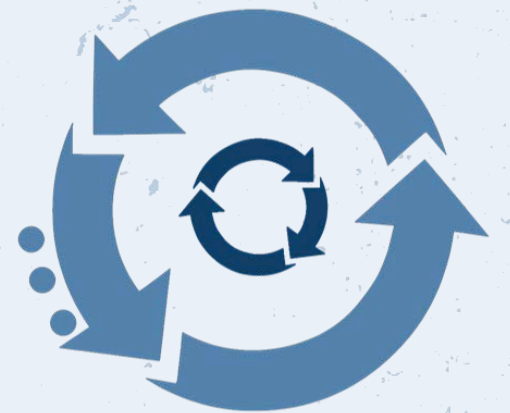
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“

When we say “everybody matters,” we really mean it, and we never give up on people and their development.

”

Tracey & Ernie Richardson



Source: Richardson, Tracey S., and Ernie Richardson. The Toyota Engagement Equation



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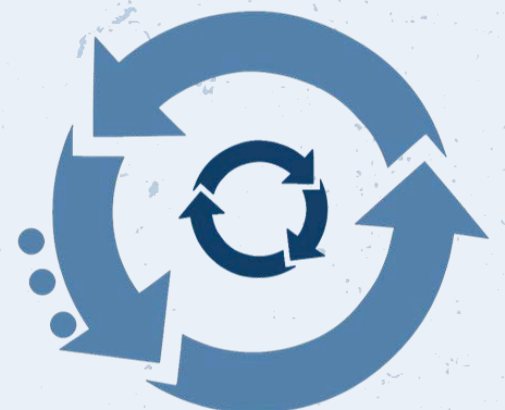
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“

**Visual control at the worksite
should make it clear at a glance
what the standard is and if
anything is out of standard.**

”

Jeffrey Liker



Source: LIKER, JEFFREY K. TOYOTA WAY: 14 Management Principles



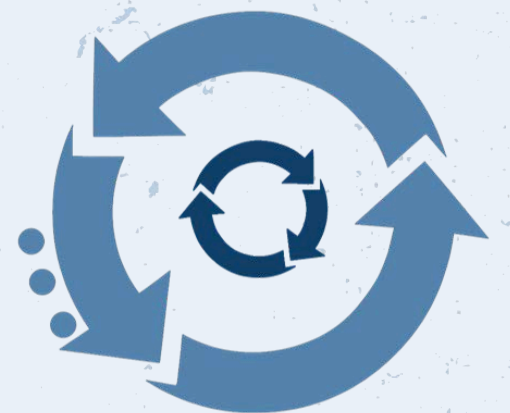
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Deming, W. Edwards

“ A company could put a
**top man at every
position** and be
swallowed by a
competitor with people
only half as good, but
who are working
together. ”



Source: deming.org/quotes



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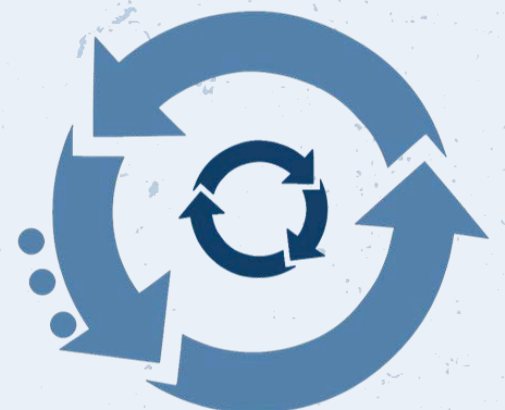


Taiichi Ohno

“

**When the problem is
clearly understood,
improvement is
possible.**

”

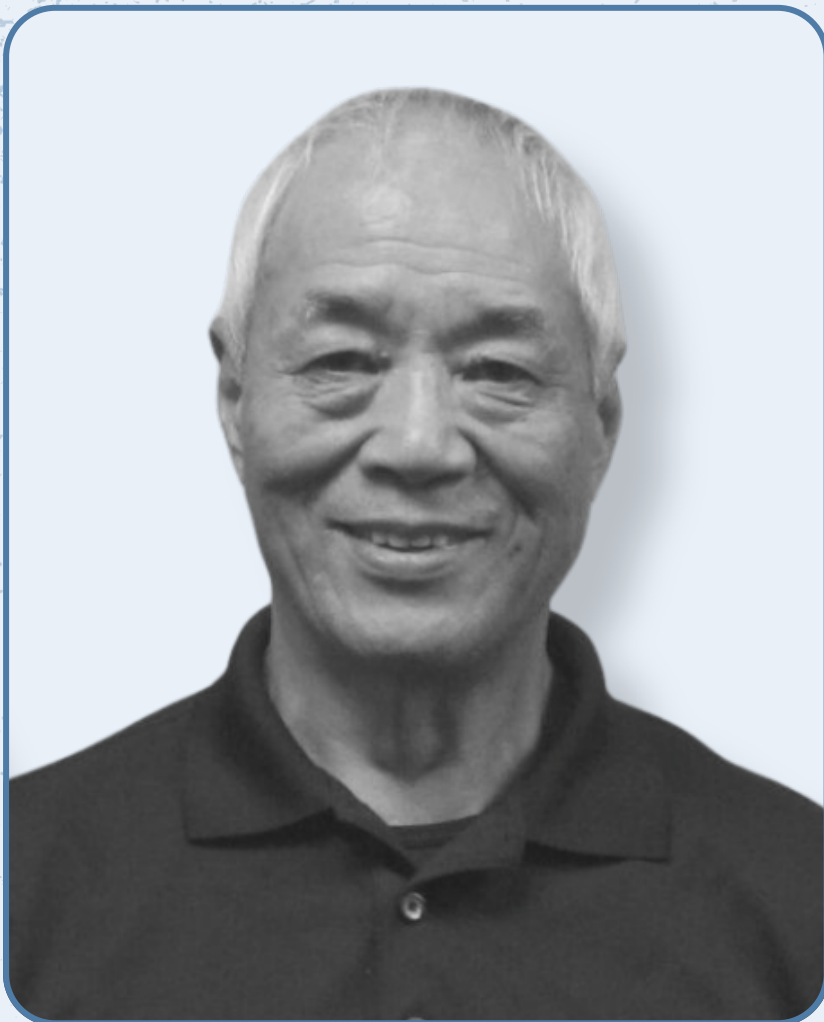


Source: Ohno, T. Toyota production system: Beyond large-scale production. Productivity Press.



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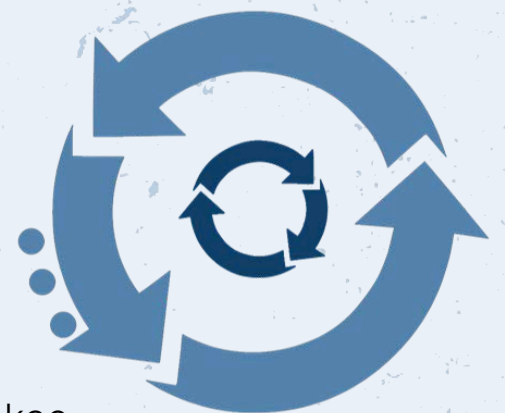
Chihiro Nakao

“

**To make good
product, you have to
make good people.**

Because good people do not
always make good products,
kaizen is necessary. In this way,
both people and product
improve.

”



Source: Emiliani, Bob; Yoshino, Katsusaburo; Go, Rudy. Kaizen Forever: Teachings of Chihiro Nakao



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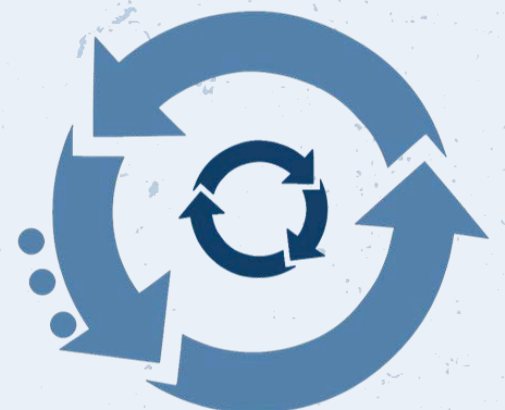
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“

**Robust, high-performing
daily management systems
are **fundamental** to the
success of **strategy**
deployment.**

”

Mark Deluzio



Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined why lean transformations fail and what to do about it.

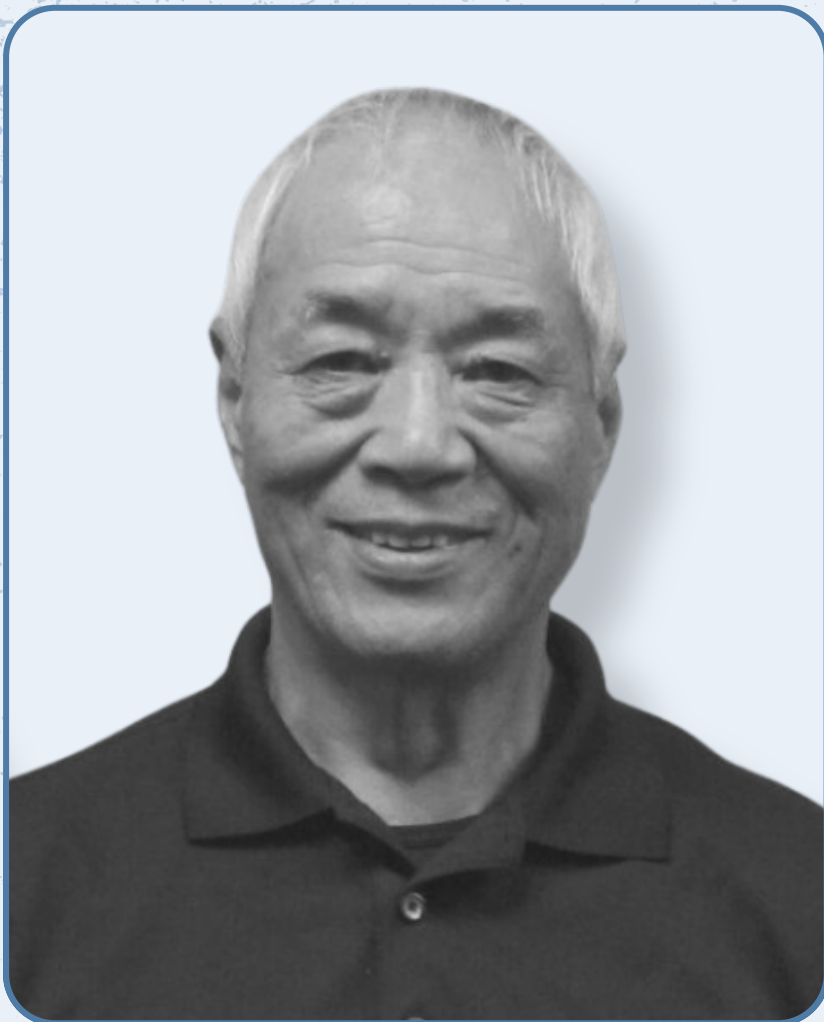


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“

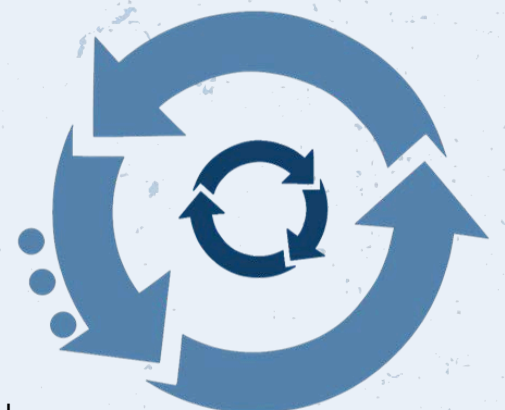


Chihiro Nakao

**Be respectful of
others.**

**Respect humanity.
People are central.**

”



Source: Emiliani, Bob; Yoshino, Katsusaburo; Go, Rudy. Kaizen Forever: Teachings of Chihiro Nakao



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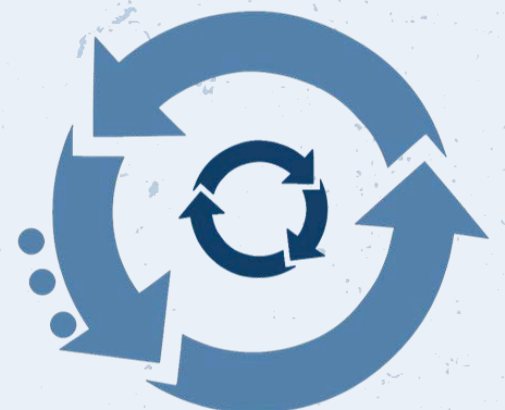
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“

**You can make a lot of money...
But the legacy that you leave
is the impact you have on
people. Money can't buy the
kind of satisfaction that this
brings.**

”

Tracey & Ernie Richardson



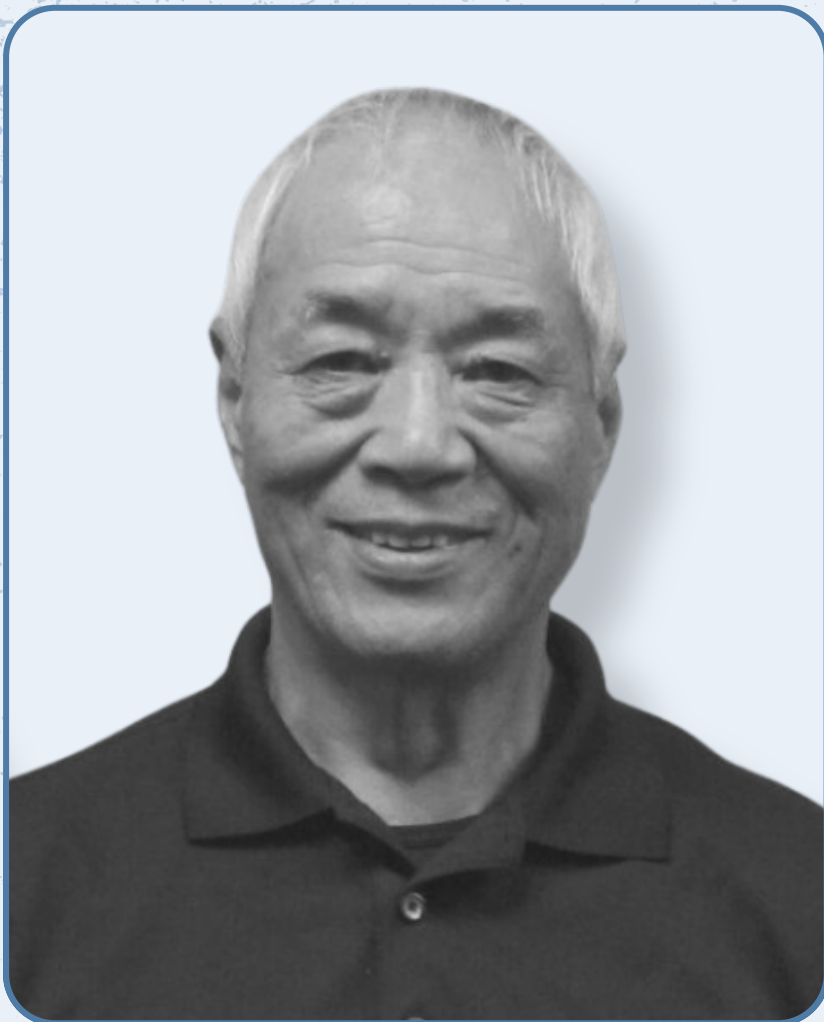
Source: Richardson, Tracey S., and Ernie Richardson. The Toyota Engagement Equation



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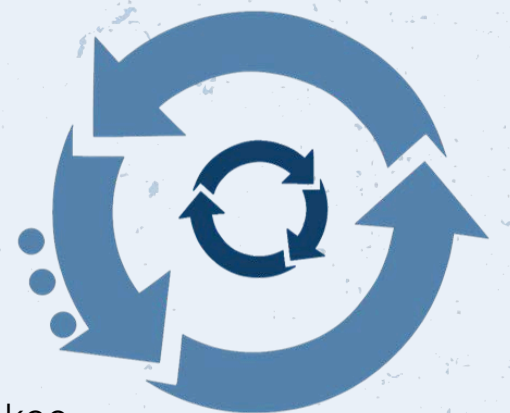
“



Chihiro Nakao

Respect
operators by
eliminating
their burdens.

”



Source: Emiliani, Bob; Yoshino, Katsusaburo; Go, Rudy. Kaizen Forever: Teachings of Chihiro Nakao



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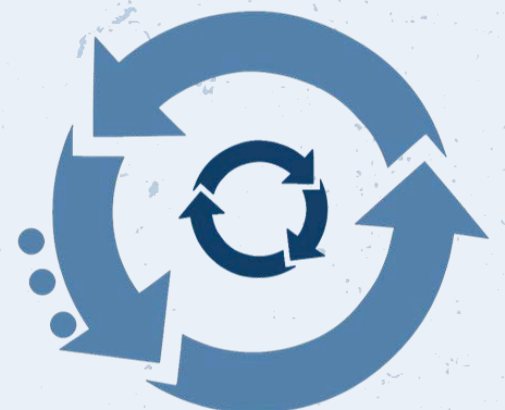


Bill Gates

“

**Automation applied
to an inefficient
operation will
magnify the
inefficiency.**

”

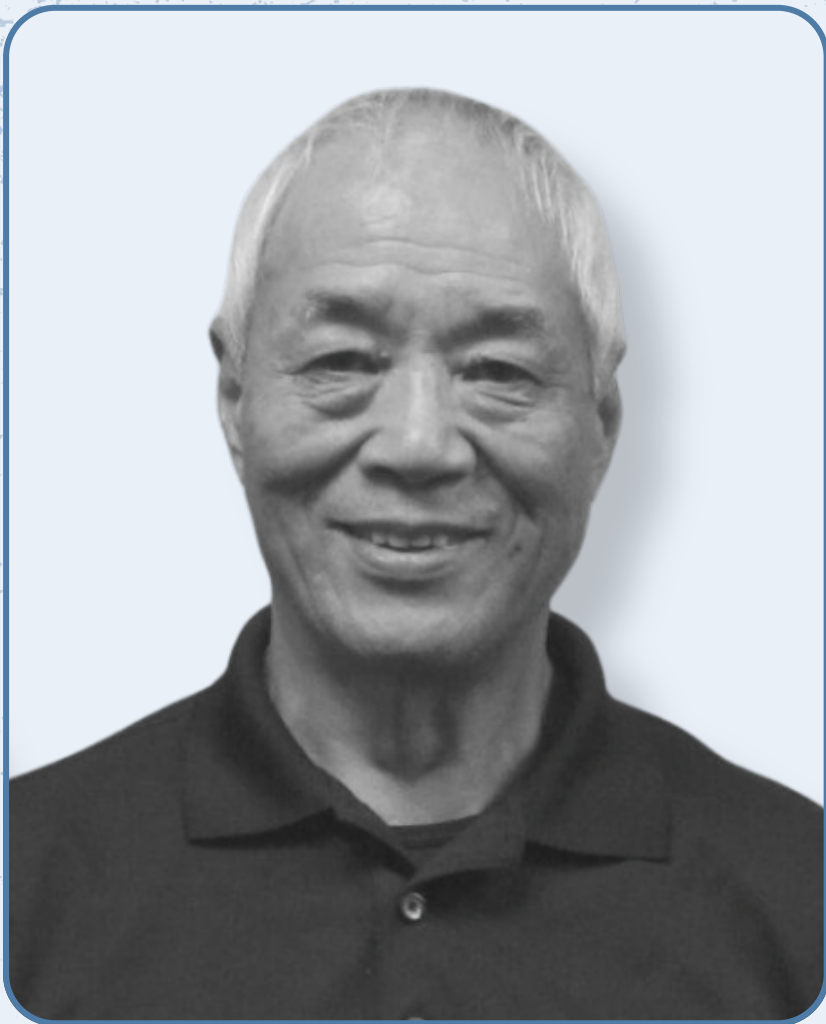


Source: LIKER, JEFFREY K. TOYOTA WAY: 14 Management Principles



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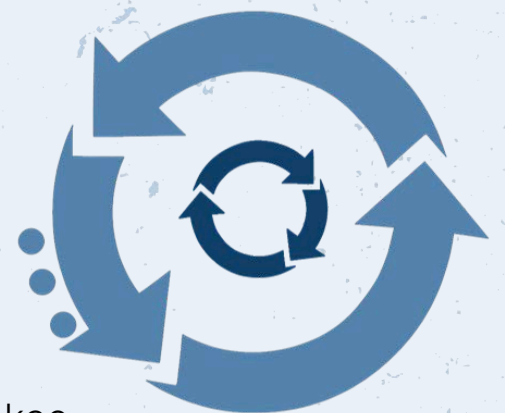


Chihiro Nakao

“

Failure is not
failure.
It is a **step**
towards
improvement.

”



Source: Emiliani, Bob; Yoshino, Katsusaburo; Go, Rudy. Kaizen Forever: Teachings of Chihiro Nakao



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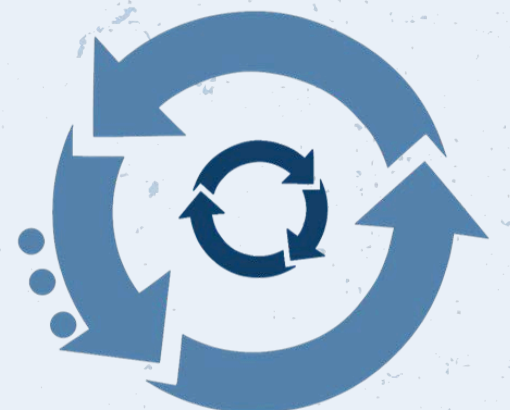
Deming, W. Edwards

“

Defects are not free.

**Somebody makes
them, and gets paid for
making them.**

”



Source: deming.org/quotes



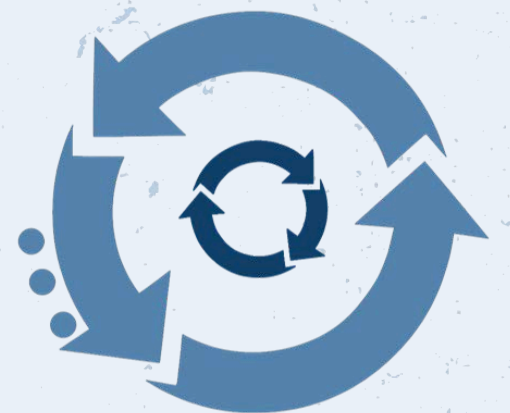
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Taiichi Ohno

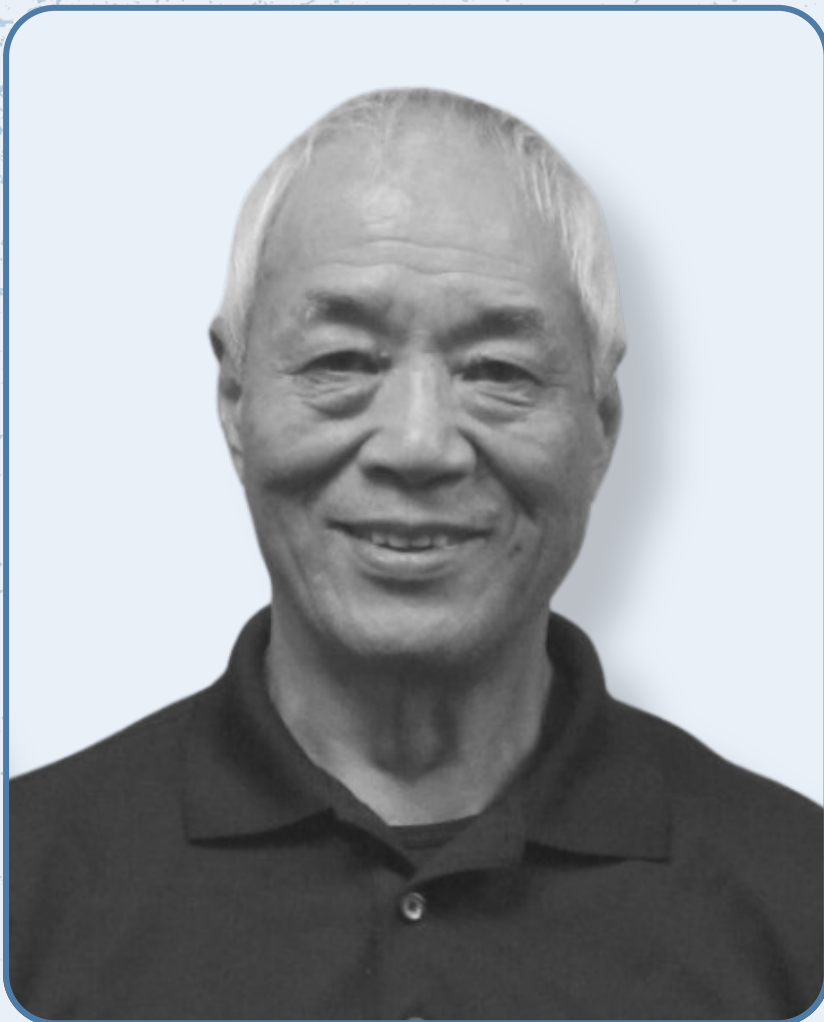
“ There is no magic method. Rather, a **total management system** is needed ... to best enhance creativity and fruitfulness, to utilize facilities and machines well, and to eliminate all waste. ”



Source: Ohno, T. Toyota production system: Beyond large-scale production. Productivity Press.



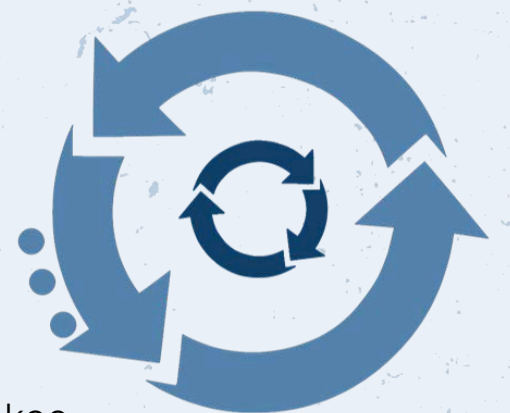
“



Chihiro Nakao

**Kaizen should
come from
operators'
complaints.**

”



Source: Emiliani, Bob; Yoshino, Katsusaburo; Go, Rudy. Kaizen Forever: Teachings of Chihiro Nakao



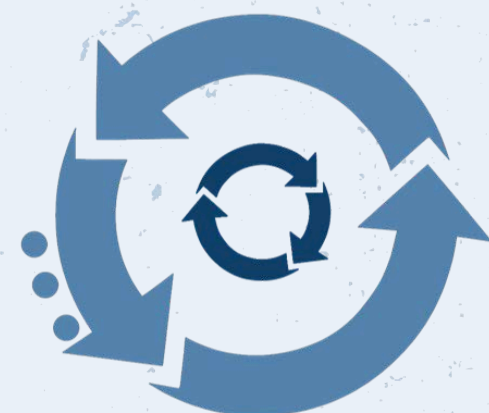
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“

**The road to success is
paved with mistakes
well handled.**

”



Source: Daniel Coyle, The Culture Code: The Secrets of Highly Successful Groups



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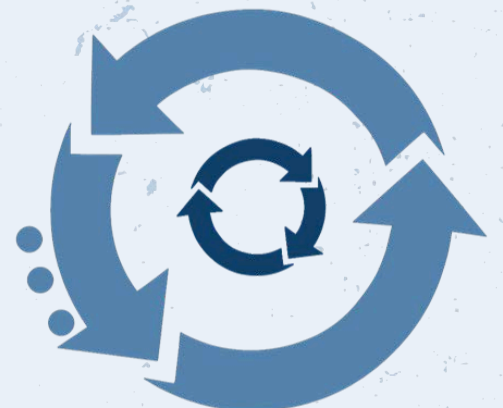
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“

**When a breakthrough is
achieved, a standardized
process should be put in place
for it to become a sustainable,
repeatable competitive
advantage**

”

Mark Deluzio



Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined why lean transformations fail and what to do about it.



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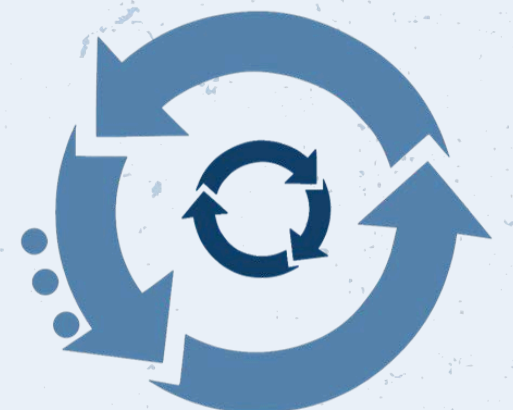
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“

Toyota is **not interested** in being
trendy and making adoption of
new technology an end unto
itself.

”

Jeffrey Liker



Source: LIKER, JEFFREY K. TOYOTA WAY: 14 Management Principles



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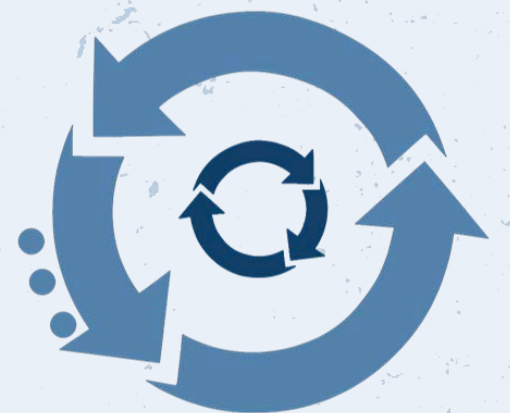
Deming, W. Edwards

“

**Fear invites wrong
figures.**

**To keep his job, anyone
may present to his boss
only good news.**

”



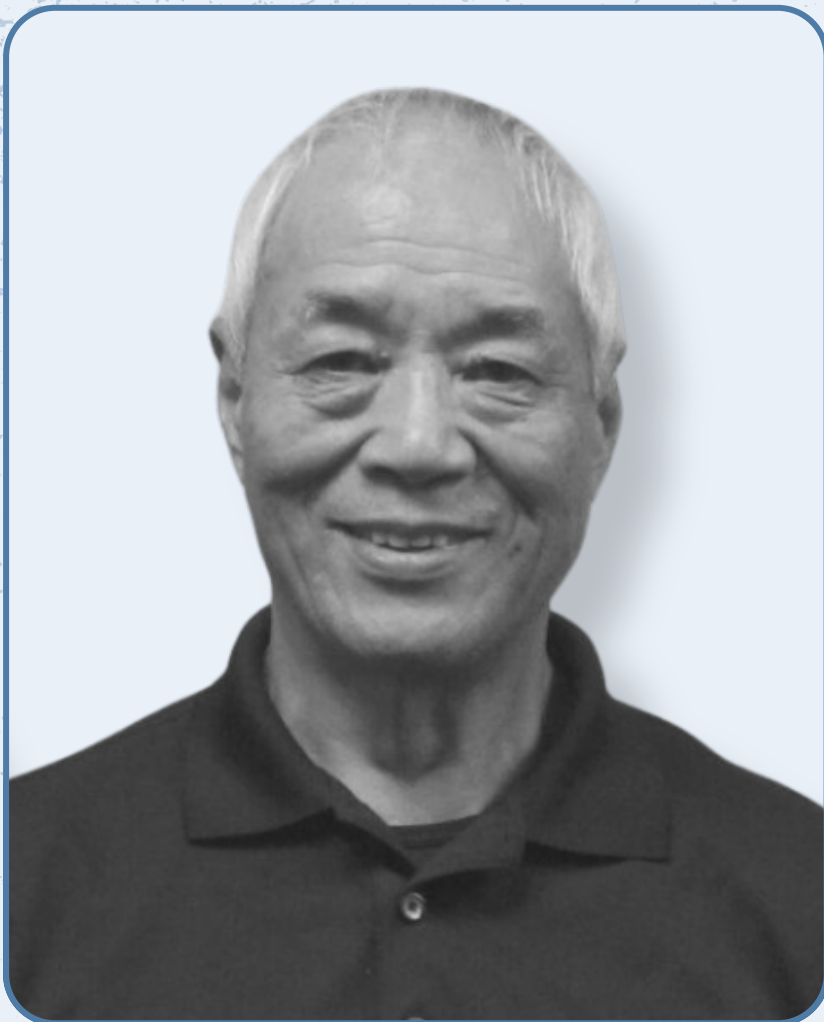
Source: deming.org/quotes



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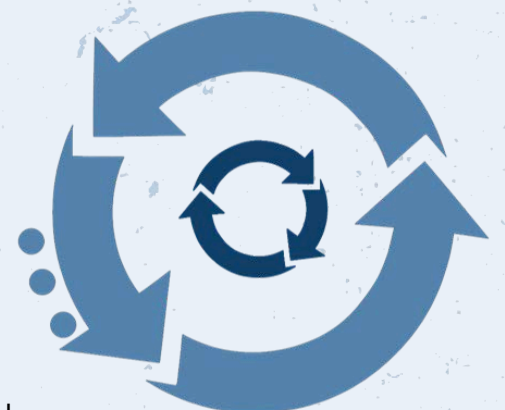
“



Chihiro Nakao

You have to
struggle to
squeeze your
intelligence
out.

”



Source: Emiliani, Bob; Yoshino, Katsusaburo; Go, Rudy. Kaizen Forever: Teachings of Chihiro Nakao



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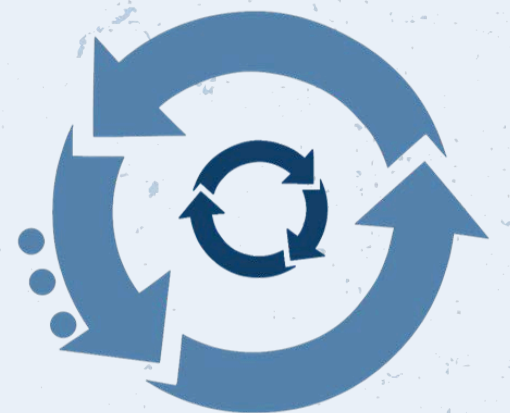
“



Taiichi Ohno

The Toyota production system and its basic structure was realized because there were always clear purposes and needs

”



Source: Ohno, T. Toyota production system: Beyond large-scale production. Productivity Press.



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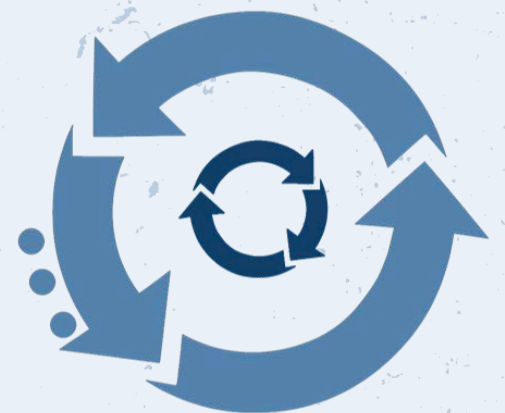
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“

**Sustainable results that combat
flatlining can only be achieved
via an enterprise focus that has
**hands-on involvement from
senior leadership.****

”

Mark Deluzio



Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined why lean transformations fail



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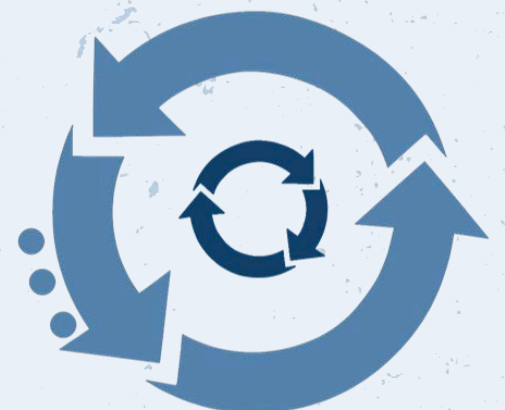
“

**Leadership by intimidation
and insult is a **bad strategy**.**

Belittling people doesn't
boost their productivity; it
diminishes it.

”

Adam Grant



Source: Grant, A. (2025, April 13). America Is Learning the Wrong Lesson from Elon Musk's Success. NYT.



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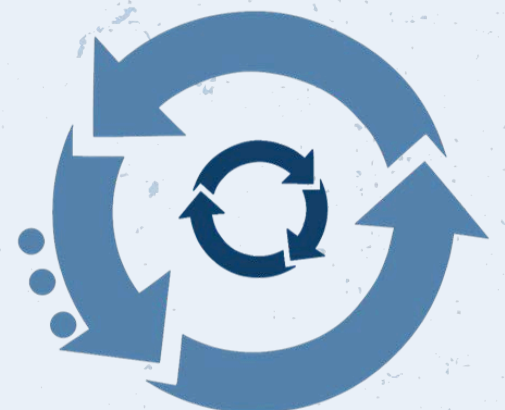
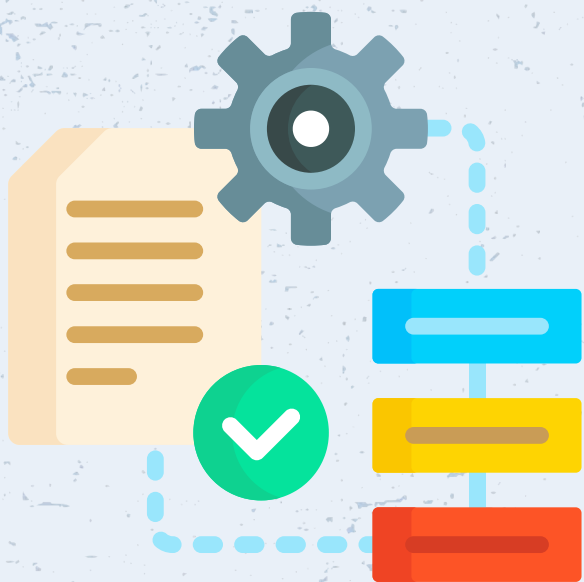
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“

The **bedrock** of any
continuous improvement
activity in an organisation
is based on **standards**.

”

Paul Dunlop



Source: Dunlop, P. (2021, November 8). Leader Standard Work: The Basics. TeamAssurance.



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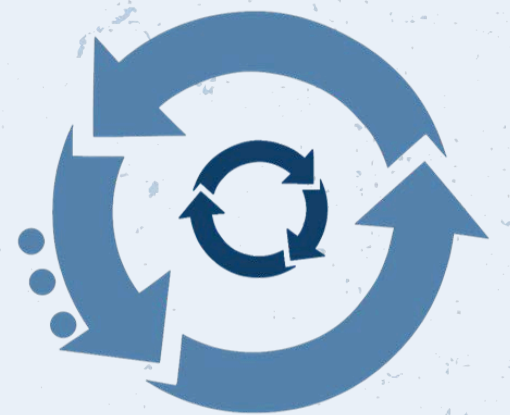
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“

Any information
technology must
prove it **adds value**
before it is
implemented broadly.

”

Jeffrey Liker

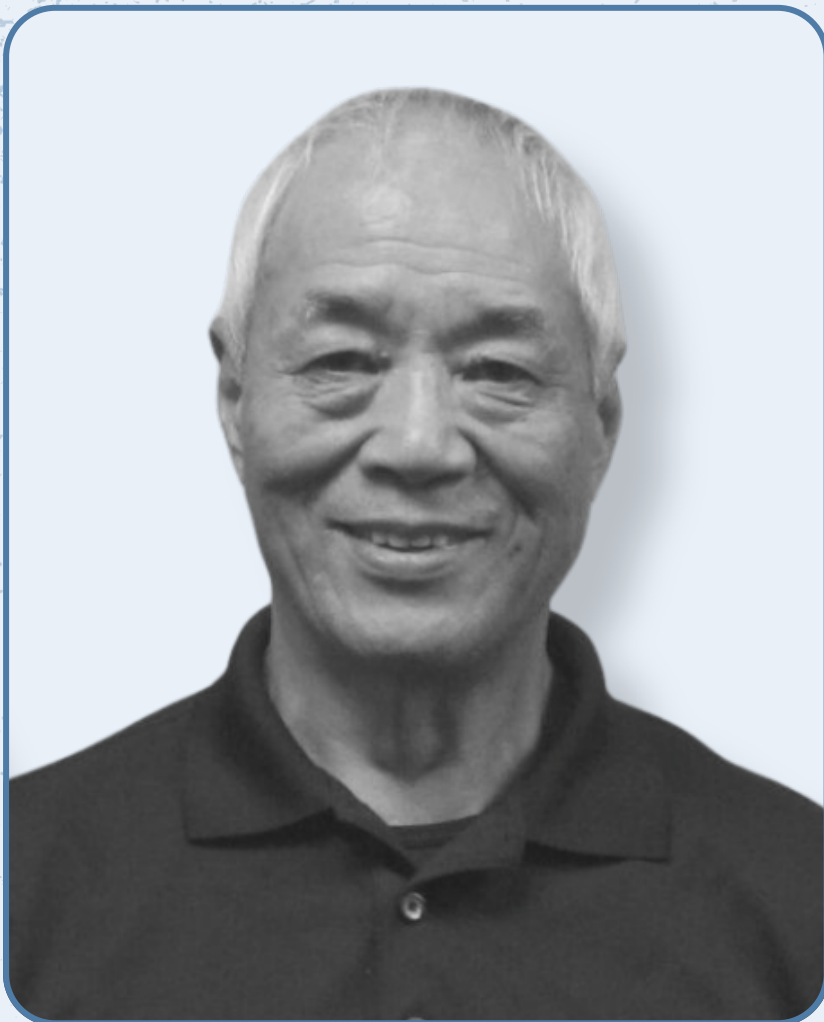


Source: Jeffrey Liker The Toyota Way, Second Edition. McGraw-Hill Education.



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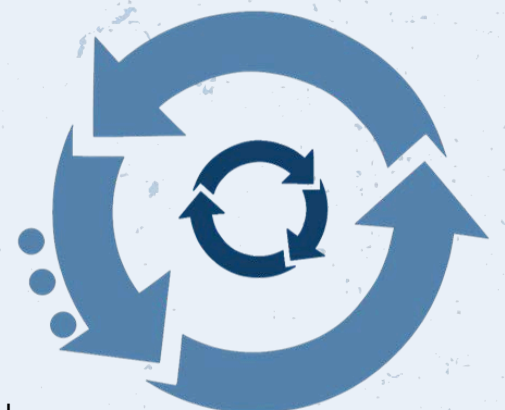
Chihiro Nakao

“

**Kaizen is not
for cutting jobs.**

Use wisdom and
ingenuity to protect
people's lives.

”



Source: Emiliani, Bob; Yoshino, Katsusaburo; Go, Rudy. Kaizen Forever: Teachings of Chihiro Nakao



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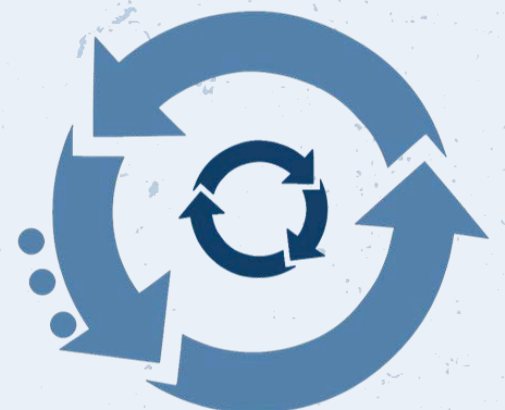


Taiichi Ohno

“

There is no **waste** in
business more
terrible than
overproduction.

”



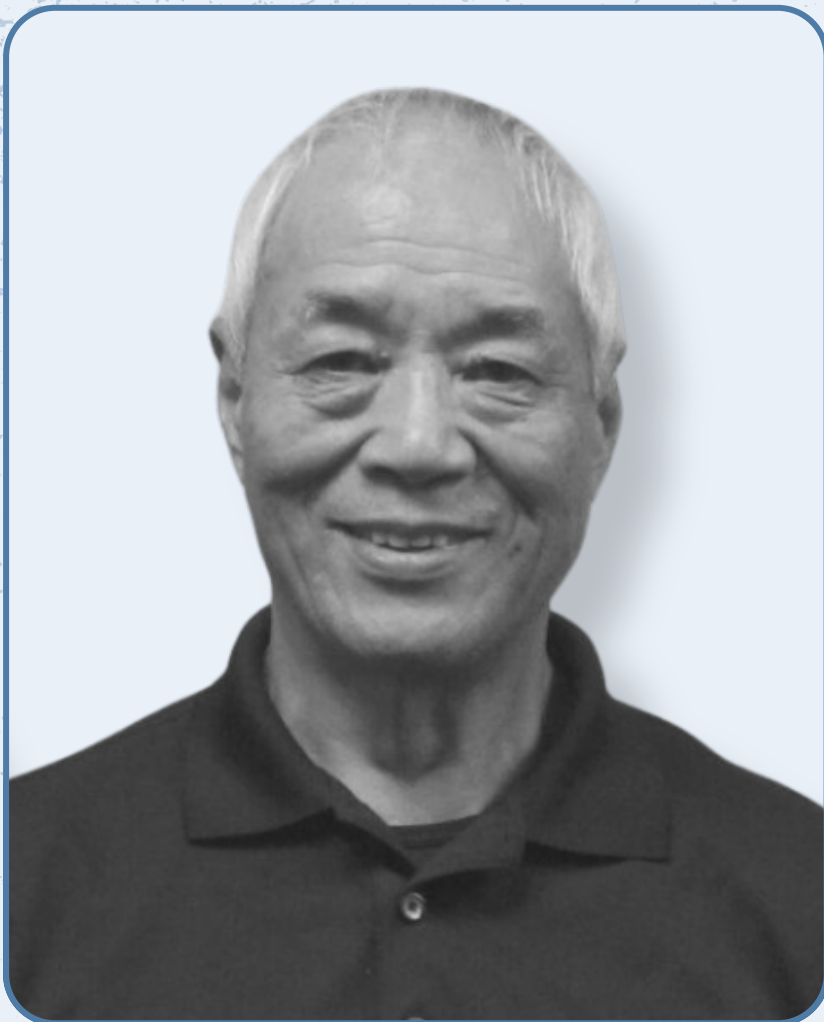
Source: Ohno, T. Toyota production system: Beyond large-scale production. Productivity Press.



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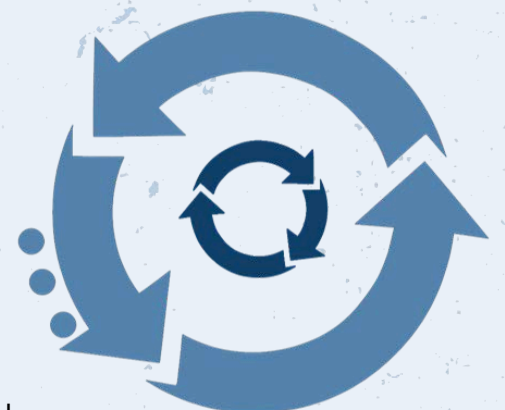
“



Chihiro Nakao

Put yourself
under dire
circumstances
to think
differently.

”



Source: Emiliani, Bob; Yoshino, Katsusaburo; Go, Rudy. Kaizen Forever: Teachings of Chihiro Nakao



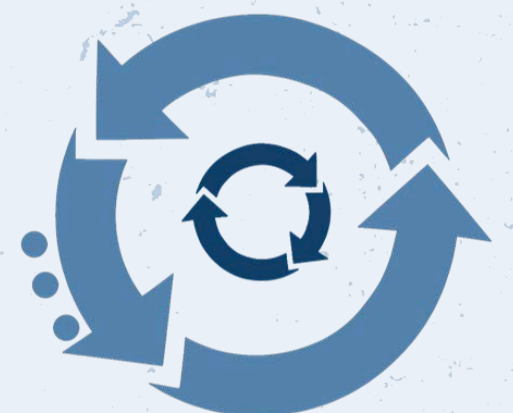
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Taiichi Ohno

“
By asking **why five times** and answering it each time, we can get to the real cause of the problem, which is **often hidden behind more obvious symptoms.**
”

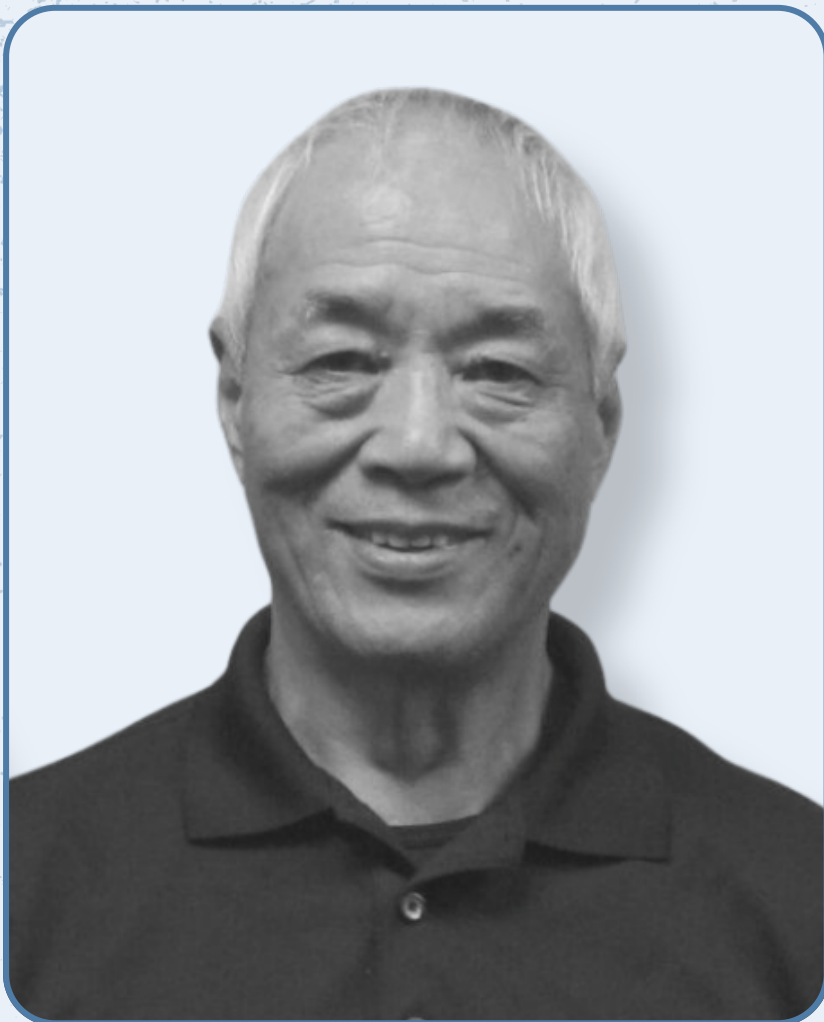


Source: Ohno, T. Toyota production system: Beyond large-scale production. Productivity Press.



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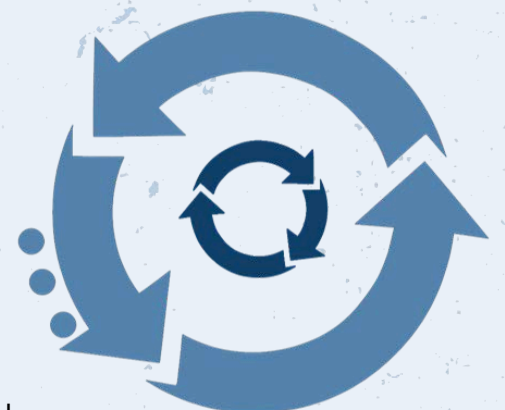


Chihiro Nakao

“

Use your
hands to think
and
feet to see.
Make your
hands dirty.

”



Source: Emiliani, Bob; Yoshino, Katsusaburo; Go, Rudy. Kaizen Forever: Teachings of Chihiro Nakao



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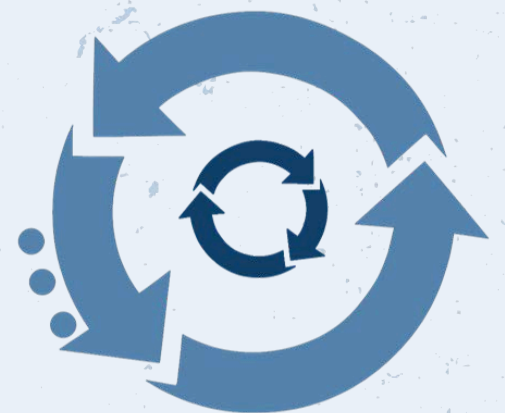
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“

You **can't** make the
transition to Lean unless the
management team
acts as one.

”

Mark Deluzio



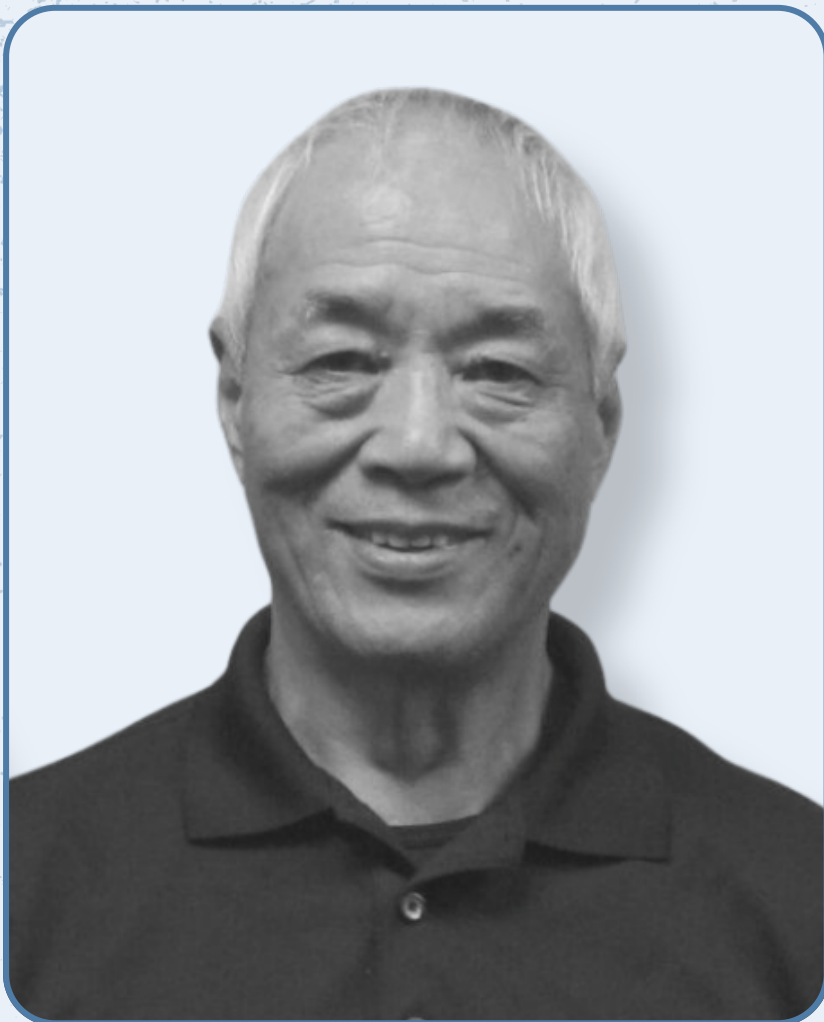
Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined why lean transformations fail



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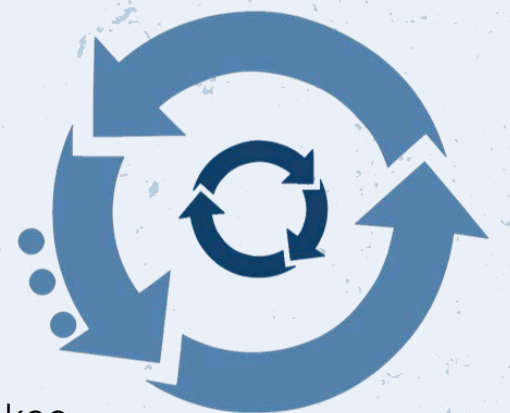
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Chihiro Nakao

“

**All departments
should be
helping the
genba. Only
genba is where
profit is made. ”**



Source: Emiliani, Bob; Yoshino, Katsusaburo; Go, Rudy. Kaizen Forever: Teachings of Chihiro Nakao



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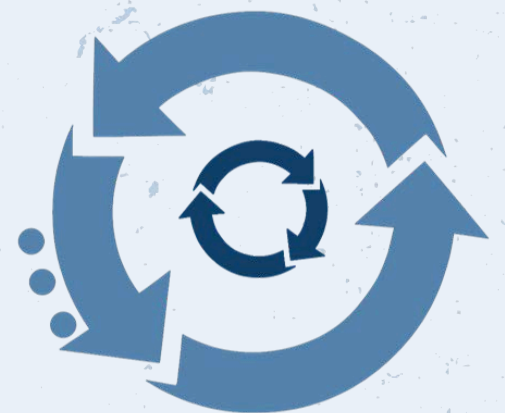
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“

Leaders [...] are often
the direct cause of
mura and **muri**.

”

Mark Deluzio



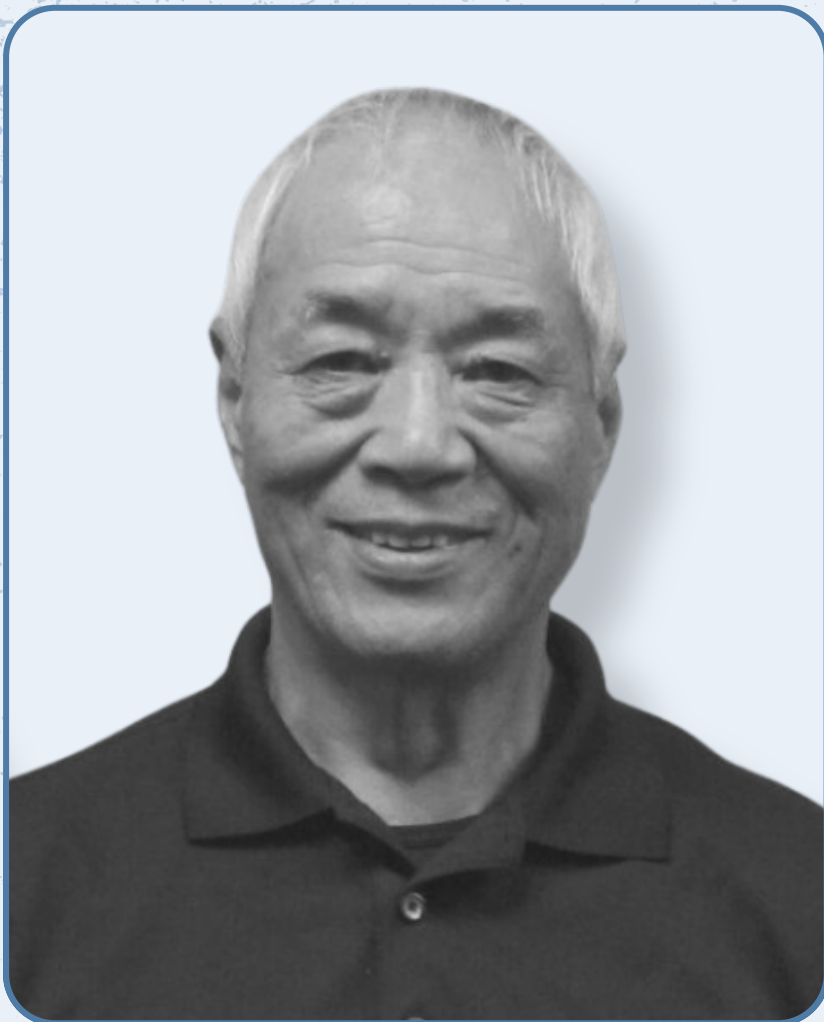
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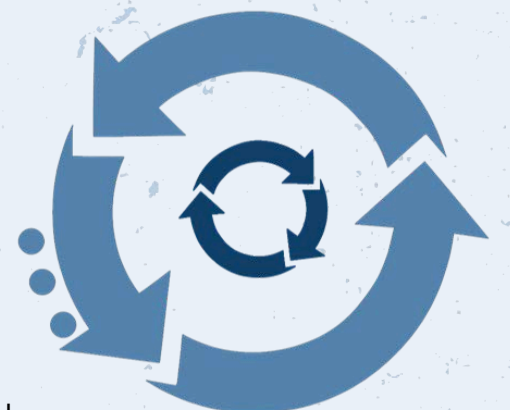
“



Chihiro Nakao

**Action
creates
wisdom.**

”



Source: Emiliani, Bob; Yoshino, Katsusaburo; Go, Rudy. Kaizen Forever: Teachings of Chihiro Nakao



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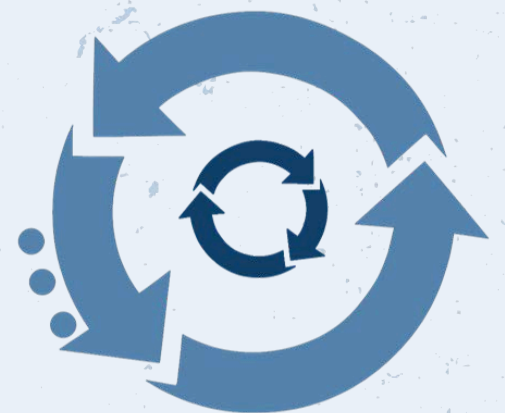
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“

Toyota does not go shopping
for “**superstar**” CEOs and
presidents because its
leaders **must live and**
thoroughly understand the
Toyota culture.

”

Jeffrey Liker

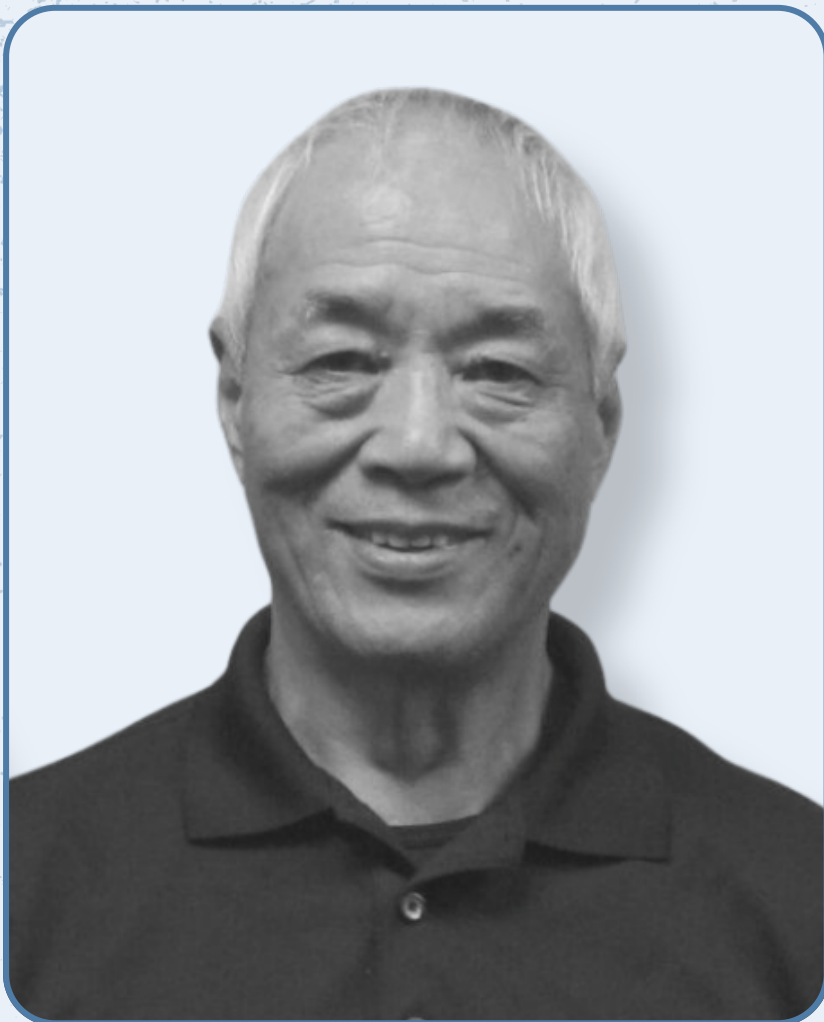


Source: Jeffrey Liker The Toyota Way, Second Edition. McGraw-Hill Education.



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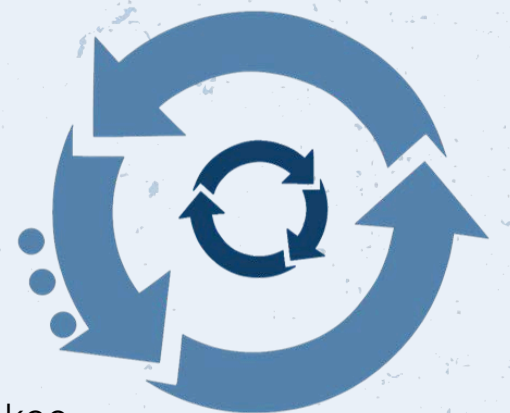


Chihiro Nakao

“

Executives **must not make light of operators.** They must discipline themselves to **wipe operators' shoes.**

”



Source: Emiliani, Bob; Yoshino, Katsusaburo; Go, Rudy. Kaizen Forever: Teachings of Chihiro Nakao



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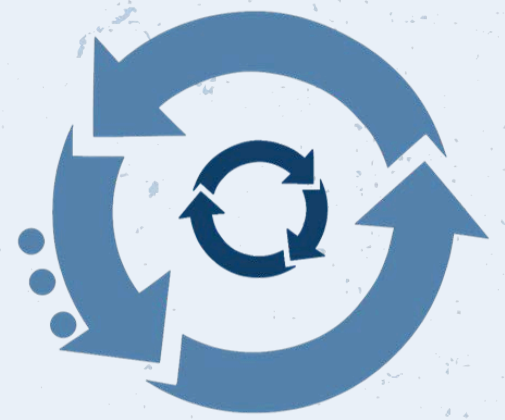
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“

Unfortunately, many managers think that it is sufficient to do **the bare minimum** and try to **fake their way** to achieving excellence.

”

John Dyer



Source: Dyer, John. The Façade of Excellence: Defining a New Normal of Leadership.



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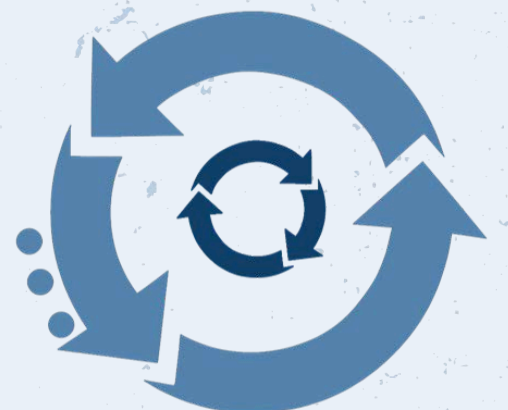


Deming, W. Edwards

“

A leader is a
coach, not a
judge.

”



Source: deming.org/quotes



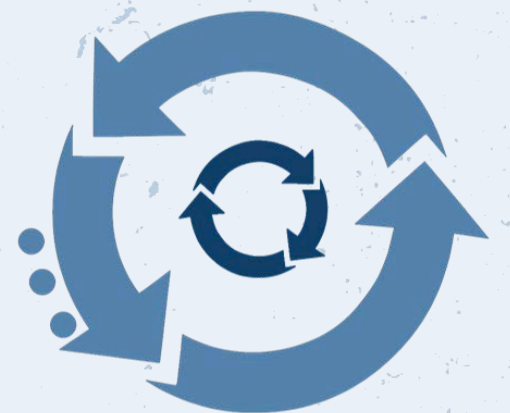
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Taiichi Ohno

“
True efficiency
improvement
comes when we
produce **zero waste**
and bring the
percentage of work
to **100 percent**.
”



Source: Ohno, T. Toyota production system: Beyond large-scale production. Productivity Press.



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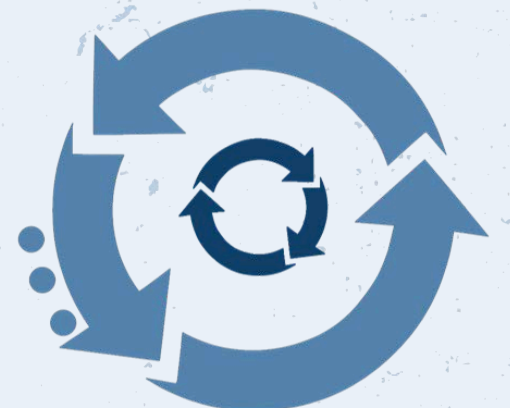
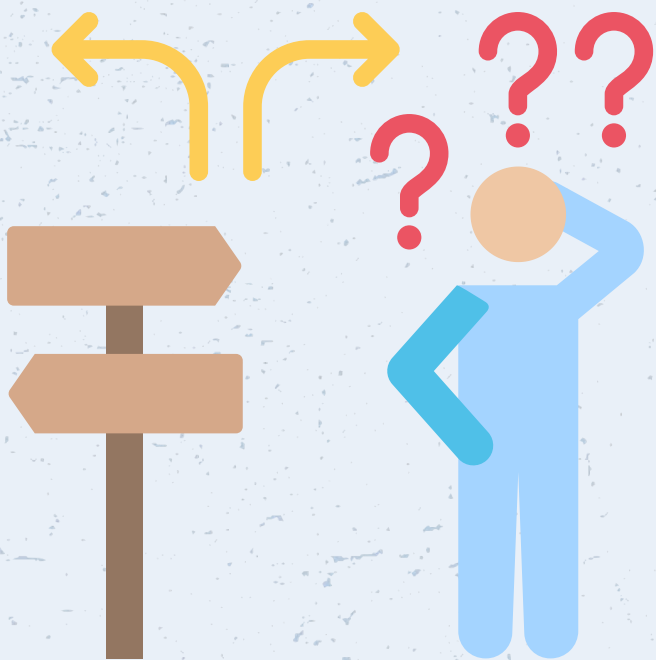
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“

Companies need to get
away from **ingrained
dysfunctional behaviors**
across the board in order to
achieve **lasting
transformations**

”

Mark DeLuzio



Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined why lean transformations fail and what to do about it. Routledge.



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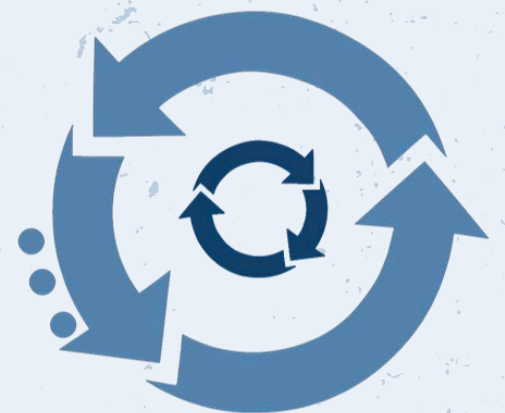
Akio Toyoda

“

Job titles are
unimportant.

In the end, the people
who know the gembu
are the most respected.

”



Source: Jeffrey Liker The Toyota Way, Second Edition



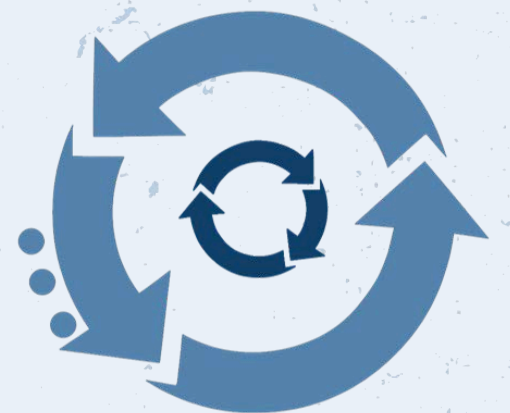
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Deming, W. Edwards

“
**Cease
dependence
on inspection
to achieve
quality.**
”



Source: deming.org/quotes



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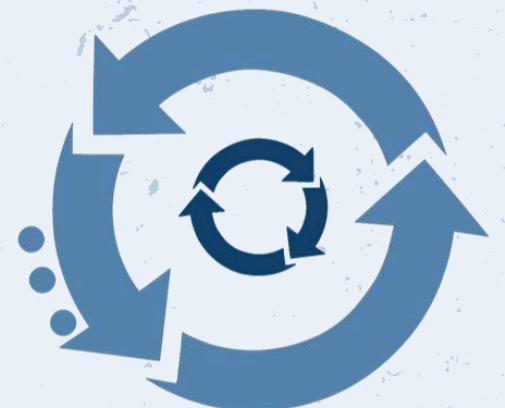
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“

For Toyota, **how** you
arrive at the decision is
as important as the
results of the decision.

”

Jeffrey Liker



Source: Jeffrey Liker The Toyota Way, Second Edition. McGraw-Hill Education.



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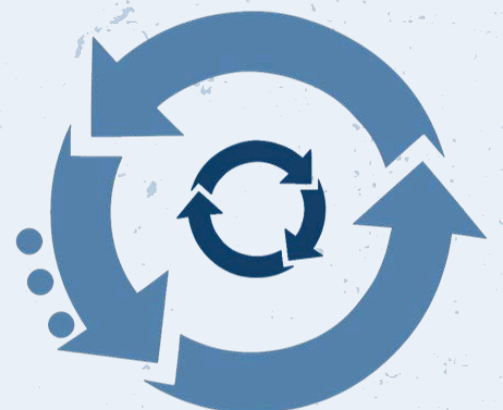
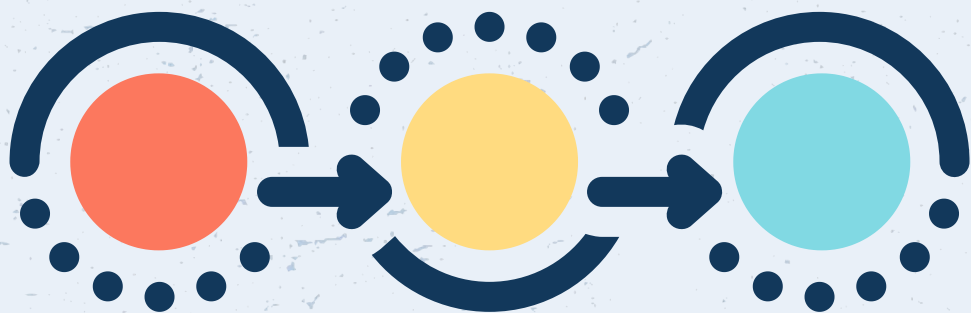
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“

Good leaders don't
believe in **good or**
bad luck, only **good**
or bad processes.

”

John Dyer



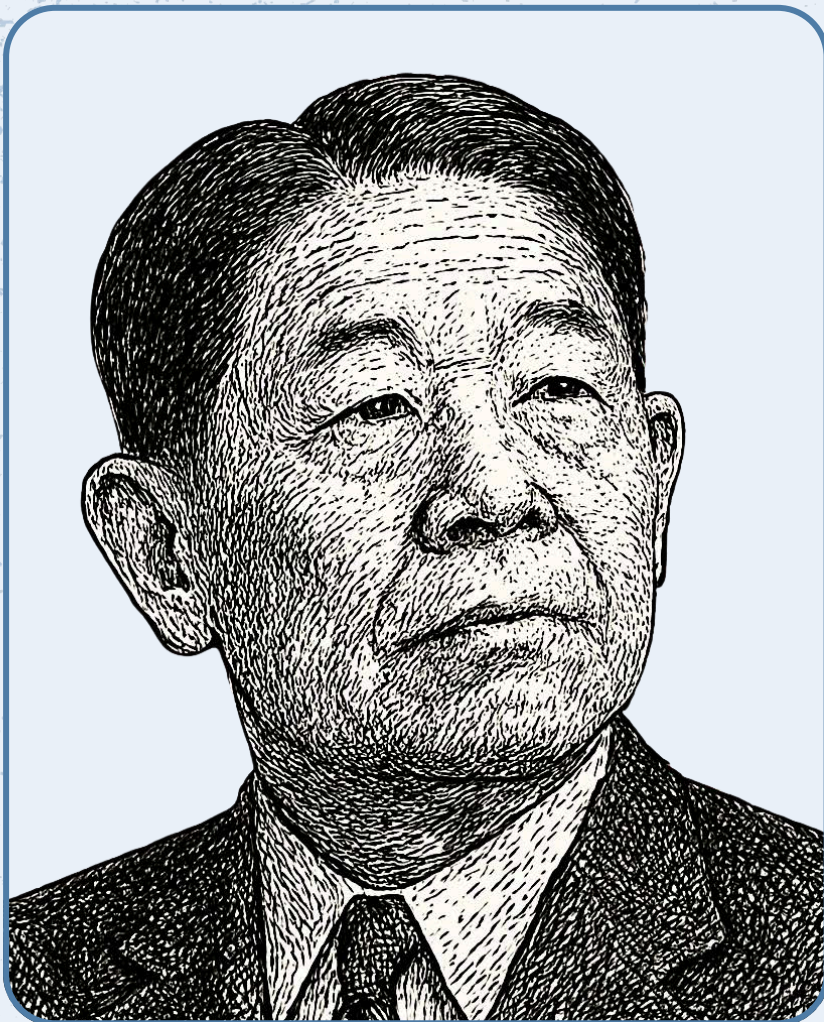
Source: Dyer, John. The Façade of Excellence: Defining a New Normal of Leadership.



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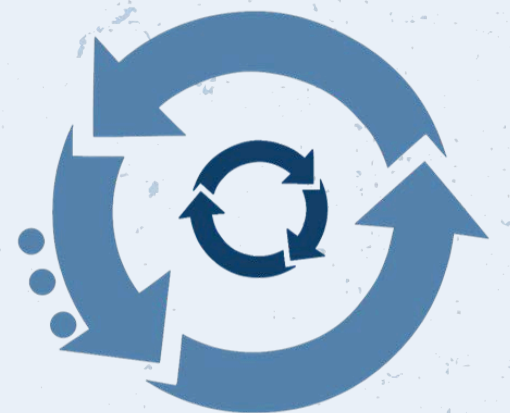
“



Shigeo Shingo

The first step in
improvement
is dissatisfaction
with the status quo

”



Source: Shingo, S. and Dillon, The Sayings Of Shigeo Shingo



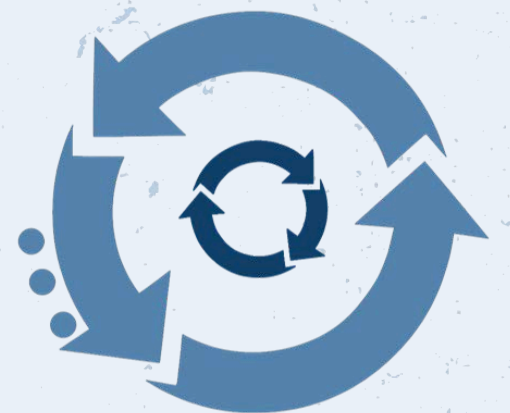
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“ Toyota’s famous
production system
makes great cars—
and with them great
managers.”

Steven J. Spear

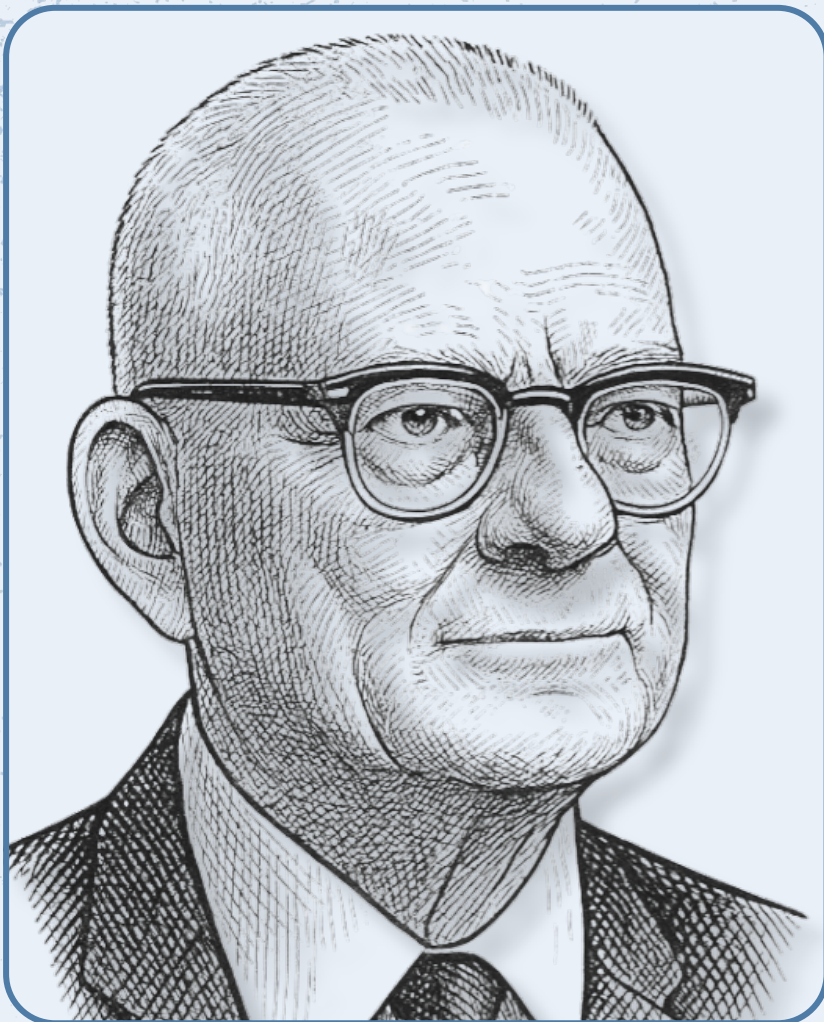


Source: Steven J. Spear, Learning to Lead at Toyota, HBR



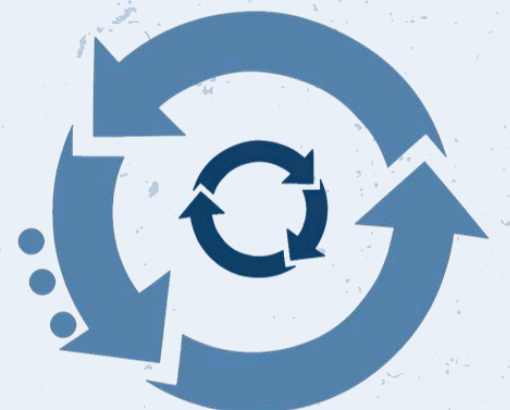
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W. Edwards Deming

“
**Eliminate the need
for inspection on a
mass basis by
building quality into
the product in the
first place.**
”

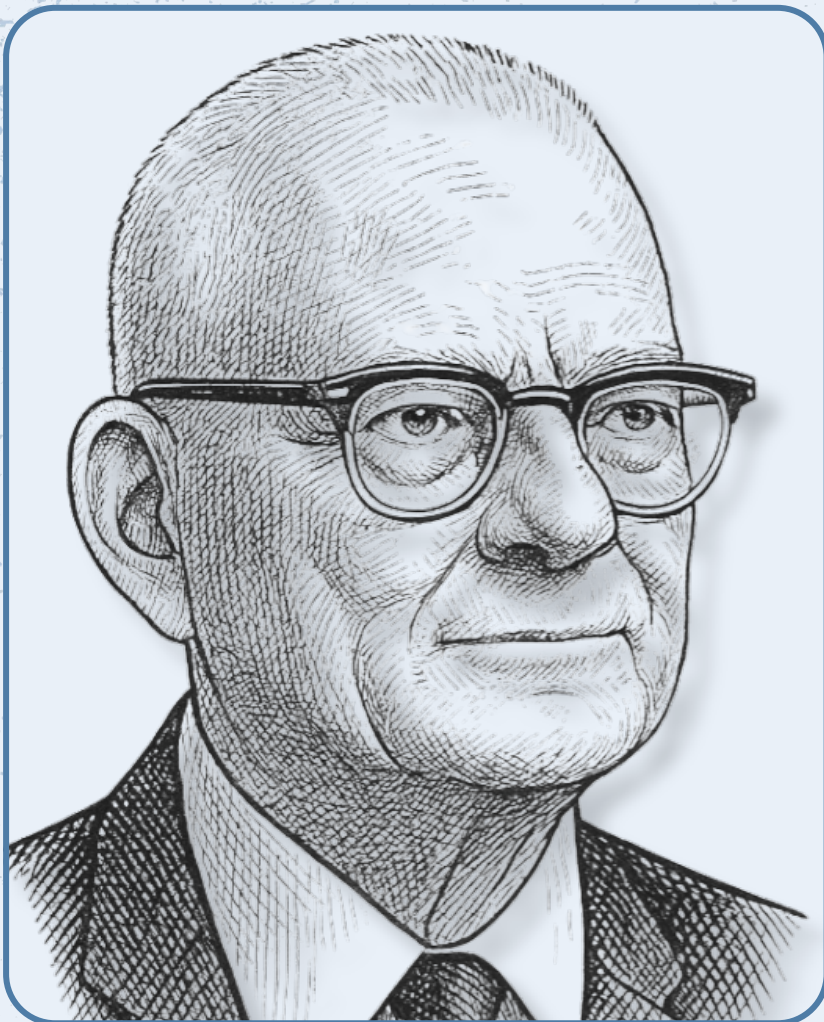


Source: deming.org/quotes



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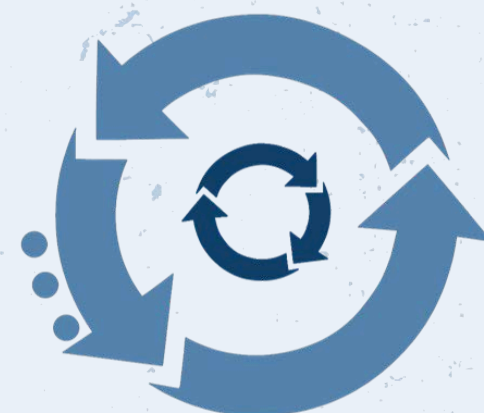


W. Edwards Deming

“

A bad system
will beat a
good person
every time.

”



Source: deming.org/quotes



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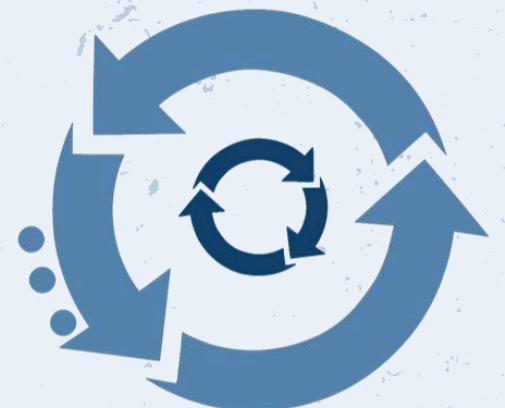
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“

.. team members are rarely to
blame for an error, but rather
there is usually something
about the system that allowed
the error to occur.

”

Jeffrey Liker



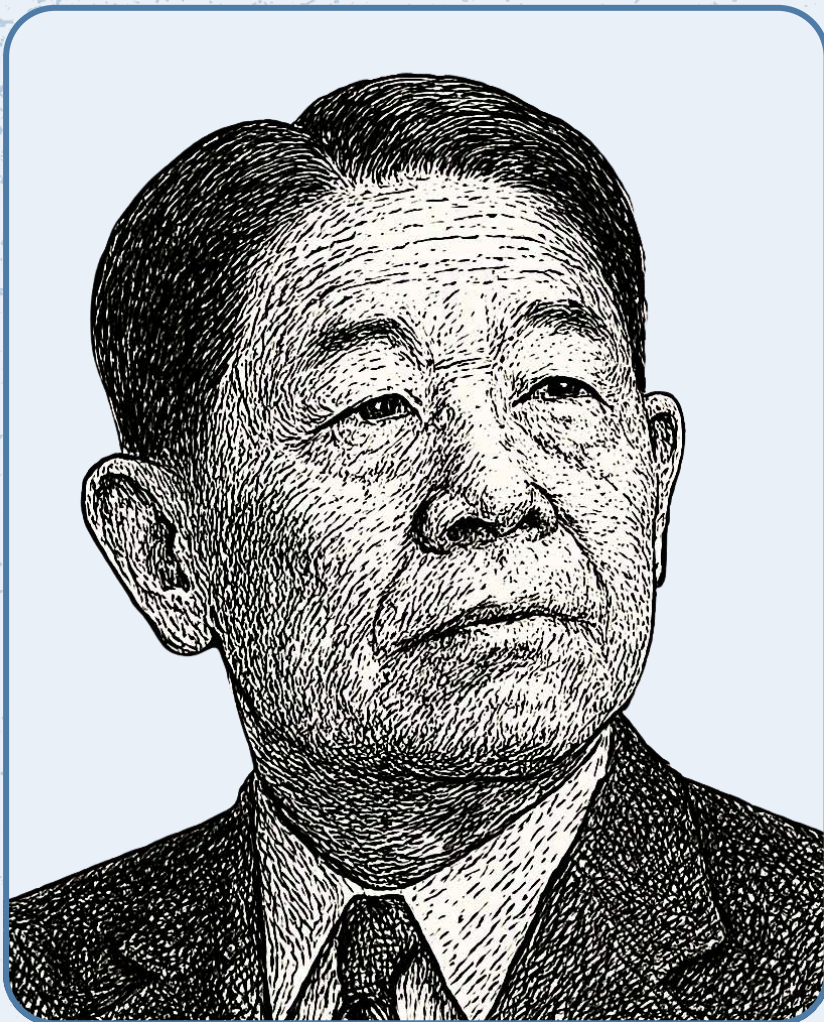
Source: Jeffrey Liker The Toyota Way, Second Edition. McGraw-Hill Education.



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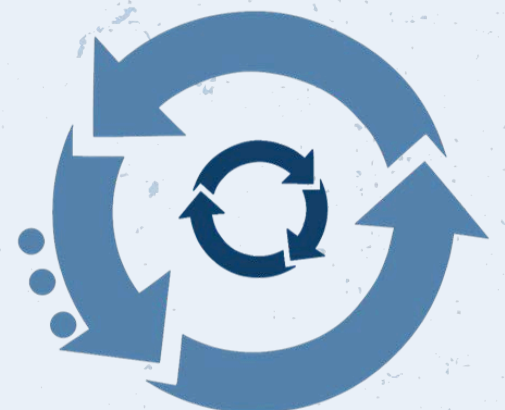
“



Shigeo Shingo

The greatest
waste
is *waste* **we**
don't' see

”

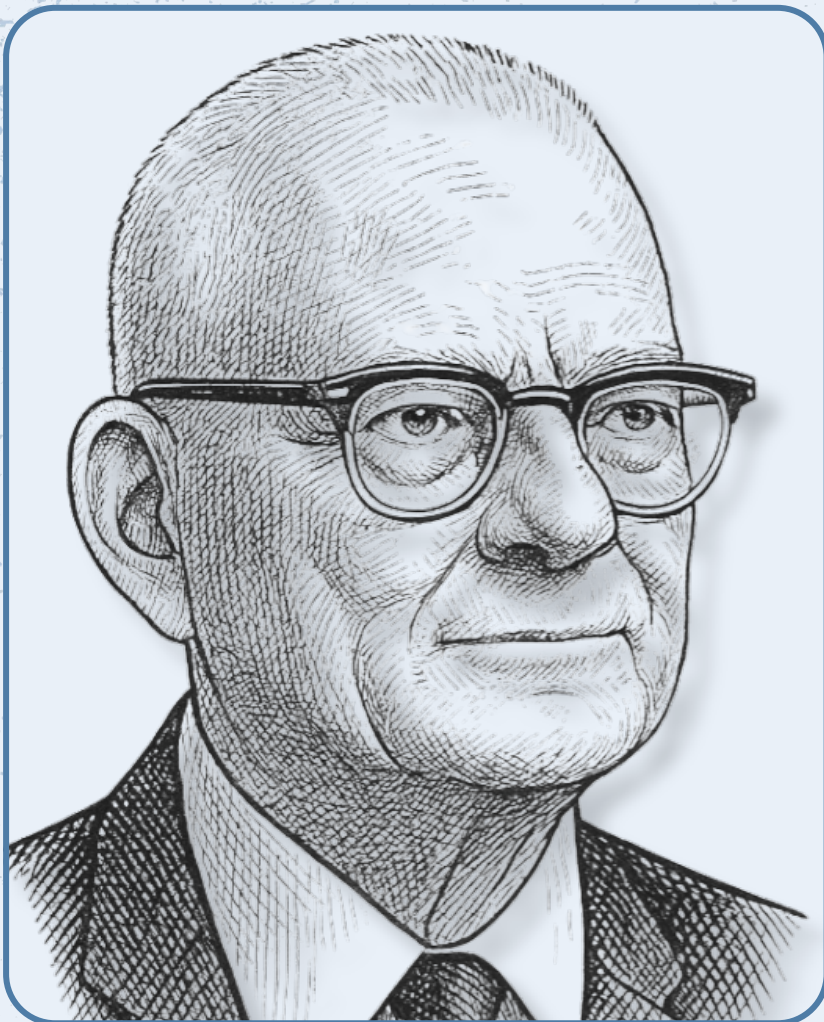


Source: Shingo, S. and Dillon, The Sayings Of Shigeo Shingo



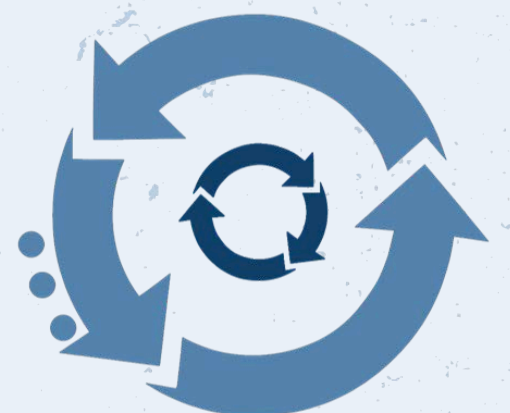
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W. Edwards Deming

“
It is **not enough** to
do your best; **you**
must know what to
do, and then do
your best.
”

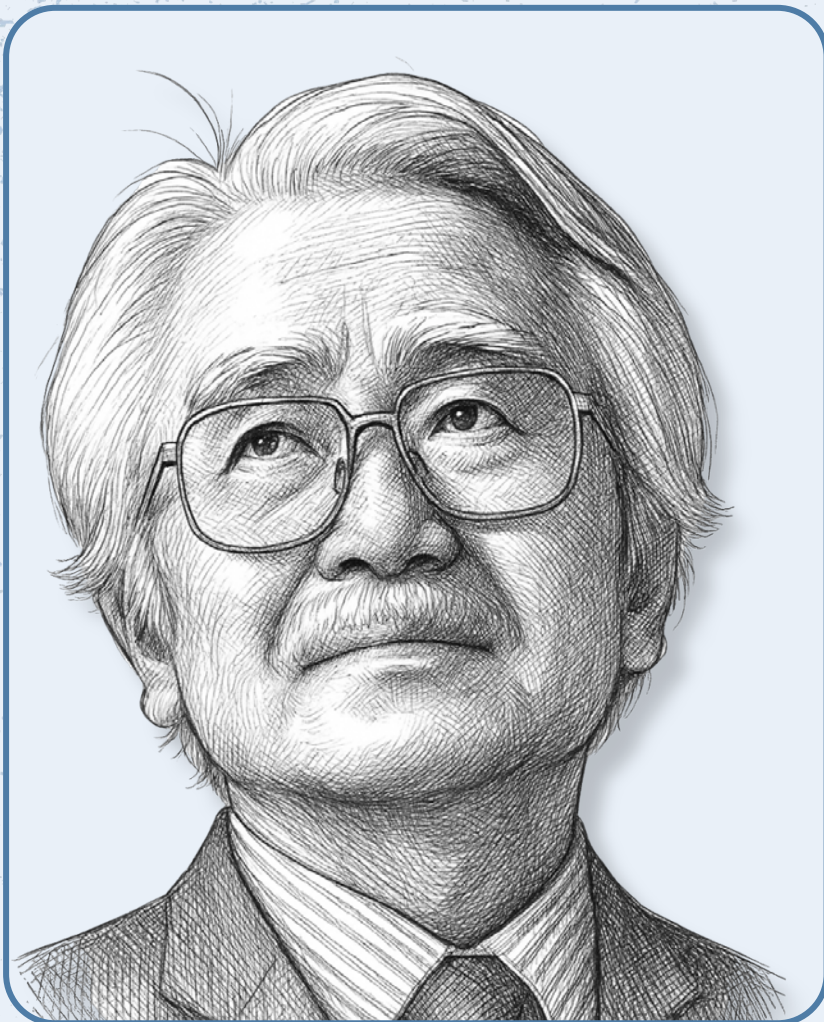


Source: deming.org/quotes



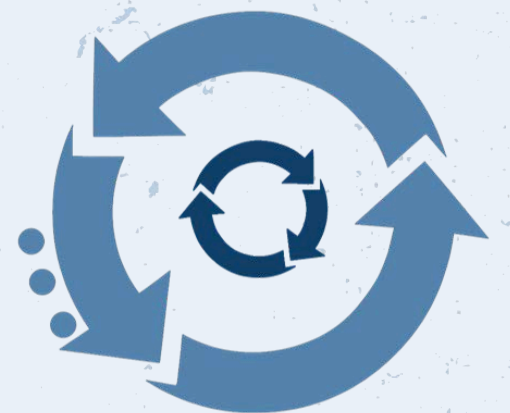
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Masaki Imai

“
It is **impossible** to
improve any
process until it is
standardized.
”



Source: Jeffrey Liker The Toyota Way, Second Edition. McGraw-Hill Education.



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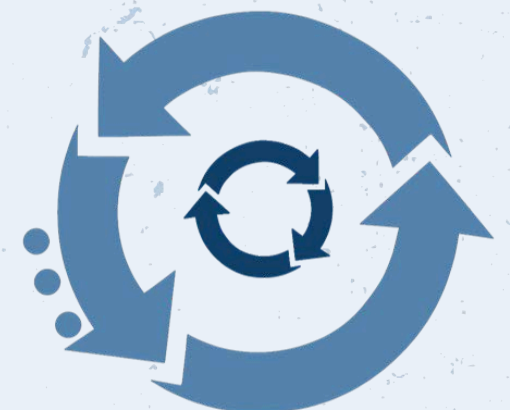
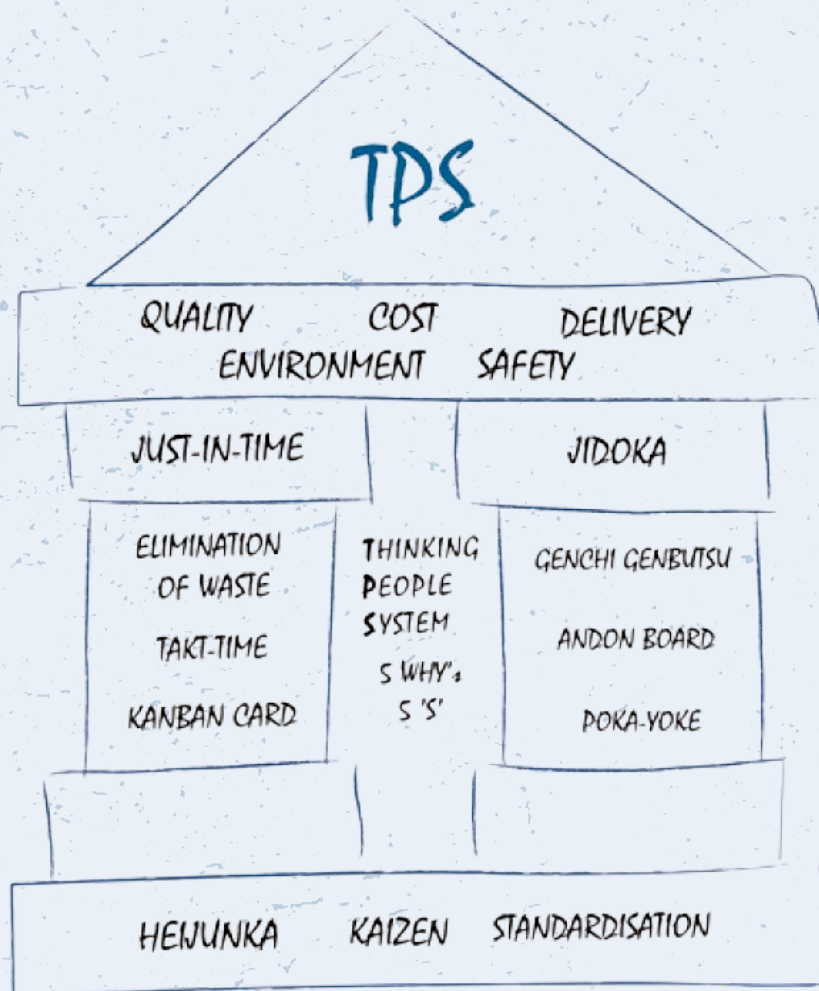
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“

Toyota Production System (TPS) is a **system of nested experiments** through which operations are constantly improved.

”

Steven J. Spear



Source: Steven J. Spear, Learning to Lead at Toyota, HBR



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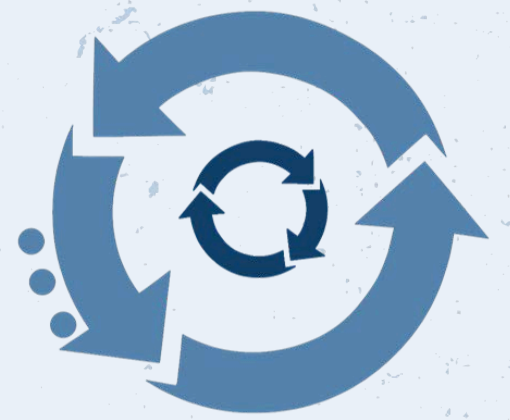
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“

One way to understand what a
company values in its leaders
is to look at its **performance**
appraisal system.

”

Jeffrey Liker



Source: Jeffrey Liker The Toyota Way, Second Edition. McGraw-Hill Education.



KAIZEN MADE EASY

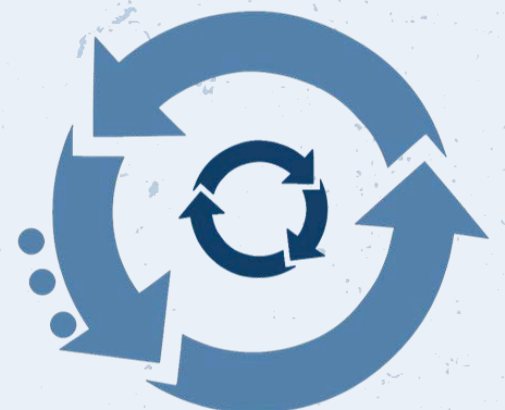
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“

It is a **mistake** to tie
headcount reductions to
the Lean process.

”

Mark DeLuzio

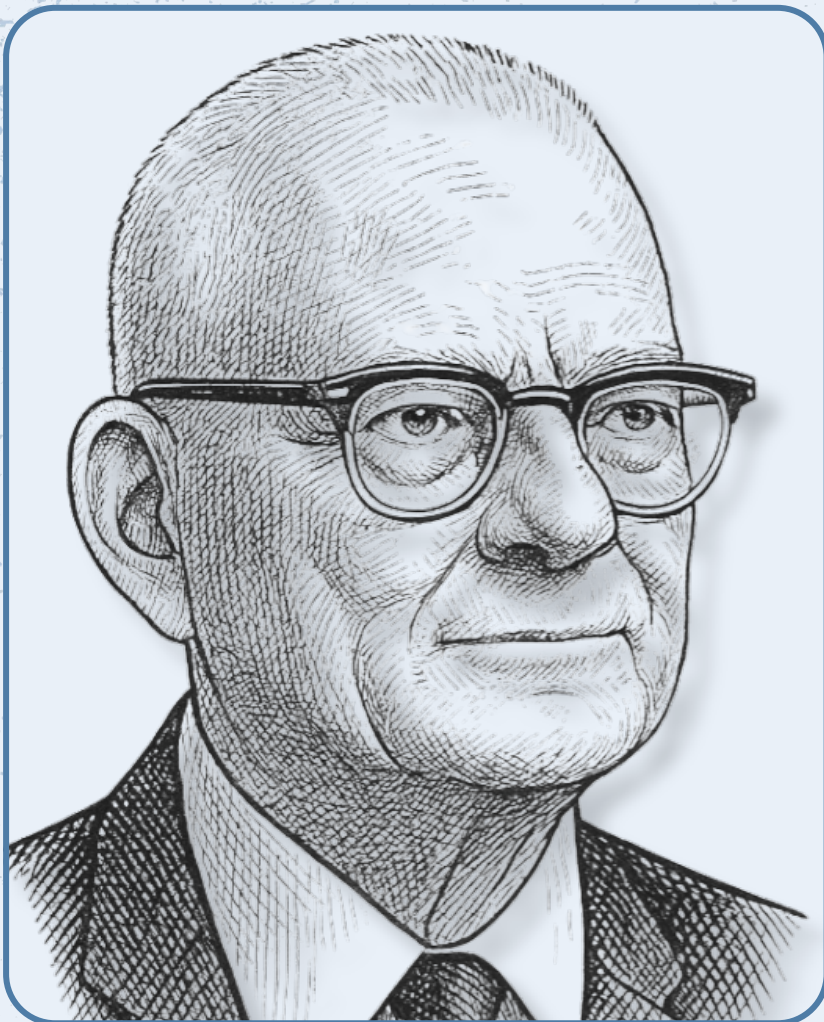


Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined why lean transformations fail and what to do about it. Routledge.



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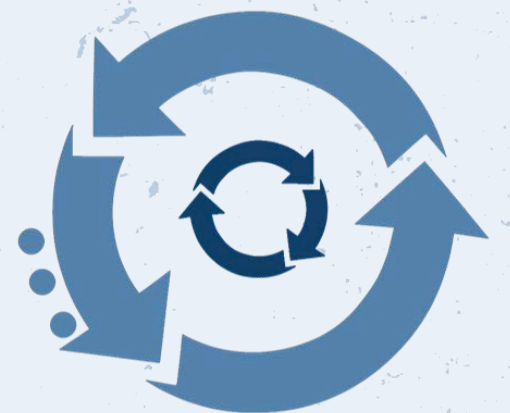


W. Edwards Deming

“

We cannot rely on
mass inspection
to improve quality

”

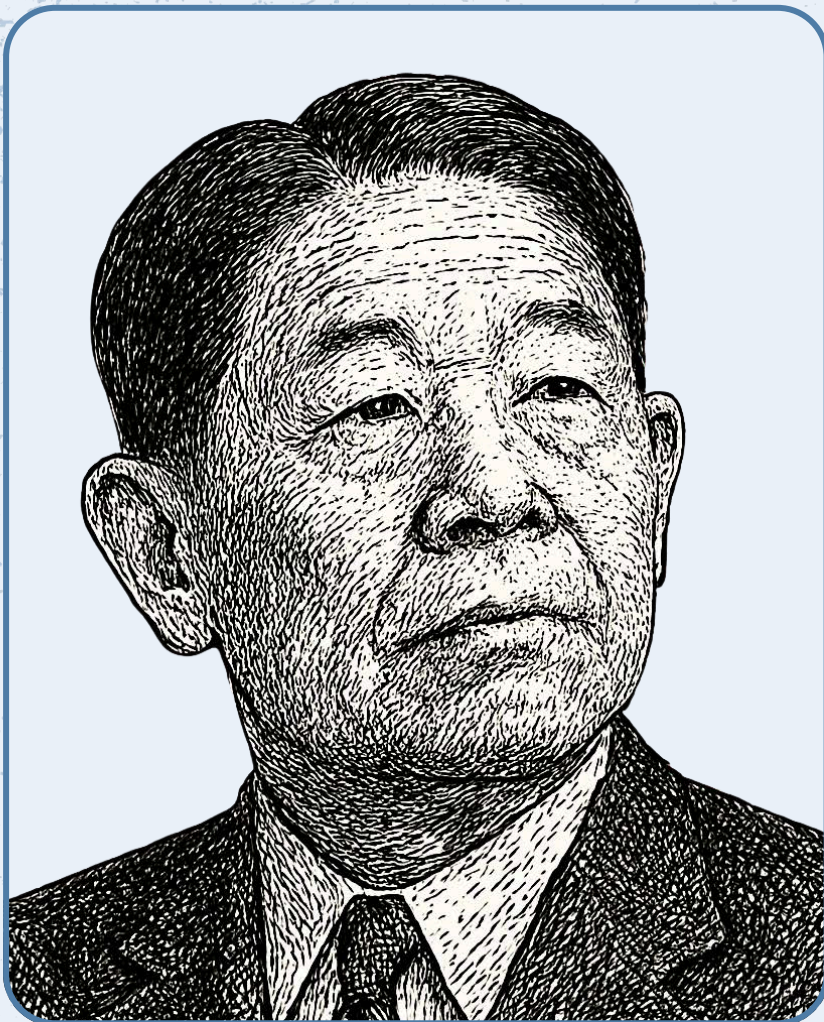


Source: deming.org/quotes



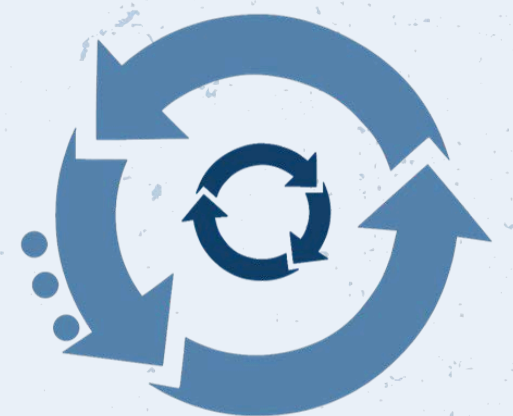
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Shigeo Shingo

“
Stock is like a
narcotic –
tolerate it once
and you'll soon
slide into a state
of addiction
”



Source: Shingo, Shigeo. A Study of the Toyota Production System:
From an Industrial Engineering Viewpoint.



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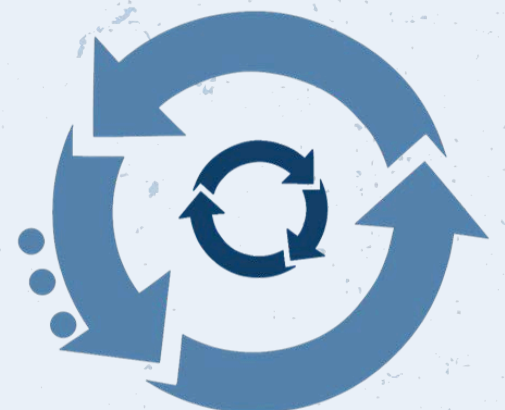
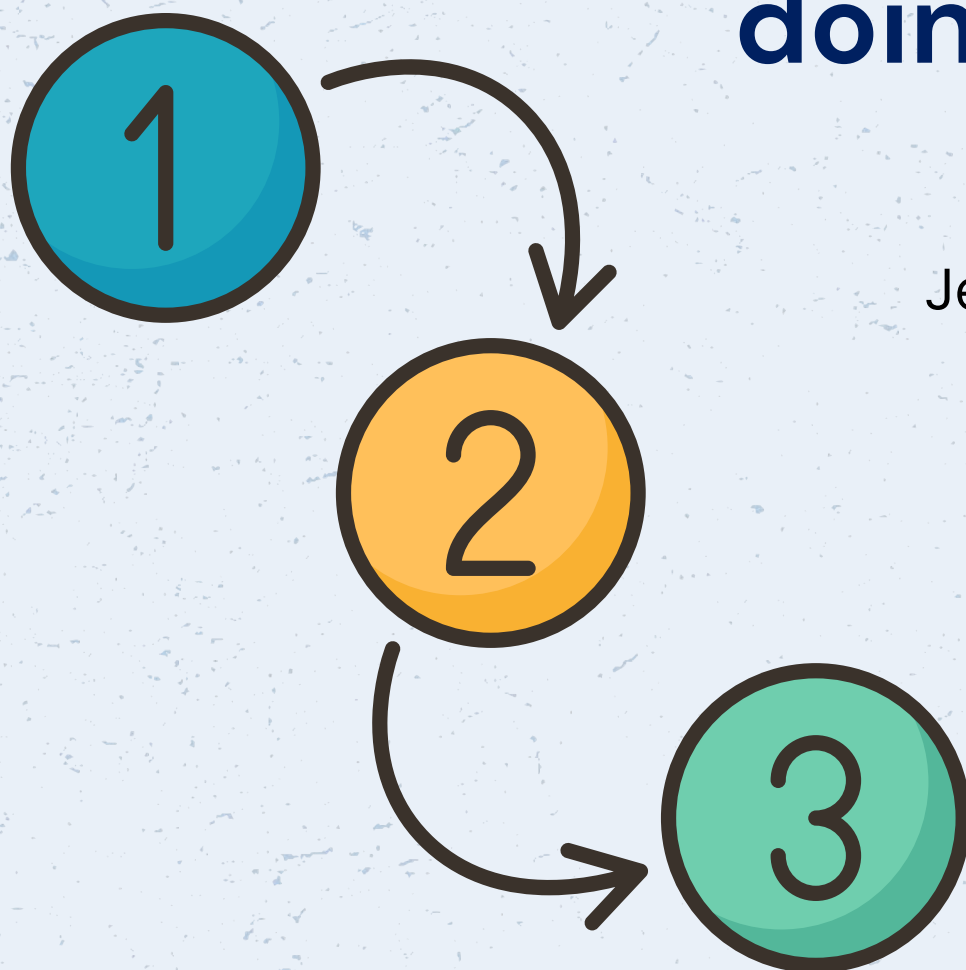
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“

For quality procedures to be effective, they must be **simple** and **practical** enough to be used every day by the people doing the work.

”

Jeffrey Liker

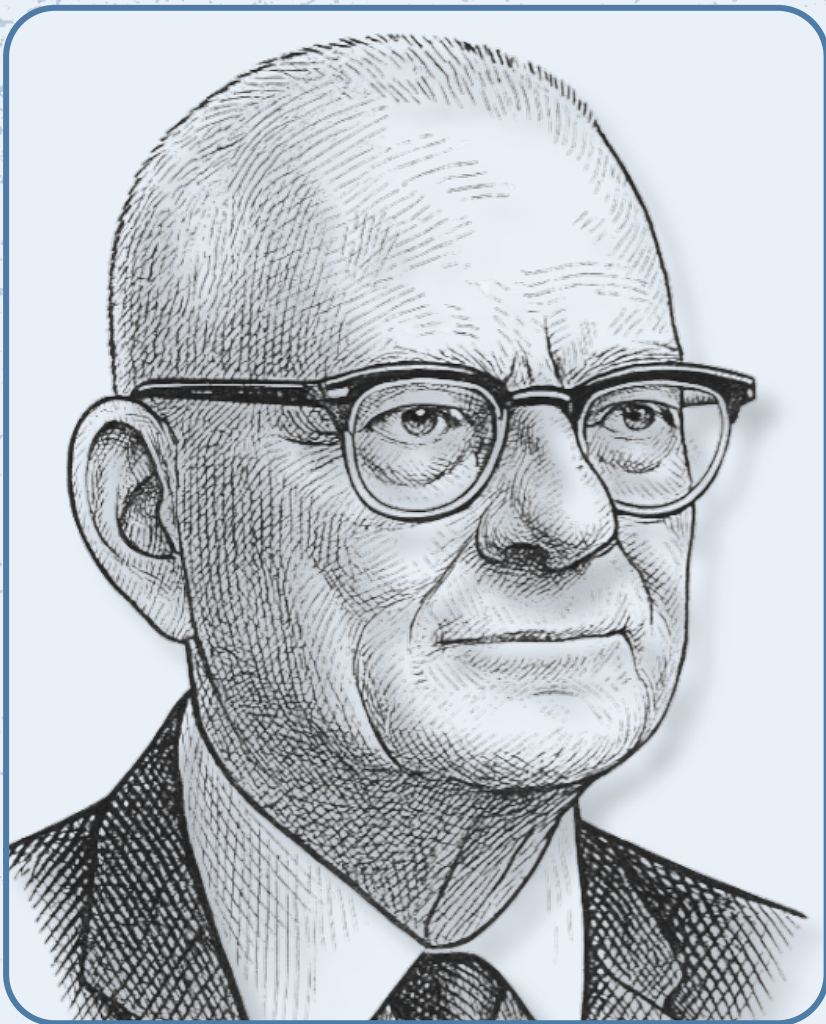


Source: Jeffrey Liker The Toyota Way, Second Edition. McGraw-Hill Education.



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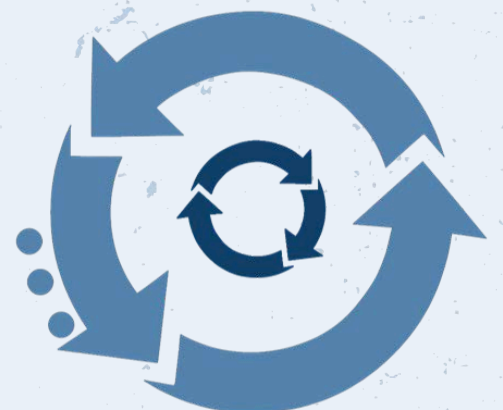


W. Edwards Deming

“

**Manage the
cause, not the
result.**

”



Source: deming.org/quotes



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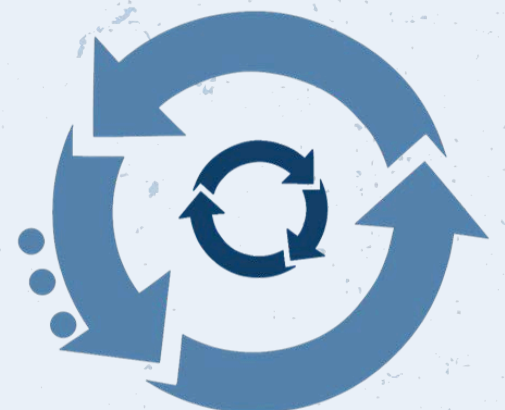
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“

It is **leaders** who model the **cultural norms and values** and **encourage adoption** of the deeply held beliefs by others through **their consistent example.**

”

Jeffrey Liker



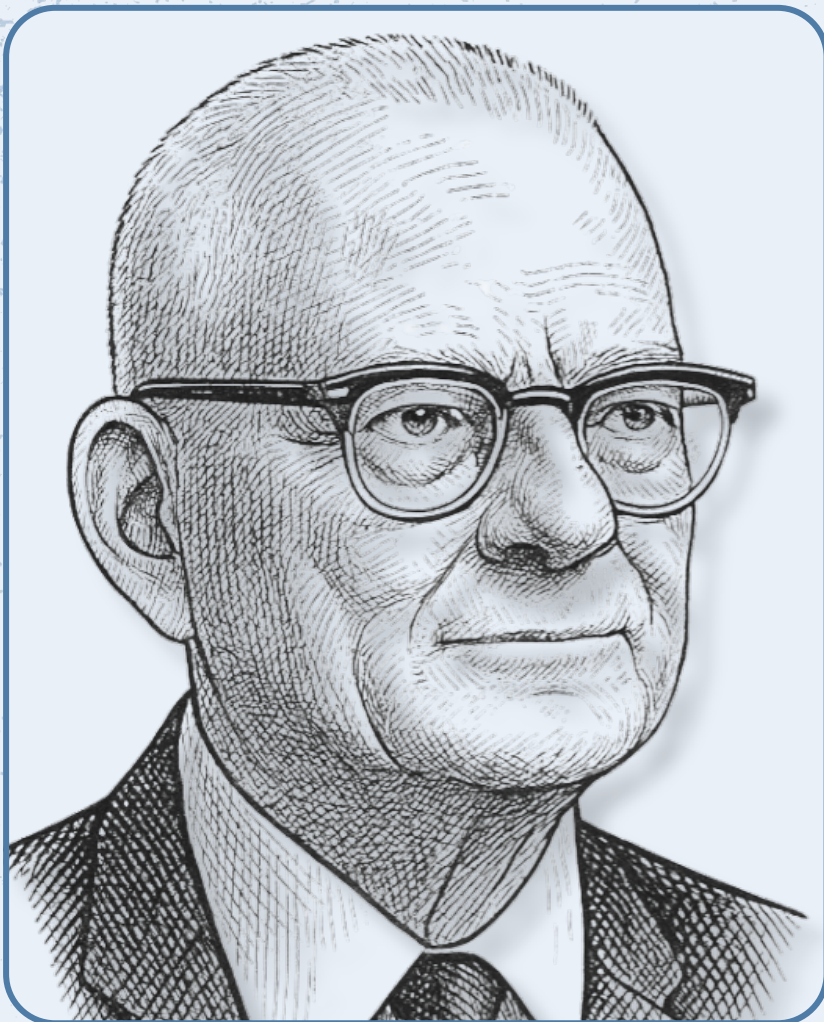
Source: Jeffrey Liker The Toyota Way, Second Edition. McGraw-Hill Education.



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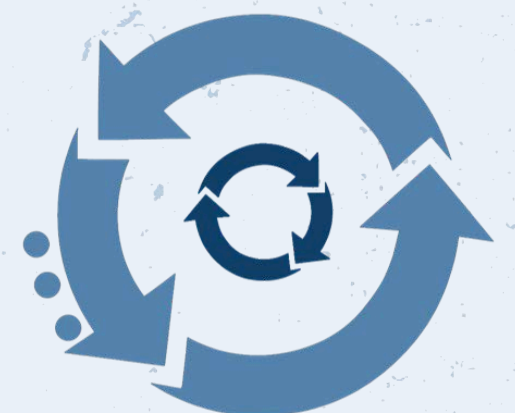
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W. Edwards Deming

“
**The worker is
not the
problem.
The problem is
at the top!**
”



Source: deming.org/quotes



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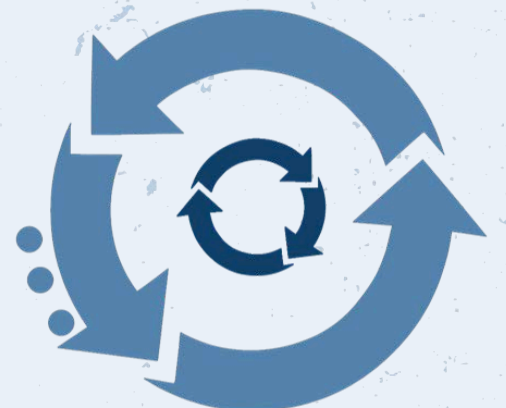
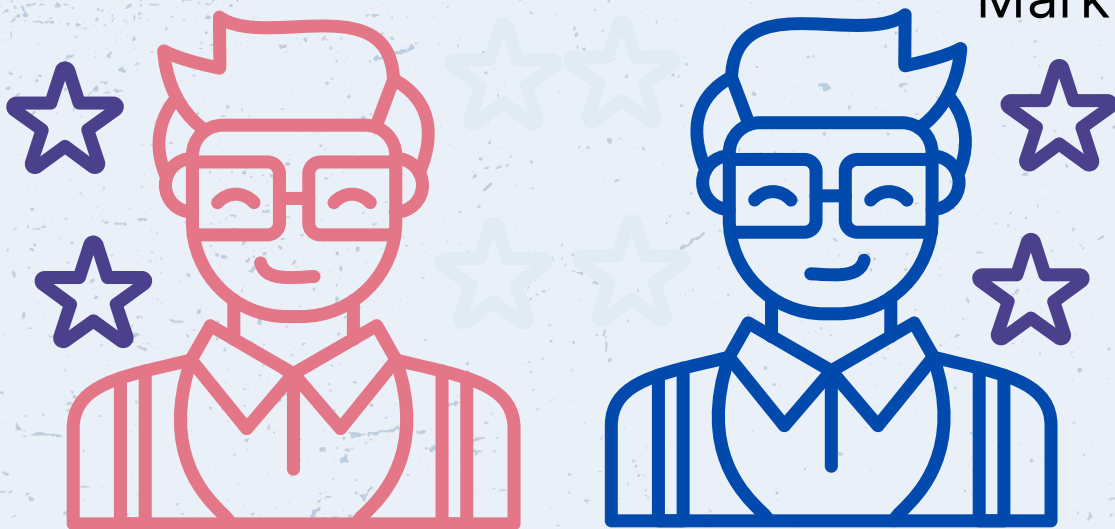
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“

there is a difference
between becoming
like Toyota or becoming
Toyota-like.

”

Mark DeLuzio



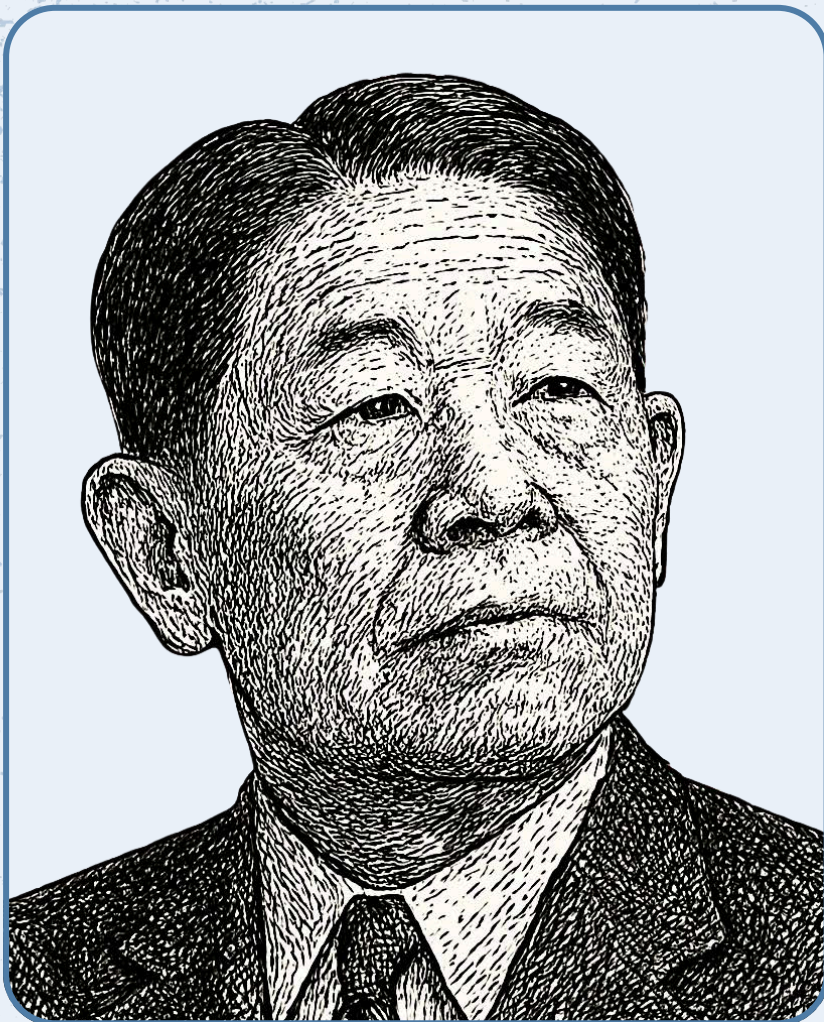
Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined why lean transformations fail and what to do about it. Routledge.



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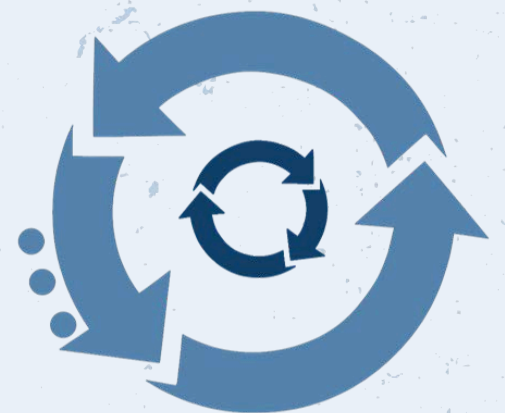
“



Shigeo Shingo

Never Say
“Impossible”

”



Source: Shingo, S. and Dillon, The Sayings Of Shigeo Shingo

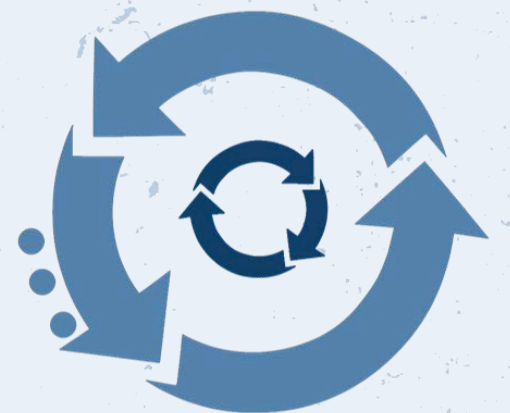


“

Aligning your Lean transformation with strategy is essential in keeping your efforts from flatlining over long periods of time

”

Mark DeLuzio

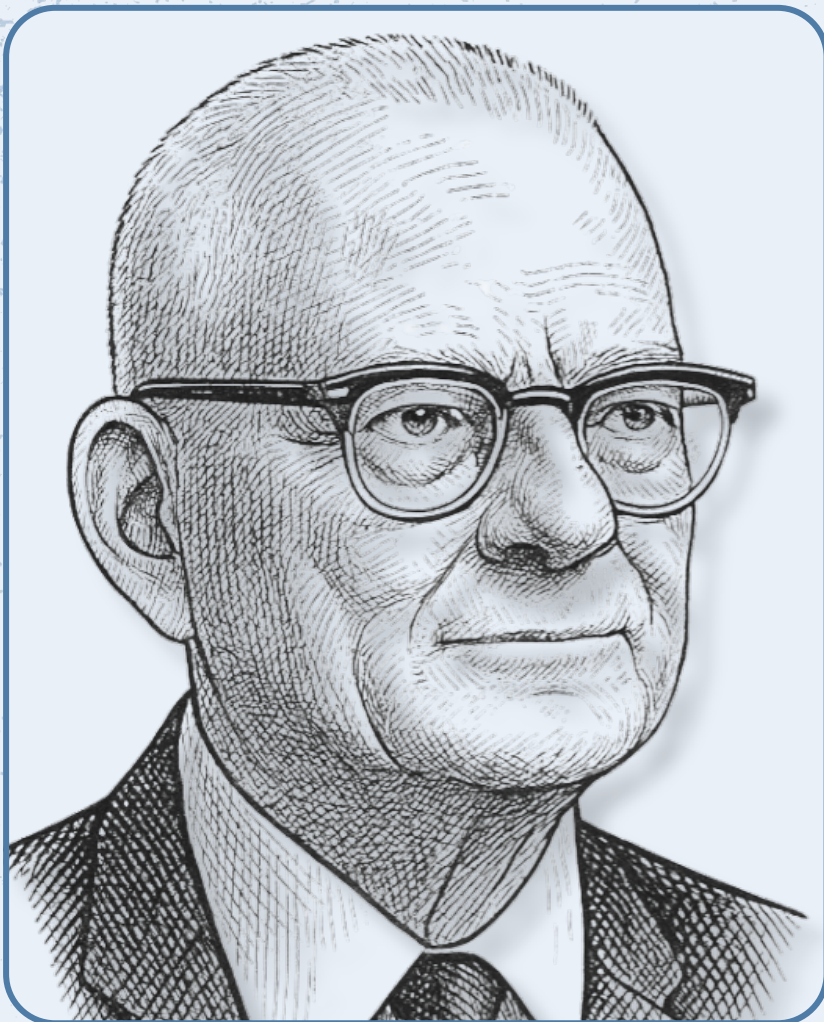


Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined why lean transformations fail and what to do about it. Routledge.



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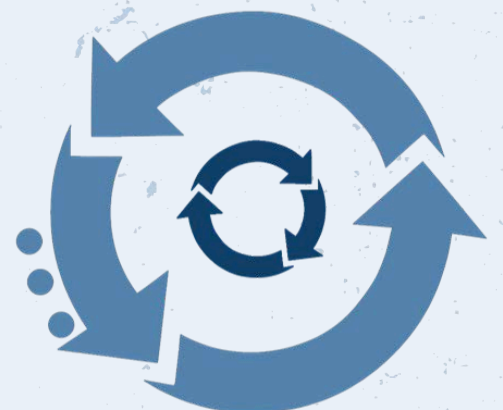


W. Edwards Deming

“

**No country need
be poor if it has
people and good
management.**

”



Source: deming.org/quotes



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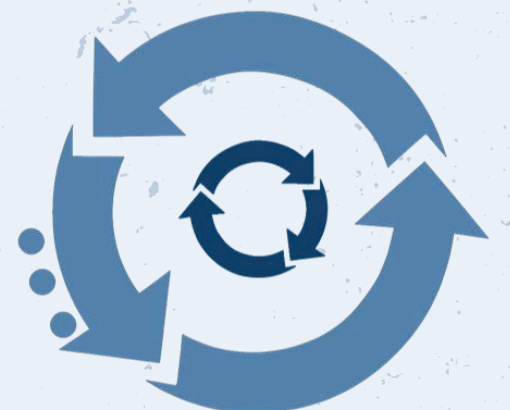
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“

Targets are meant to be **very**
challenging not only for you as
an individual, but for the
organization collectively.

”

Tracey, Ernie Richardson



Source: Tracey Richardson, and Ernie Richardson. The Toyota Engagement Equation



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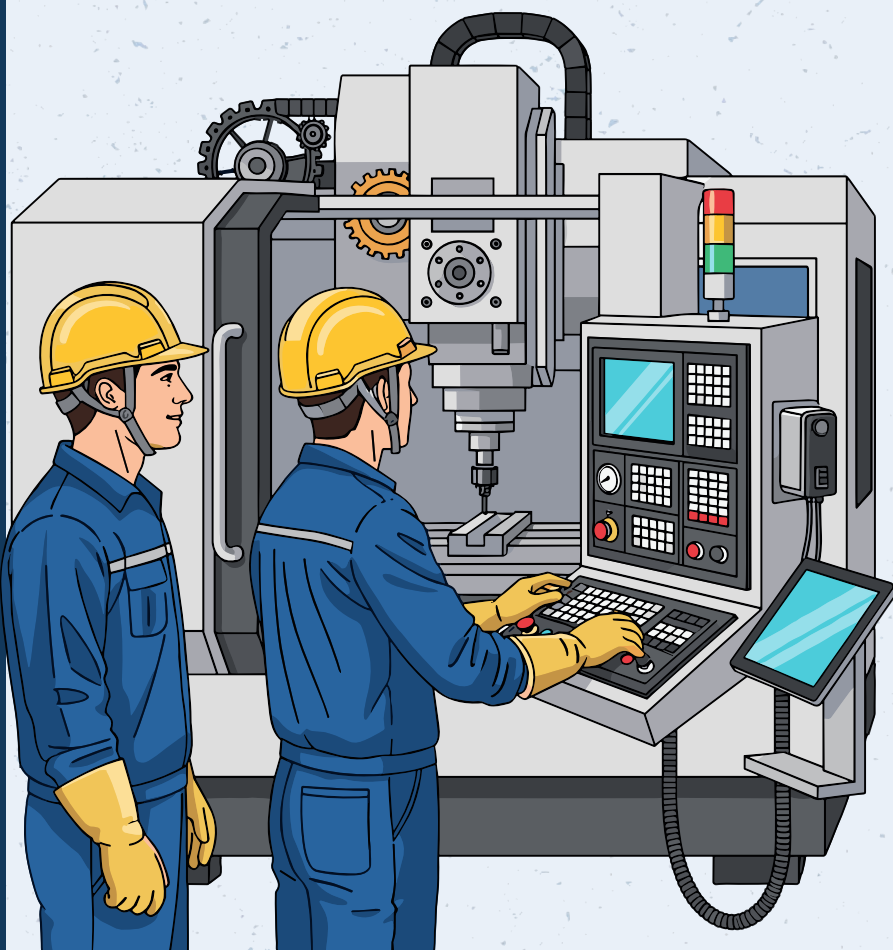
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“

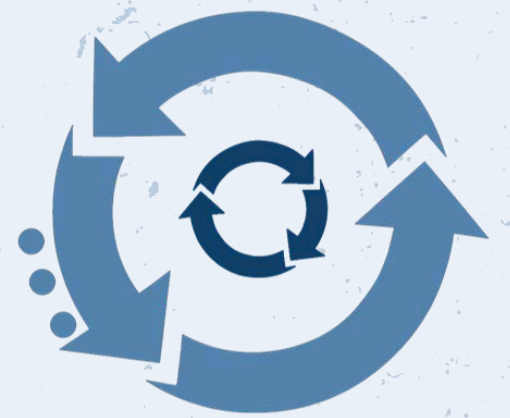
**Direct observation is essential,
and no combination of indirect
methods, however clever, can
possibly take its place.**

”

Steven J. Spear



Source: Steven J. Spear, Learning to Lead at Toyota, HBR



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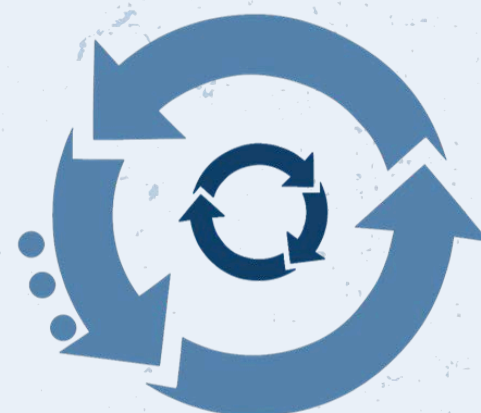
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“

.. if you make **teamwork** the
foundation of the company and
develop strong leaders,
individual performers
will give their hearts and souls to
contribute ...

”

Jeffrey Liker



Source: Jeffrey Liker The Toyota Way, Second Edition. McGraw-Hill Education.



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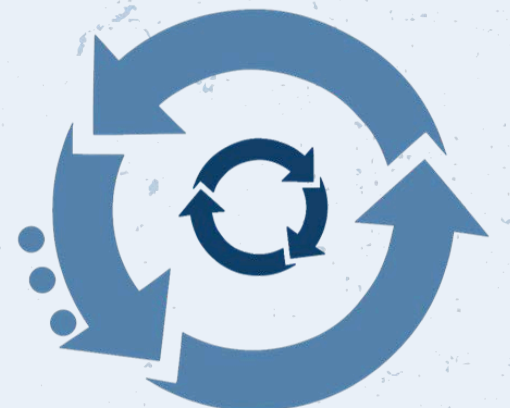
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“

Never allow yourself to move
faster than the facts you confirm
at the gemba, and never let
down your guard against the
dangers of assumptions.

”

Tracey, Ernie Richardson



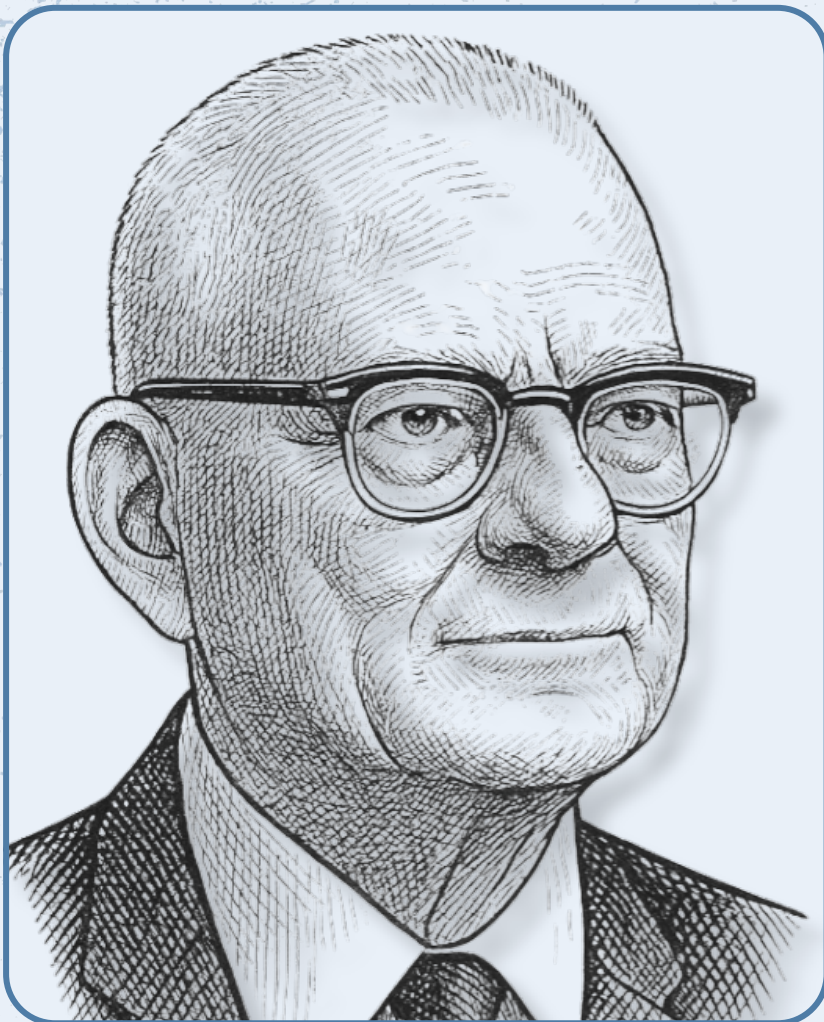
Source: Tracey Richardson, and Ernie Richardson. The Toyota Engagement Equation



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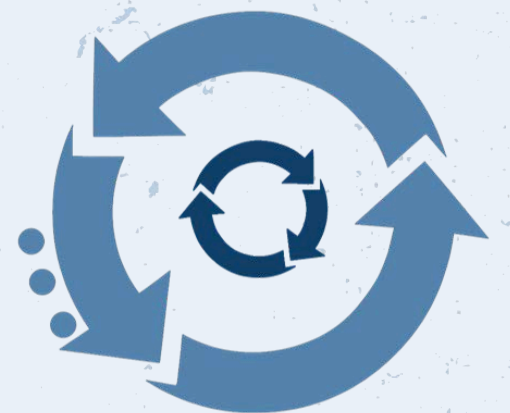
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W. Edwards Deming

“
**Management by
results — like
driving a car by
looking in rear
view mirror.**
”



Source: deming.org/quotes



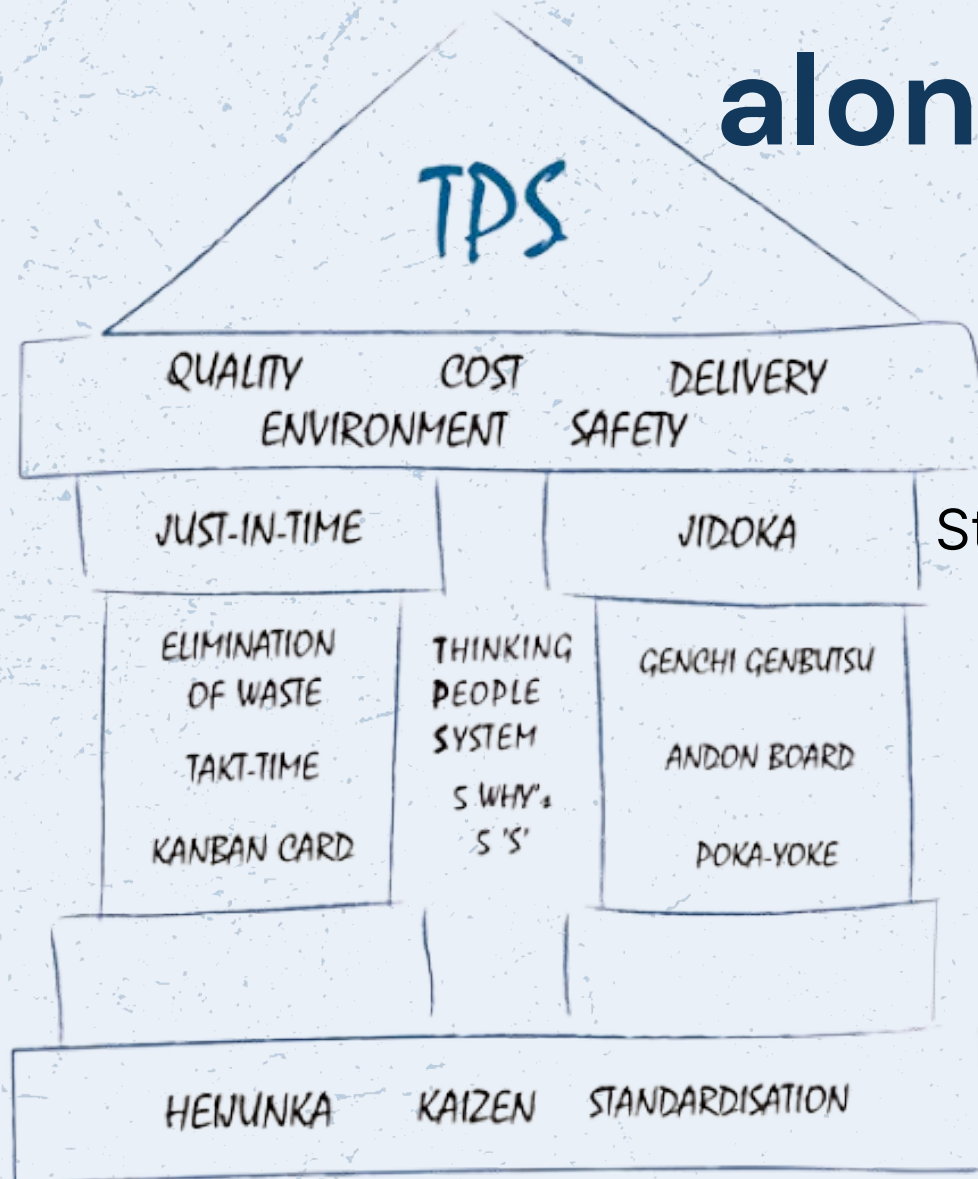
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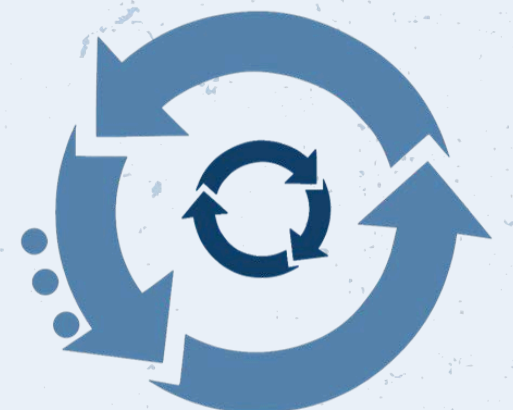
“

TPS is a system you have to
live to fully understand, let
alone improve.

”



Steven J. Spear



Source: Steven J. Spear, Learning to Lead at Toyota, HBR



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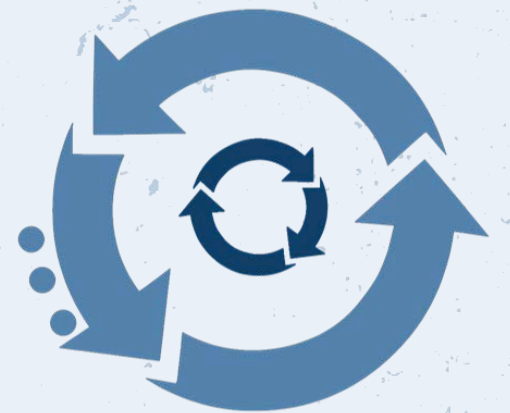
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“

**The Toyota Way is ... about
simultaneously
challenging and respecting
team members.**

”

Jeffrey Liker



Source: Jeffrey Liker The Toyota Way, Second Edition. McGraw-Hill Education.



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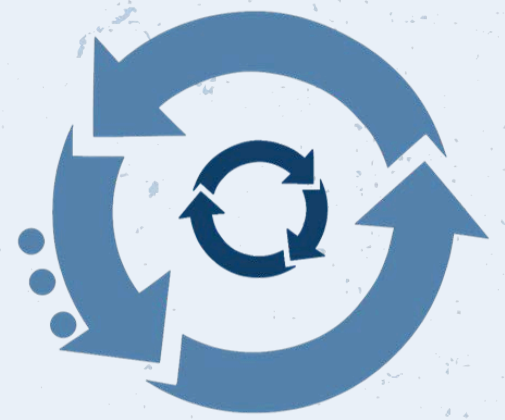
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“

Toyota's view of the role of the leader ... is **not to discipline and react to problems**, but rather to **plan, lead by example, and coach.**

”

Jeffrey Liker



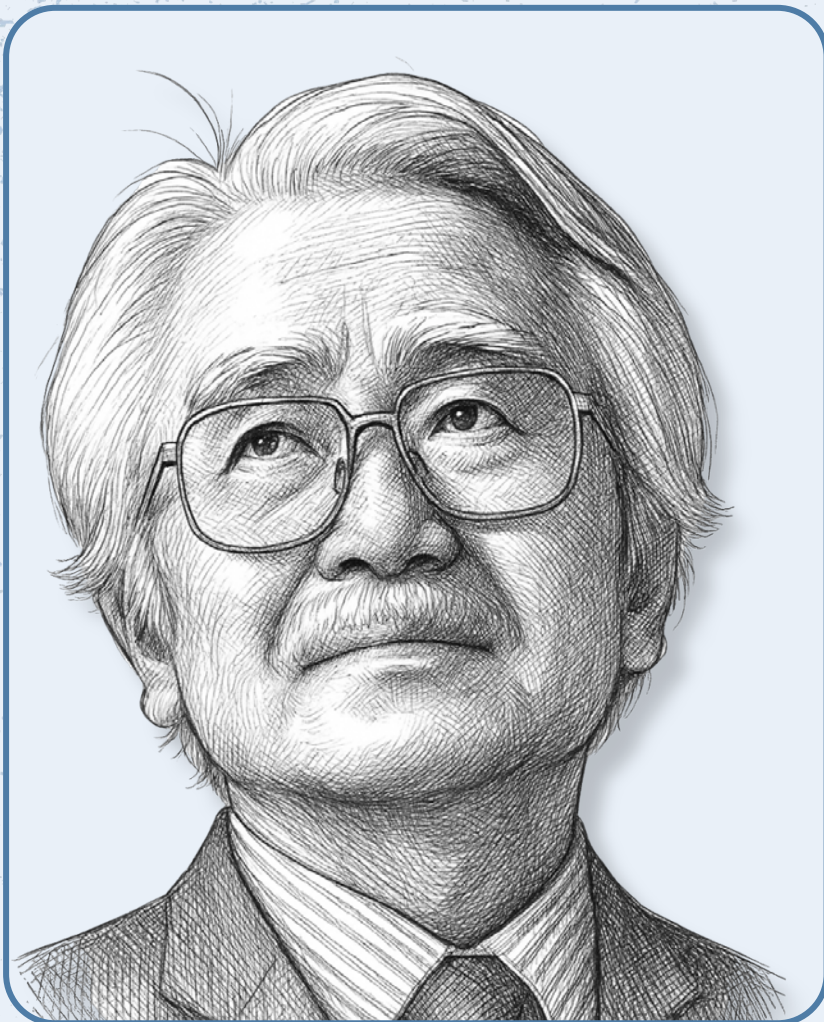
Source: Jeffrey Liker The Toyota Way, Second Edition. McGraw-Hill Education.



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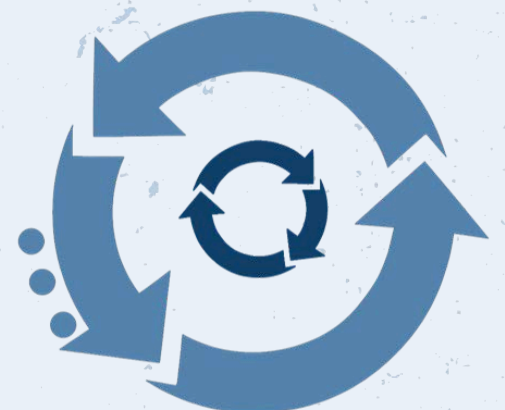
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Masaki Imai

“ **kaizen and productivity improvement must not result in firing of employees.** ”



Source: Jeffrey Liker The Toyota Way, Second Edition. McGraw-Hill Education.



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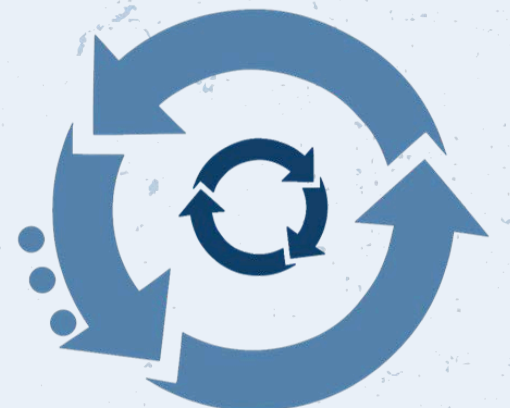
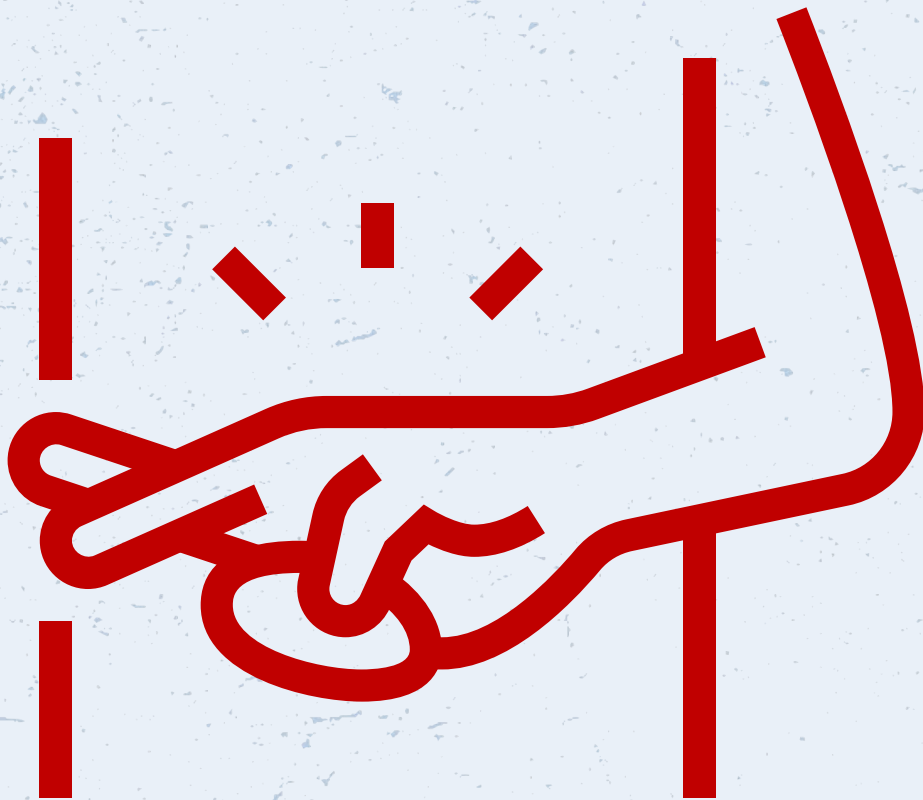
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“

**Establish mutual trust ... and
construct a win-win partnership.
If team members think management
is playing games, it is over.**

”

Jeffrey Liker



Source: Jeffrey Liker The Toyota Way, Second Edition. McGraw-Hill Education.



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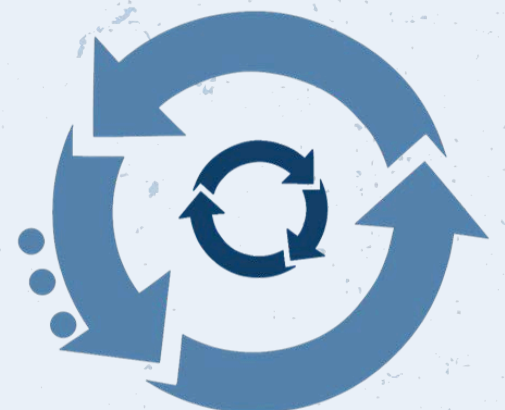
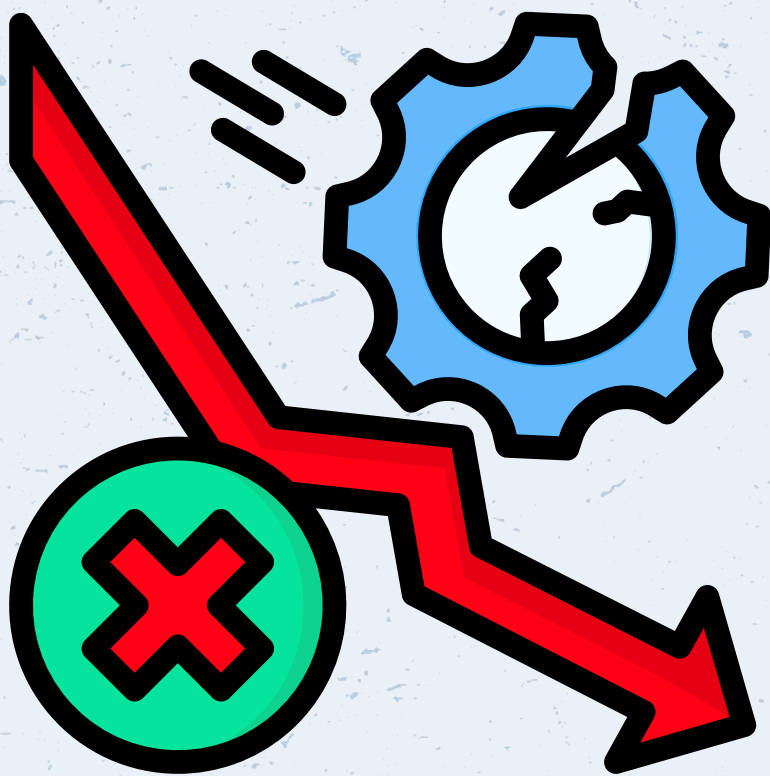
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“

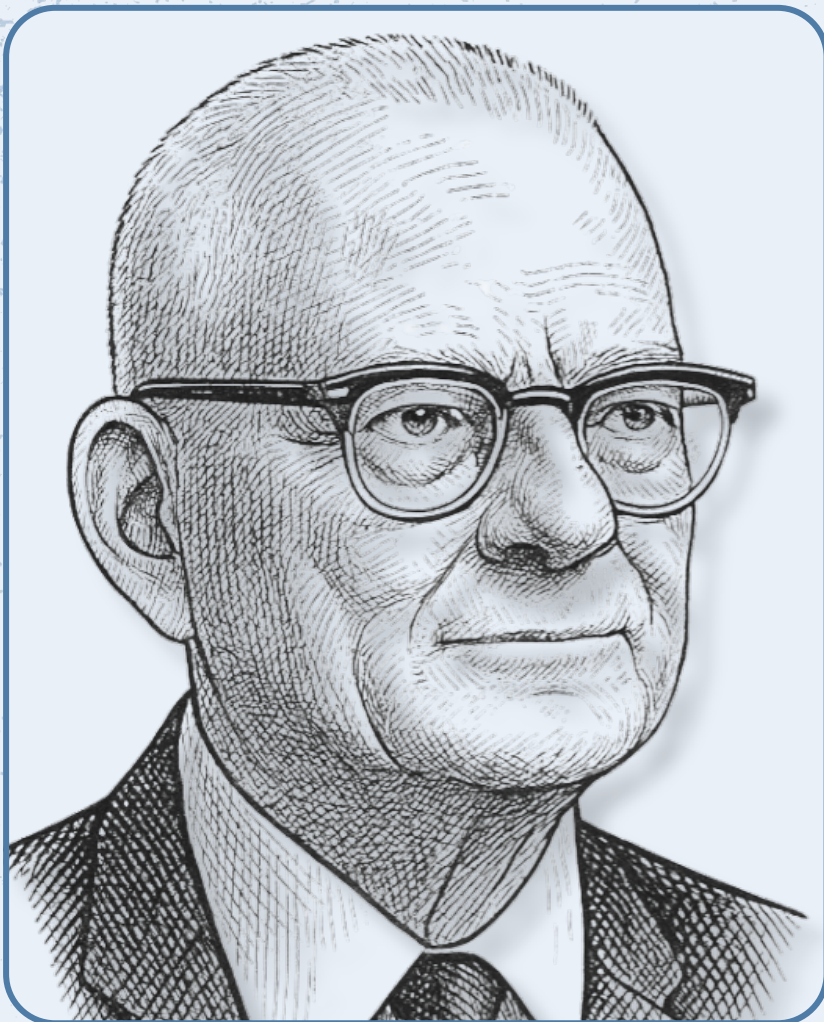
Companies that don't focus
on the **enterprise as a whole**
will **never realize** the true
potential that Lean has to
offer

”

Mark DeLuzio



Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined why lean transformations fail and what to do about it. Routledge.

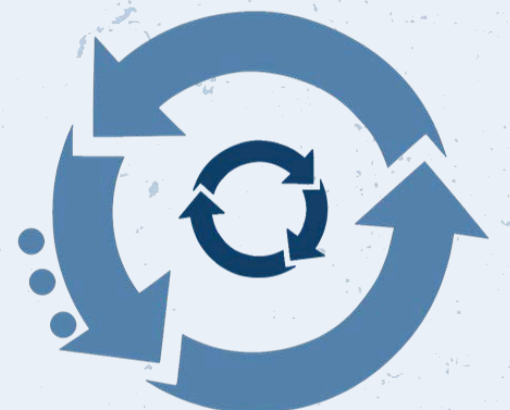


W. Edwards Deming

“

The greatest waste
in America is
failure to use the
abilities of people.

”

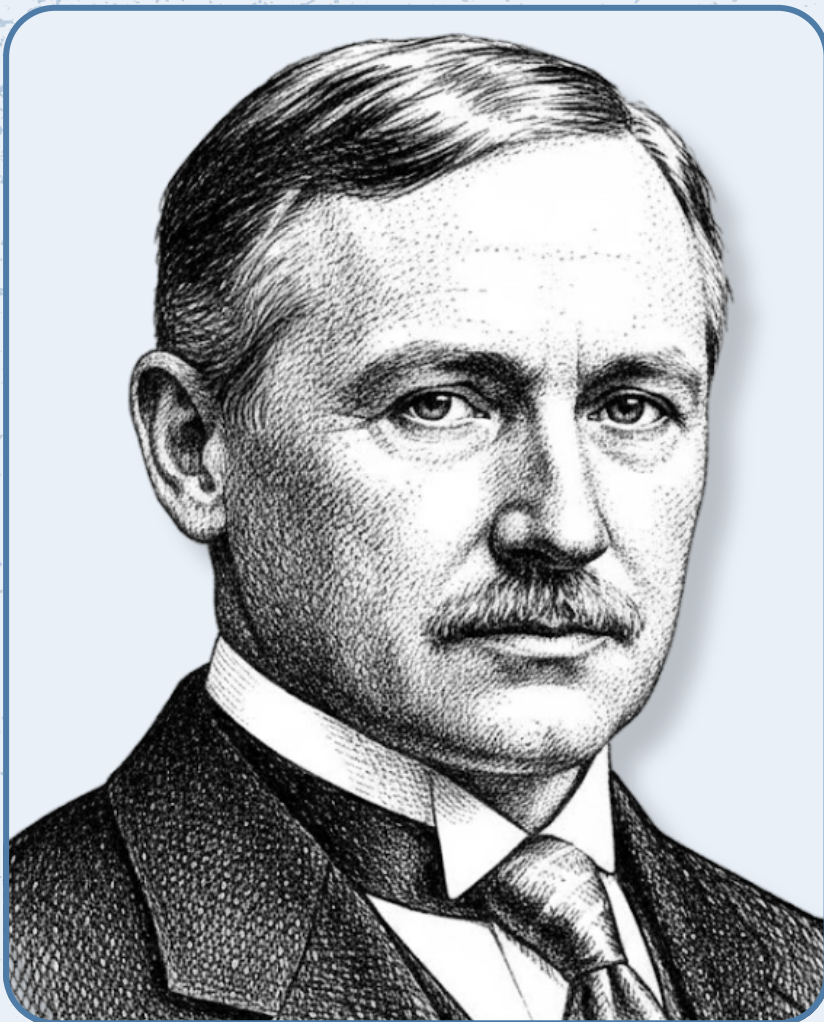


Source: deming.org/quotes



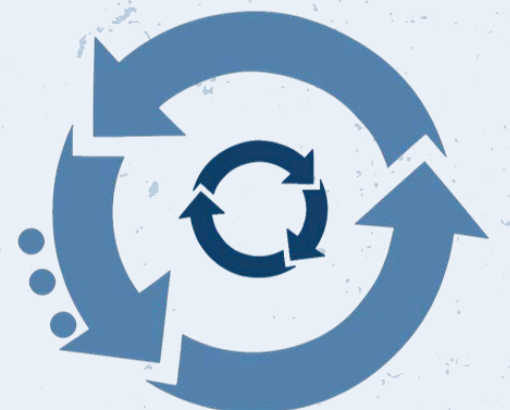
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Frederick Winslow Taylor

“
The principal object of
management should be to
secure the **maximum
prosperity** for the employer,
coupled with the **maximum
prosperity** for each
employee.
”



Source: The Principles of Scientific Management



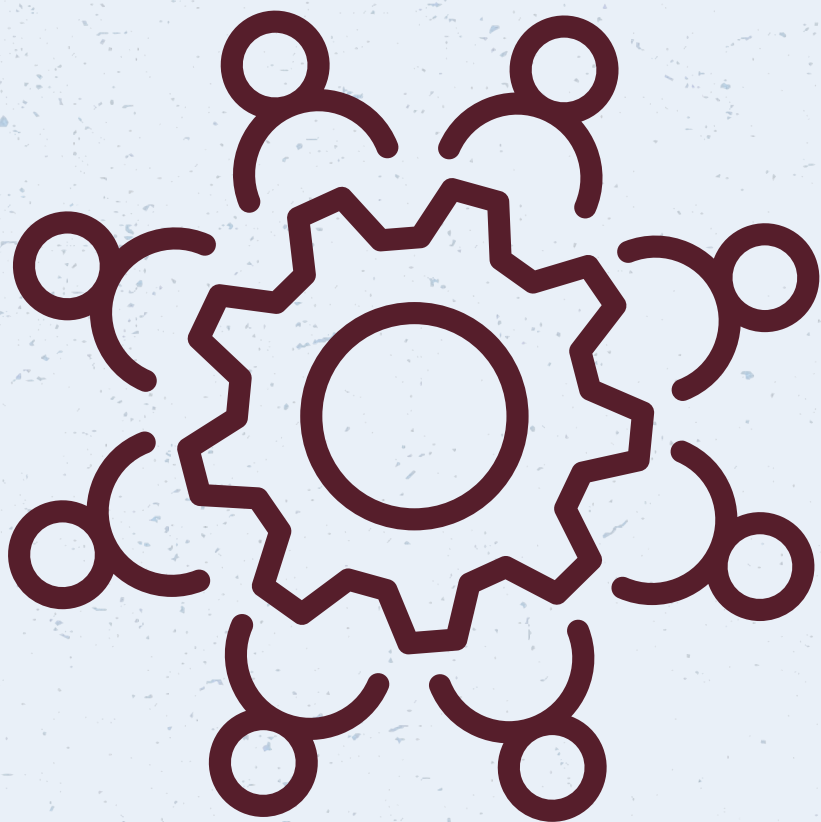
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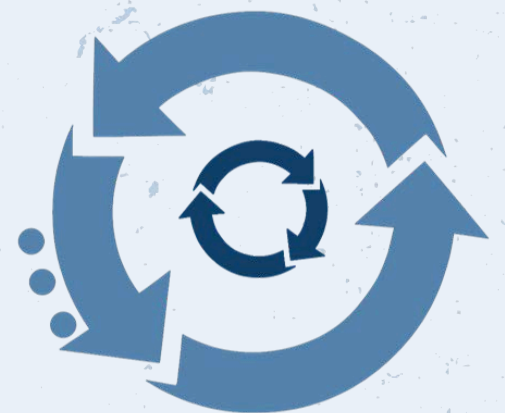
“

If Lean is an enterprise endeavor, culture is the glue that holds the entire infrastructure together.

”



Mark DeLuzio

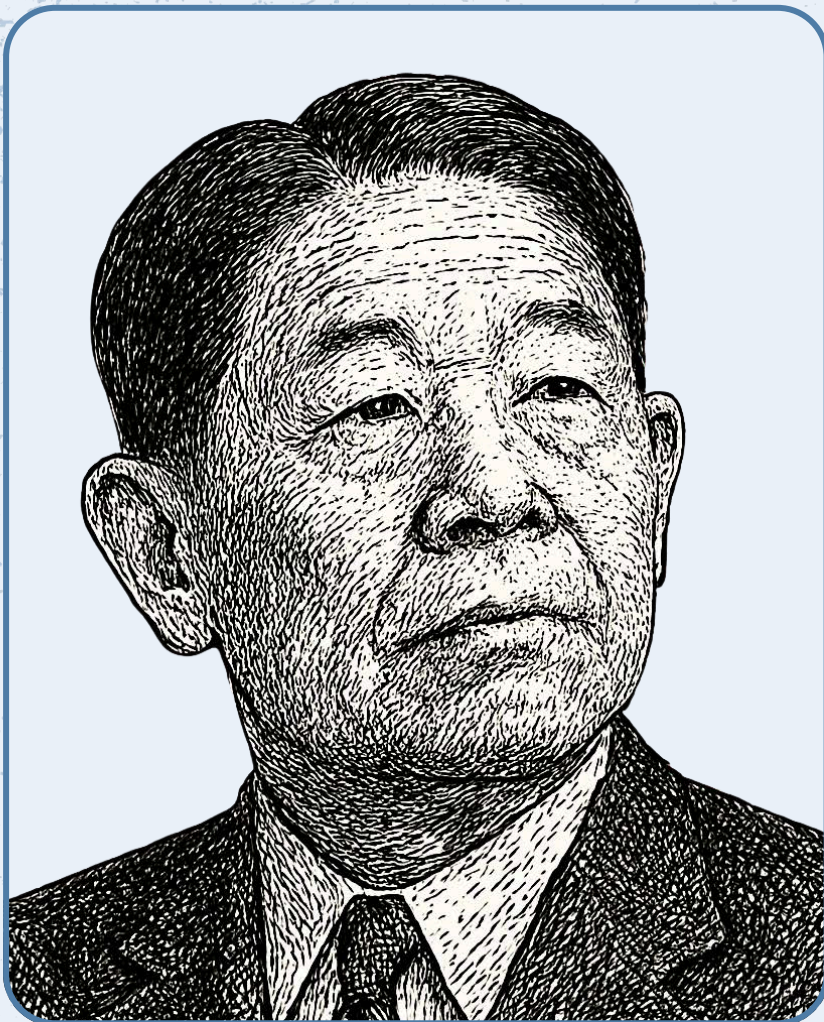


Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined why lean transformations fail and what to do about it. Routledge.



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Shigeo Shingo

“

Quality control should
never be confined to
scholarly theoretical
studies;

it has to be comprehensible to
ordinary managers and shop-floor
supervisors.

”



Source: Shingo, S. and Dillon, The Sayings Of Shigeo Shingo



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“

**Values and principles
without underlying
processes are merely
slogans.**

”

Mark DeLuzio



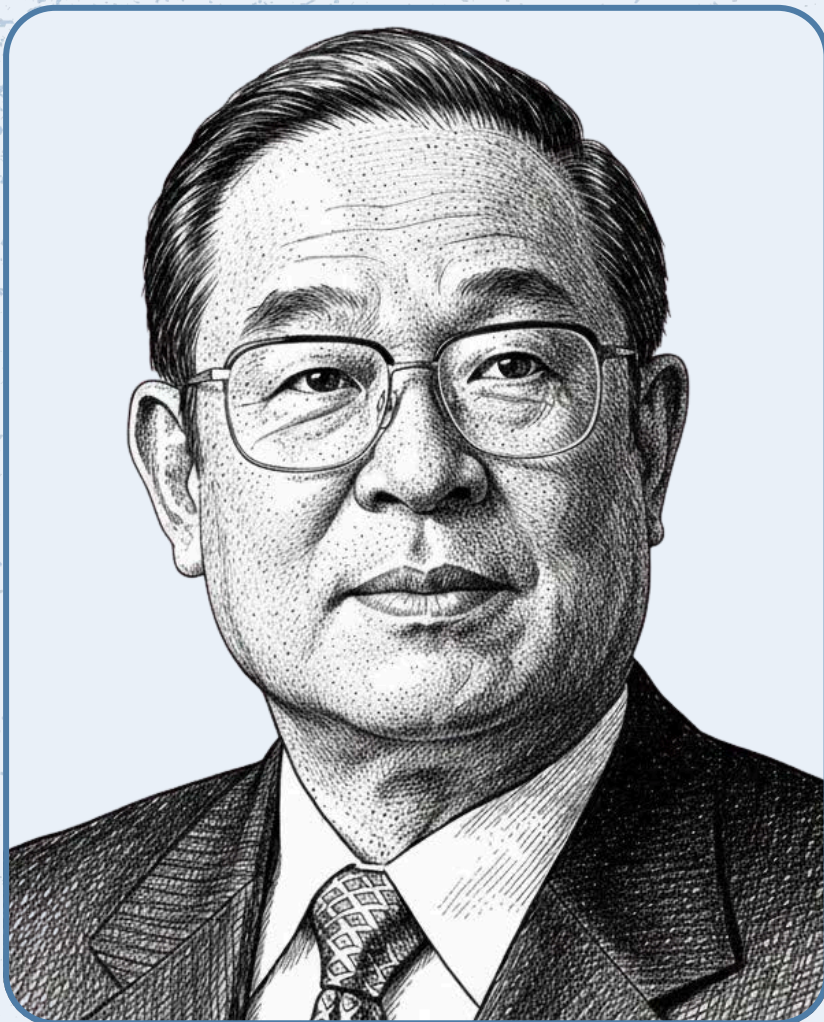
Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined why lean transformations fail and what to do about it. Routledge.



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“



Fujio Cho

First we build
people, then
we build cars.

”



Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined why lean transformations fail and what to do about it. Routledge.



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“

The **power of Lean** rippling
through your organization
.... requires the **CEO** to be
the champion of it.

”

Mark DeLuzio



Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined why lean transformations fail and what to do about it. Routledge.



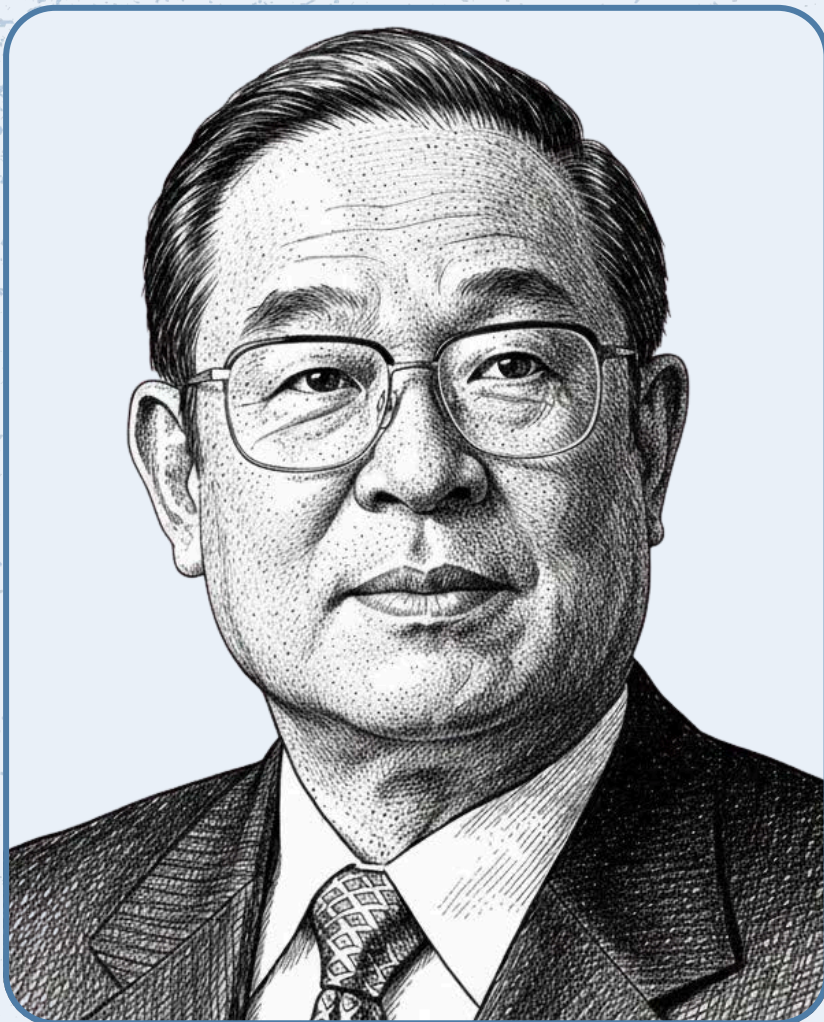
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“



Fujio Cho

Go see.

Ask why.

Show respect

”

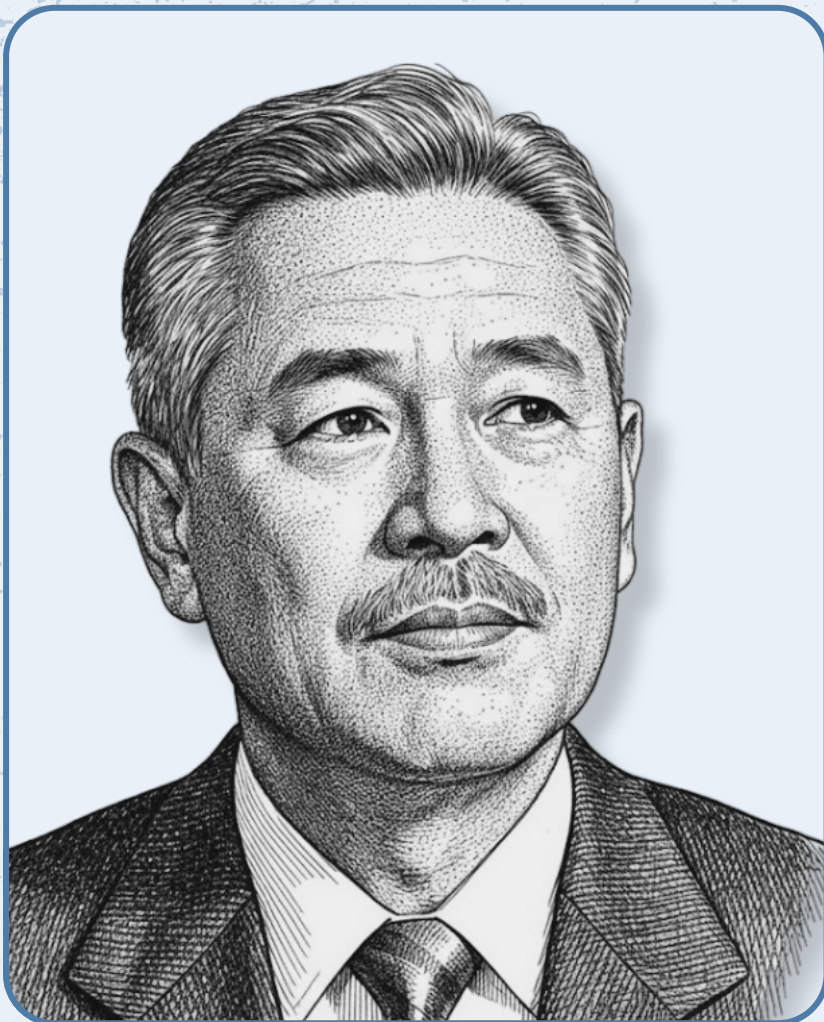


Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined why lean transformations fail and what to do about it. Routledge.



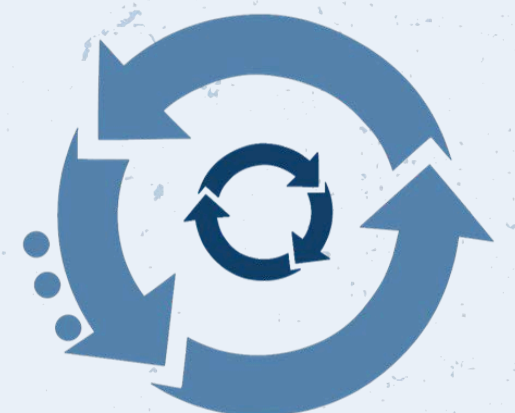
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Taiichi Ohno

“
The basis of the
Toyota production
system is the
absolute
elimination of
waste
”



Source: Ohno, T. Toyota production system: Beyond large-scale production. Productivity Press.



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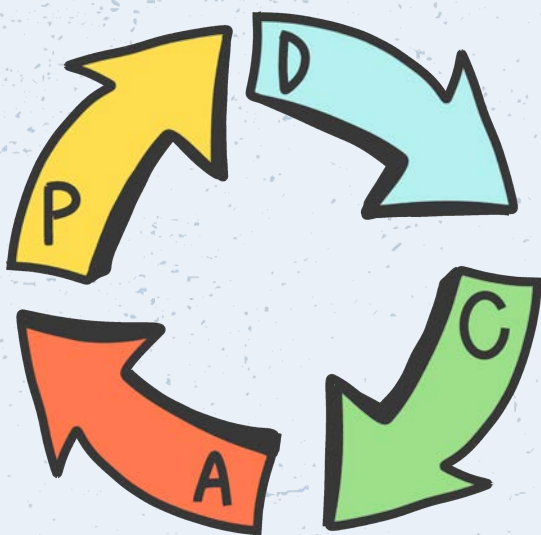
“

**Anything that I'm doing
today can be done
better tomorrow.**

Without this fundamental belief radiating throughout the organization, improvements can't happen.
The flatline will stay flat.

”

Mark DeLuzio

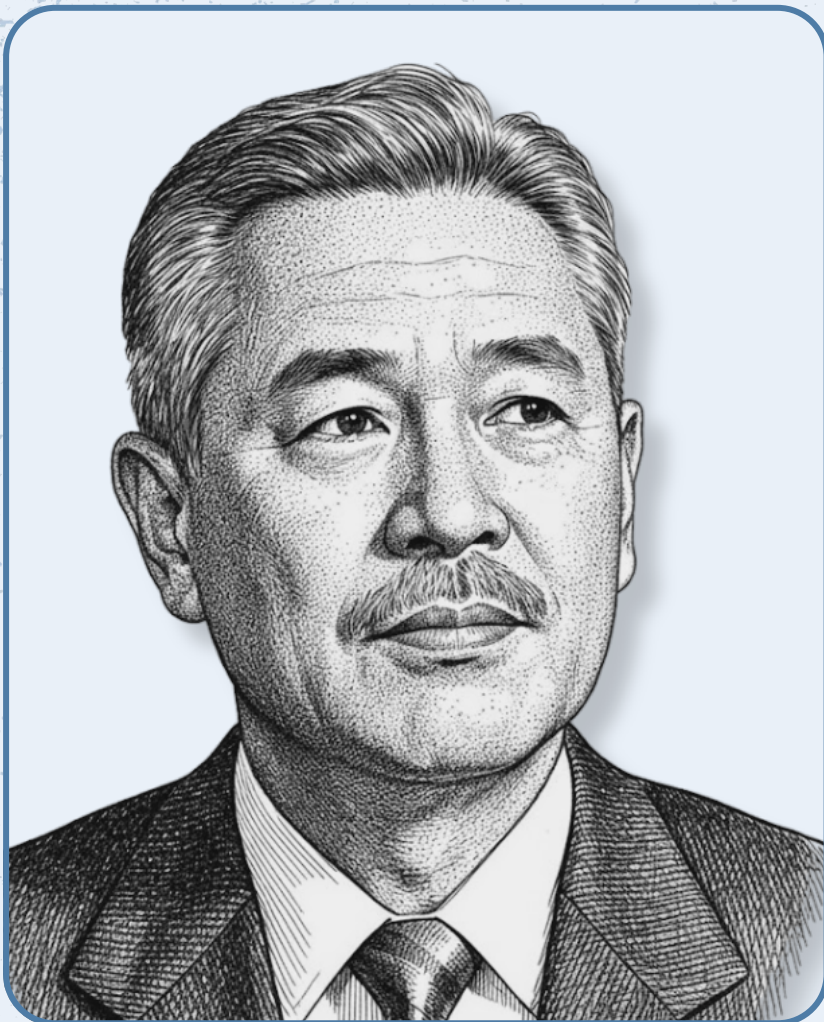


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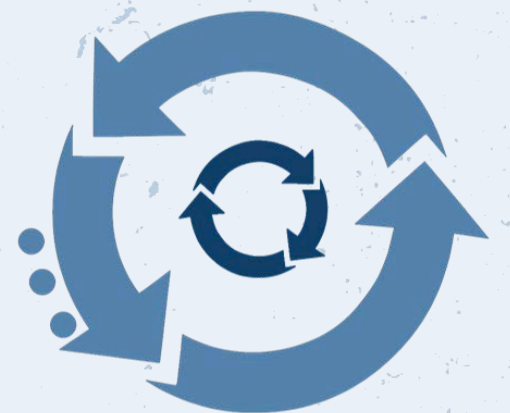
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Taiichi Ohno

“
**Eliminating
wasteful and
meaningless jobs..
enhances the
value of work for
workers.**
”



Source: Ohno, T. Toyota production system: Beyond large-scale production. Productivity Press.



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“

The operators are the **best consultants** who know the nature of the work better than anyone.

”

Mark DeLuzio



Source: DeLuzio, M. C. (2020). Flatlined why lean transformations fail and what to do about it. Routledge.



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